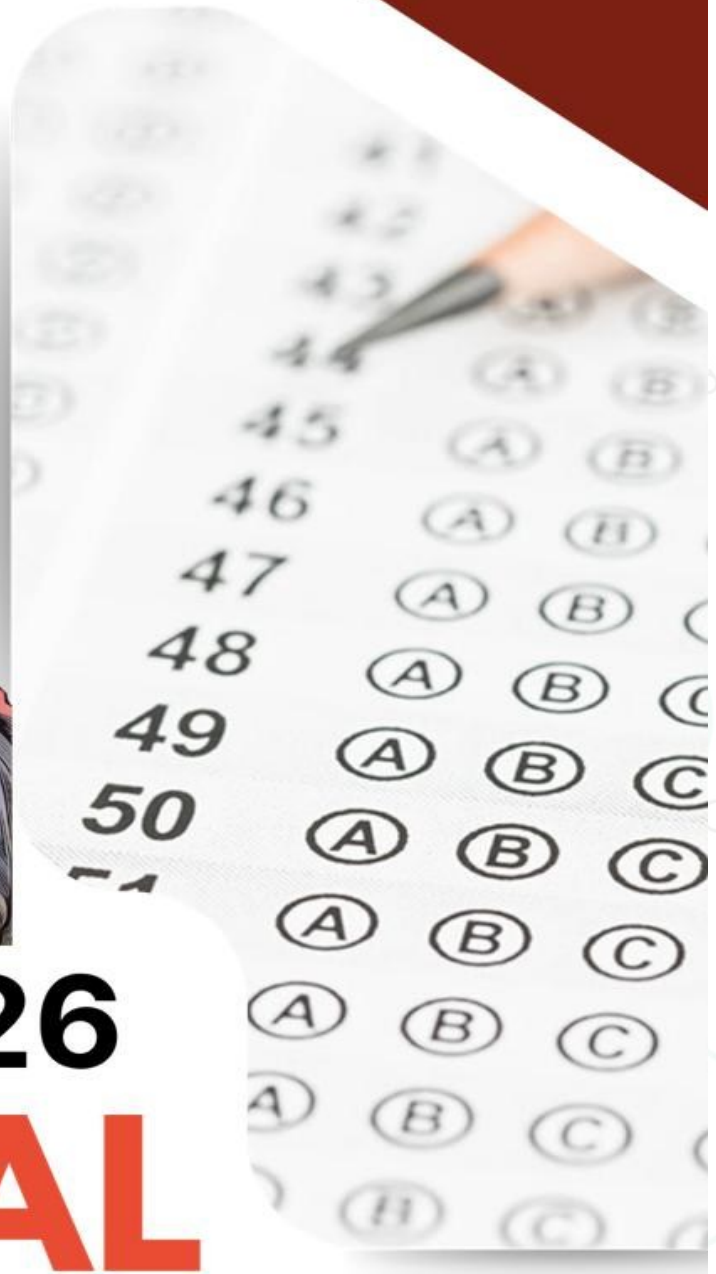
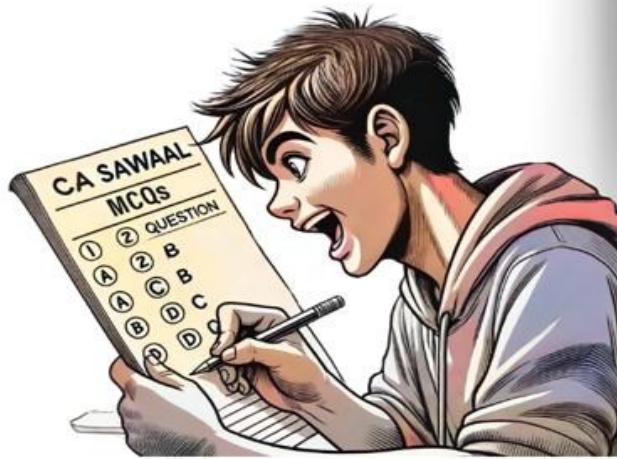




MARCH 2026 SAWAAL

**The CA OBJECTIVE
Monthly e-Book**

400^{*} MCQs
Detailed
Explanation

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Important Days

1. Zero Discrimination Day is observed every year on:

- (a) 8 May (b) 1 March
(c) 10 December (d) 21 March

Answer: B

Explanation

- 1 March Zero Discrimination Day
- Zero Discrimination Day highlights how people can become informed about and promote inclusion, compassion, peace and, above all, a movement for change.

2. The theme of World Civil Defence Day 2026 is:

- (a) Building Back Better
(b) Climate Action Now
(c) Managing Environmental Risks for a Resilient and Sustainable Future
(d) Disaster-Free World

Answer: C

Explanation

- 1 March World Civil Defence Day
- THEME : "Managing Environmental Risks for a Resilient and Sustainable Future"

3. Seagrasses are best described as:

- (a) Marine algae
(b) Freshwater mosses
(c) Marine flowering plants
(d) Coral organisms

Answer: C

Explanation

- March 1 World Seagrass Day
- In May 2022, the General Assembly adopted proclaiming 1 March as World Seagrass Day.
- Seagrasses are marine flowering plants that are found in shallow waters in many parts of the world, from the tropics to the Arctic circle.

4. The theme for World Wildlife Day 2026 is:

- (a) Partnerships for Wildlife Conservation
(b) Sustaining All Life on Earth
(c) Recovering Key Species for Ecosystem Restoration
(d) Medicinal and Aromatic Plants: Conserving Health, Heritage and Livelihoods

Answer: D

Explanation

- March 3 - World Wildlife Day
- THEME: "Medicinal and Aromatic Plants: Conserving Health, Heritage and Livelihoods"

5. The theme of World Hearing Day 2026 is:

- (a) Hearing care for all
(b) Ear and hearing care across the life course
(c) From communities to classrooms: hearing care for all children
(d) To hear for life, listen with care

Answer: C

Explanation

- March 3 - World Hearing Day
- The theme - "From communities to classrooms: hearing care for all children"

6. The theme of National Safety Day/Safety Week 2025 is:

- (a) Safety First, Safety Always
(b) Building a Safer Future
(c) Engage, Educate & Empower People to Enhance Safety
(d) Safety for Sustainable Development

Answer: C

Explanation

- March 4 - National Safety Day
- National Safety Council (NSC) was set up by the Ministry of Labour, Government of India (GOI) on 4th March, 1966 to generate, develop and sustain a voluntary movement on Safety, Health and Environment (SHE) at the national level .
- Theme: "Engage, Educate & Empower People to Enhance Safety."

7. World Engineering Day for Sustainable Development (WED) is celebrated on:

- (a) 1st March (b) 4th March
(cx) 5th June (d) 14th April

Answer: B

Explanation

- 4th March World Engineering Day for Sustainable Development
- In November 2019, UNESCO proclaimed the World Engineering Day for Sustainable Development (WED) at its 40th General Conference.
- It is celebrated worldwide on March 4 each year since 2020.
- the theme is "Smart engineering for sustainable future through innovation and digitalization"

8. What is the theme of World Obesity Day?

- (a) Healthy Living for All
(b) 8 Billion Reasons to Act on Obesity
(c) Fit India Movement
(d) Nutrition for Growth

Answer: B

Explanation

- World Obesity Day has been observed globally on the 4th of March every year from 2020
- theme is "8 Billion Reasons to Act on Obesity"

9. The International Day for Disarmament and Non-Proliferation Awareness is observed every year on:

- (a) 3 March (b) 5 March
(c) 10 April (d) 24 October

Answer: B

Explanation

- 5 March - International Day for Disarmament and Non- Proliferation Awareness

10. Which Indian corporate group has been named an official partner for World Engineering Day for Sustainable Development (WED) 2026?

- (a) Tata Group (b) Reliance Industries
(c) Adani Group (d) Larsen & Toubro

Answer: C

Explanation

- The Adani Group has been named an official partner for the World Engineering Day for Sustainable Development (WED) 2026.
- This marks the first time an Indian organisation has been selected

11. The theme of Jan Aushadhi Diwas 2026 is:

- (a) Affordable Medicines for All
(b) Swasth Bharat, Samridh Bharat
(c) Janaushadhi Sasti Bhi, Bharosemand Bhi, Sehat Ki Baat, Bachat Ke Saath
(d) Generic Medicines for Healthy India

Answer: C

Explanation

- 7th March Jan Aushadhi Diwas
- Theme: "Janaushadhi Sasti Bhi, Bharosemand Bhi, Sehat Ki Baat, Bachat Ke Saath,"

12. The theme of International Women's Day 2026 is:

- (a) Invest in Women: Accelerate Progress
(b) Rights. Justice. Action. For ALL Women and Girls.
(c) Gender Equality Today for a Sustainable Tomorrow
(d) Women in Leadership: Achieving an Equal Future

Answer: B

Explanation

- March 8 - International Women's Day
- Theme "Rights. Justice. Action. For ALL Women and Girls."
- A global campaign theme, 'Give to Gain'.

13. The Central Industrial Security Force (CISF) was established under an Act of Parliament on:

- (a) 26 January 1969 (b) 10 March 1969
(c) 15 August 1969 (d) 2 October 1969

Answer: B

Explanation

- Central Industrial Security Force (CISF) established in 1969 to protect sensitive public sector undertakings.
- It was set up under an Act of the Parliament of India on 10 March 1969 with a strength of 2,800.

14. International Day of Women Judges is observed annually on:

- (a) 8 March (b) 10 March
(c) 15 March (d) 21 March

Answer: B

Explanation

- 10th March International Day of Women Judges
THEME :Women Judges on the Bench and Beyond: Protecting Access to Justice

15. Mauritius celebrates its National Day every year on:

- (a) March 10 (b) March 12
(c) April 12 (d) February 12

Answer: B

Explanation

- Mauritius celebrates its National Day annually on March 12, marking its independence from British rule in 1968.
- The day also signifies the nation's transition to a republic within the Commonwealth in 1992.

16. Consider the following statements regarding the Dandi March:

1. It was launched by Mohandas Karamchand Gandhi in 1930.

2. It aimed to challenge the British tax on salt.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Explanation

- Dandi March Anniversary - 12th March, 1930
- The Dandi March, also known as the Salt March and the Dandi Satyagraha was an act of nonviolent civil disobedience led by Mohandas Karamchand Gandhi.
- The march lasted from 12th March, 1930 to 6th April, 1930 as a direct action campaign of tax resistance and nonviolent protest against the British salt monopoly.
- On 12th March, Gandhiji set out from Sabarmati with 78 followers on a 241-mile march to the coastal town of Dandi on the Arabian Sea.

17. World Kidney Day is observed every year on:

- (a) First Monday of March
- (b) Second Thursday of March
- (c) Third Tuesday of March
- (d) Fourth Tuesday of March

Answer: B**Explanation**

- 12 March World Kidney Day - Celebrated on the 2nd Thursday in the month of March every year since 2006.
- Theme is "Kidney Health for All: Caring for People, Protecting the Planet."

18. The theme of International Day of Mathematics 2026 is:

- (a) Mathematics for a Better World
- (b) Mathematics Unites
- (c) Mathematics and Creativity
- (d) Mathematics and Hope

Answer: D**Explanation**

- March 14 - International Mathematics Day
- The theme for International Mathematics Day 2026 is "Mathematics and hope."

19. Pi Day is celebrated every year on:

- (a) March 12
- (b) March 14
- (c) April 14
- (d) December 22

Answer: B**Explanation**

- 14 March Pi Day
- Pi Day is an annual celebration of the mathematical constant π which is approximately 3.14159
- Pi Day is observed on March 14 since 3, 1, and 4 are the first three significant figures of π

20. The theme for International Day of Action for Rivers 2026 is:

- (a) Rivers for Climate
- (b) Water for All
- (c) Protect Rivers, Protect People
- (d) Restore River Ecosystems

Answer: C**Explanation**

- 14 March International Day of Action for Rivers
- Theme - Protect Rivers, Protect People.

21. The 2026 theme of World Consumer Rights Day is:

- (a) Safe Products, Confident Consumers
- (b) Sustainable Consumption
- (c) Fair Digital Finance
- (d) Consumer Protection in E-Commerce

Answer: A**Explanation**

- 15 March World Consumer Rights Day
- Theme : "Safe Products, Confident Consumers"

22. International Day to Combat Islamophobia is observed annually on:

- (a) 10 March
- (b) 12 March
- (c) 15 March
- (d) 21 March

Answer: C**Explanation**

- 15 March International Day to Combat Islamophobia
- Designated by United Nations in 2022

23. The theme of National Vaccination Day 2026 is:

- (a) Vaccines Work for All
- (b) Immunization for All is Humanly Possible
- (c) Vaccines Bring Us Closer
- (d) Long Life for All

Answer: B**Explanation**

- March 16 National Vaccination Day
- National Vaccination Day was celebrated for the first time on 16 March, 1995.
- The theme - "Immunization for All is Humanly Possible".

24. Consider the following statements:

1. Ordnance Factory Day is celebrated on 18 March.
2. The first ordnance factory in India was set up in Cossipore.
3. The Ordnance Factory Board was established in 1969.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A**Explanation**

- Ordnance Factory Day is celebrated on 18th March every year in India as a mark of establishing the first Ordnance Factory in India in 1801 in Cossipore, Kolkata.
- The Ordnance Factory Board established in 1979, manages the defense production in India.

25. The headquarters of the Narcotics Control Bureau is located in:

- (a) Mumbai
- (b) New Delhi
- (c) Kolkata
- (d) Chennai

Answer: B**Explanation**

- March 17 Narcotics Control Bureau Raising Day
- It is the nodal drug law enforcement and intelligence agency under the Ministry of Home Affairs, Government of India.
- It came into effect on 14th November, 1985, under the provisions of the Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances Act, 1985 (NDPS Act).
- Headquarters: New Delhi

26. Which bird was declared the state bird of Delhi?

- (a) Peacock (b) House Sparrow
(c) Parrot (d) Eagle

Answer: B

Explanation

- 20th March World Sparrow Day
- World Sparrow Day was initiated by "Nature Forever," a bird conservation organization in 2010.
- In 2012, the house sparrow became Delhi's state bird.

27. International Day of Happiness is observed on:

- (a) March 18 (b) March 19
(c) March 20 (d) March 21

Answer: C

Explanation

20 March International Day of Happiness

- The General Assembly of the United Nations in its resolution of 12 July 2012 proclaimed 20 March the International Day of Happiness.

0 French Language Day is observed on:

- (a) 21 March (b) 20 March
(c) 19 March (d) 22 March

Answer: B

Explanation

- On March 20th, the United Nations celebrates French Language Day.
- This is one of the six official languages celebrated by the UN each year.

28. Consider the following statements regarding Nowruz:

1. It is celebrated on the first full moon of the year.

2. The United Nations General Assembly proclaimed March 21 as the International Day of Nowruz.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

Explanation

- International Nowruz Day - The Parsi New Year Nowruz, also spelled Novruz, Navruz, Nooruz, Nevruz, or Nauryz.
- With roots extending back over 3,000 years to the era of Zoroastrianism, Nowruz heralds the arrival of spring and is celebrated on the day of the vernal equinox, usually March 20 or 21.

- In 2010, the United Nations General Assembly proclaimed March 21 as the International Day of Nowruz, encouraging global celebrations that highlight the festival's themes of peace, unity, and renewal.

29. The theme of World Oral Health Day 2026 is:

- (a) Healthy Teeth, Healthy Life
(b) A Happy Mouth is a Happy Life
(c) Oral Care for All
(d) Smile for Life

Answer: B

Explanation

20th March - World Oral Health Day

- Theme : A Happy Mouth is a Happy Life

30. World Puppetry Day is observed on:

- (a) March 20
(b) March 21
(c) April 21
(d) May 21

Answer: B

Explanation

21st March World Puppetry Day

- The UNESCO has declared March 21st as the World Puppetry Day for the promotion of puppetry art.

31. World Day for Glaciers is observed on:

- (a) March 20
(b) March 21
(c) April 22
(d) June 5

Answer: B

Explanation

- 21 March - World Day For Glaciers 2026
- The United Nations declared 2025 as the International Year of Glaciers' Preservation.
- Proclaimed 21st March of each year as the World Day for Glaciers starting in 2025.

32. The theme of World Down Syndrome Day 2026 is:

- (a) Equal Rights for All
(b) Together Against Loneliness
(c) Inclusion for Development
(d) Leave No One Behind

Answer: B

Explanation

- 21 March - World Down Syndrome Day
- Theme : Together Against Loneliness

33. The theme for International Day for the Elimination of Racial Discrimination (2026) is:

- (a) Equality for All
- (b) Together Against Racism
- (c) Mobilizing political will: 60 years of commemorating the International Day for the Elimination of Racial Discrimination
- (d) End Discrimination Now

Answer: C**Explanation**

- 21 March International Day for the Elimination of Racial Discrimination
- Theme - Mobilizing political will: 60 years of commemorating the International Day for the Elimination of Racial Discrimination

34. World Poetry Day is observed on:

- (a) March 20
- (b) March 21
- (c) April 23
- (d) May 1

Answer: B**Explanation**

- 21 March World Poetry Day
- UNESCO first adopted 21 March as World Poetry Day during its 30th General Conference in Paris in 1999.
- Consider the following statements:
 1. International Day of Forests is observed on March 21.
 2. Theme 2026 – Forests and Economies.
 3. Forests are included in the Concurrent List (Seventh Schedule) of the Constitution of India.

35. Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D**Explanation**

- Theme 2026 - Forests and economies
- Every year on March 21, the world celebrates the International Day of Forests to celebrate all types of forests, recognize the importance of trees and forests, and take action to protect them.
- UNGA proclaimed March 21 as the International Day of Forests in November 2012, with the first official celebration taking place in 2013
- Forests are included in the Concurrent List in the (Seventh Schedule) of the Constitution of India.

36. The theme of World Water Day 2026 is:

- (a) Water and Climate Change
- (b) Valuing Water
- (c) Water and Gender
- (d) Groundwater Sustainability

Answer: C**Explanation**

- March 22 – World Water Day
- To raise awareness about the importance of freshwater and advocate for the sustainable management of freshwater resources.
- Theme - Water and Gender

37. The theme of World Meteorological Day 2026 is:

- (a) Climate Action Now
- (b) Weather, Climate and Water
- (c) Observing Today, Protecting Tomorrow
- (d) Early Warning for All

Answer: C**Explanation**

- March 23 World Meteorological Day [WMO]
- Theme- Observing Today, Protecting Tomorrow
- WMO is headquartered in Geneva, Switzerland.

38. Martyrs' Day (Shaheed Diwas) is observed on 23 March to commemorate:

- (a) Jallianwala Bagh massacre
- (b) Quit India Movement
- (c) Execution of Bhagat Singh, Rajguru, and Sukhdev
- (d) Kakori Conspiracy

Answer: C**Explanation**

- 23rd March Martyrs' Day/ Shaheed Diwas
- To commemorate the execution of Bhagat Singh, Shivaram Rajguru and Sukhdev Thapar.
- The three revolutionary freedom fighters were hanged on this day in 1931 for his involvement in the killing of British officer John Saunders.

39. What is the theme of World Bear Day 2026?

- (a) Save Wildlife, Save Earth
- (b) Protecting Habitats, Preserving Sentience
- (c) Coexistence with Nature
- (d) Wildlife for Future Generations

Answer: B**Explanation**

- 23rd March World Bear Day
- Theme: "Protecting Habitats, Preserving Sentience"

40. Consider the following statements regarding Tuberculosis (TB):

1. TB is caused by a bacterial infection.
2. It affects only the lungs.
3. It is a contagious disease.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 1 and 3 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: B

Explanation

- March 24 - World Tuberculosis (TB) Day
- Theme – 'Yes! We can end TB!' About Tuberculosis (TB)
- Tuberculosis (TB) is a contagious bacterial infection.
- It mainly affects the lungs, but it can affect any part of the body, including the tummy (abdomen), glands, bones and nervous system.
- TB is a potentially serious condition, but it can be cured if it's treated with the right antibiotics.

41. The Week of Solidarity with the Peoples Struggling against Racism and Racial Discrimination is observed during:

- (a) 1–7 January
(b) 21–27 March
(c) 10–16 December
(d) 5–11 June

Answer: B

Explanation

- 21st – 27th March Week of Solidarity with the Peoples Struggling against Racism and Racial Discrimination

42. The International Day of Remembrance of the Victims of Slavery and the Transatlantic Slave Trade is observed on:

- (a) 21 March (b) 25 March
(c) 2 December (d) 10 December

Answer: B

Explanation

- 25 March International Day of Remembrance of the Victims of Slavery and the Transatlantic Slave Trade
- THEME: Justice in Action: Confronting History, Advancing Dignity, Empowering Futures.

43. What is Operation Searchlight?

- (a) A UN peacekeeping mission in South Asia
(b) A Pakistani military crackdown in East Pakistan in 1971
(c) A joint India–Bangladesh military exercise
(d) A diplomatic initiative during the Cold War

Answer: B

Explanation

- March 25: National Genocide Day (Bangladesh)
- To mark the brutal killing of millions of Bangladeshis of the then East Pakistan on 25th March in 1971.
- The Pakistani army, under the leadership of Yahya Khan, launched 'Operation Searchlight' on 25 March all over East Pakistan who were demanding freedom under East Pakistan's Sheikh Mujibur Rahman's Awami League because of the language and cultural differences between the two regions.

44. Gaura Devi played a crucial role in:

- (a) Silent Valley Movement
(b) Appiko Movement
(c) Narmada Bachao Andolan
(d) Chipko Movement

Answer: D

Explanation

- 26 March - Anniversary of the Chipko Movement, The Chipko movement, a pivotal environmental protest against deforestation, began on March 26, 1973, Led by environmental activists such as Sundarlal Bahuguna and Gaura Devi, among others, the movement aimed to prevent the felling of trees in the Himalayan region.

45. Purple Day, observed on March 26, is associated with:

- (a) Cancer awareness
(b) Epilepsy awareness
(c) Mental health awareness
(d) Autism awareness

Answer: B

Explanation

- March 26 - Purple Day of Epilepsy
- Purple Day is an international grassroots effort dedicated to increasing awareness about epilepsy worldwide

46. The theme of the International Day of Zero Waste (30 March) is:

- (a) Plastic Pollution
(b) Food Waste
(c) E-waste Management
(d) Water Conservation

Answer: B

Explanation

- On 14 December 2022, the United Nations General Assembly adopted a resolution at its seventy-seventh session to proclaim 30 March as International Day of Zero Waste
- Theme: Food Waste

Books & Authors

1. Who edited the book “The Other Half of the Coconut: Women Writing Self-Respect History”?

- (a) K. Srilata (b) Gail Omvedt
(c) Kancha Ilaiah (d) Romila Thapar

Answer: A

Explanation

- BOOK - The Other Half of the Coconut: Women Writing Self-Respect History (first published in 2003 and then in 2025),
- Edited by K. Srilata

2. The book That’s a Fire Ant Right There has been translated into English by:

- (a) Arunava Sinha (b) D.V. Subhashri
(c) Daisy Rockwell (d) Meena Kandasamy

Answer: B

Explanation

- Stories by Telugu writer Mohammed Khadeer Babu
- Translated into English by D.V. Subhashri.

3. The book “Mahatma: A Great Communicator” is written by:

- (a) Dr Amitabh Kant (b) Dr Rajiv Kumar
(c) Dr Dhiraj Kakadia (d) Dr S. Jaishankar

Answer: C

Explanation

- Union Minister of Labour and Employment and Youth Affairs and Sports, Dr Mansukh Mandaviya, released a Book titled “Mahatma: A Great Communicator” .
- The Book was written by Additional Director General Akashvani, Dr Dhiraj Kakadia.

4. “An Accidental Lawyer: My Adventures in Law and Life” is the biography of which of the following personalities?

- (a) Fali S. Nariman (b) K. K. Venugopal
(c) Mukul Rohatgi (d) Gopal Subramaniam

Answer: B

Explanation

- K.K. Venugopal biography, titled An Accidental Lawyer: My Adventures in Law and Life, co-authored with Advocate Suhasini Sen

5. The book “The Wealth of Nations” was written by:

- (a) David Ricardo
(b) Adam Smith
(c) John Maynard Keynes
(d) Thomas Malthus

Answer: B

Explanation

- The Wealth of Nations on its 250th anniversary
- Author: Adam Smith

6. The memoir “The Corpse Collector: A True Story” is written by:

- (a) Niyas Kareem and Ministhy S.
(b) Benyamin and S. Hareesh
(c) Vinu P. and Niyas Kareem
(d) Paul Zacharia and K.R. Meera

Answer: C

Explanation

- The memoir, The Corpse Collector: A True Story
- Written by Vinu P. and Niyas Kareem, and translated by Ministhy S.

7. “Theo of Golden” is a work by which author?

- (a) Paulo Coelho (b) Allen Levi
(c) Ruskin Bond (d) Khaled Hosseini

Answer: B

Explanation

Theo of Golden by Allen Levi

8. “Bharat 2026 – A Reference Annual” is released in which of the following languages?

- (a) English and Hindi (b) English and French
(c) Hindi and Sanskrit (d) English, Hindi and Urdu

Answer: A

Explanation

- The Publications Division, Ministry of Information & Broadcasting, Government of India, released the latest edition of its prestigious reference publication “Bharat 2026 – A Reference Annual” in both English and Hindi.

9. Who has authored the book “Karuna: The Power of Compassion”?

- (a) Amartya Sen (b) Arundhati Roy
(c) Kailash Satyarthi (d) Chetan Bhagat

Answer: C

Explanation

- Nobel Peace Prize laureate Kailash Satyarthi has recently released his new book titled “Karuna: The Power of Compassion,”
- Kailash Satyarthi, awarded the Nobel Peace Prize in 2014.

10. People of Gopallapuram is the English translation of a Tamil novel by ____.

- (a) Perumal Murugan
(b) Ashokamitran
(c) Kalki Krishnamurthy
(d) Ki. Rajanarayanan

Answer: D

Explanation

- Book - People of Gopallapuram, (the English translation of Ki. Rajanarayanan’s Tamil novel Gopalapurathu Makkal) , Translator Shubashree Desikan

Appointments

1. José Antonio Kast has assumed office as the new President of

- (a) Peru (b) Chile
(c) Argentina (d) Colombia

Answer: B

Explanation

■ José Antonio Kast has officially taken office as the new President of Chile

2. Who assumed charge as Director General of Naval Armament (DGONA) on 01 March 2026?

- (a) Shri B.P. Singh
(b) Shri Divakar Jayant
(c) Vice Admiral Dinesh Tripathi
(d) Shri Ajay Kumar

Answer: A

Explanation

■ Shri B.P. Singh Assumed Charge as Director General of Naval Armament (DGONA) at Naval Headquarters, New Delhi, on 01 Mar 2026. An officer of the 1994 batch of the Indian Naval Armament Service (INAS).

3. Who became the first Kashmiri woman to head the high- security Central Jail Srinagar?

- (a) Saba Shawl (b) Hina Bhat
(c) Tasleema Akhter (d) Nuzhat Gul

Answer: A

Explanation

■ Jammu and Kashmir's prison administration, Saba Shawl has been appointed as Superintendent of Central Jail Srinagar, becoming the first Kashmiri woman to head the high-security correctional facility.

4. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code given below:

List-I (Person)	List-II (Appointed as)
A. Shiv Pratap Shukla	1. Governor of Bihar
B. Jishnu Dev Varma	2. Governor of Nagaland
C. Nand Kishore Yadav	3. Governor of Telangana
D. Syed Ata Hasnain	4. Governor of Maharashtra

Codes:

- (a) A-3, B-4, C-2, D-1
(b) A-4, B-3, C-2, D-1
(c) A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
(d) A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation

- President Droupadi Murmu has appointed Governors in different States and Union Territories.
 - The Governor of Himachal Pradesh, Shiv Pratap Shukla, has been appointed as Governor of Telangana.
 - Telangana Governor Jishnu Dev Varma has been appointed Governor of Maharashtra.
 - Former Bihar Assembly Speaker Nand Kishore Yadav has been appointed as Governor of Nagaland.
 - Lieutenant General (Retired) Syed Ata Hasnain has been appointed as Governor of Bihar.
5. Who has been selected as the new Supreme Leader of Iran?
- (a) Hassan Rouhani (b) Ebrahim Raisi
(c) Mohammad Khatami (d) Mojtaba Khamenei

Answer: D

Explanation

- Iran names Khamenei's son, Mojtaba, as new supreme leader
- Mojtaba Khamenei, the second son of Ayatollah Ali Khamenei, who was killed on the first day of the war that the United States and Israel launched on Iran, has been selected as Iran's new supreme leader.

6. Balendra "Balen" Shah, recently seen in the news, has become the Prime Minister of which country?

- (a) Bhutan (b) Nepal
(c) Sri Lanka (d) Bangladesh

Answer: B

Explanation

- Balendra "Balen" Shah (leader of the Rastriya Swatantra Party - RSP) is set to become the next Prime Minister of Nepal
 - In Nepal, Prime Ministerial candidate of the Rashtriya Swatantra Party (RSP), Balendra Shah, has been elected the House of Representatives (HoR) Member from Jhapa constituency
7. Who has become the first woman Chief Superintendent overseeing the operations of a functional nuclear power plant under the Nuclear Power Corporation of India Limited (NPCIL)?
- (a) Nirmala Sitharaman (b) RM Nachammai
(c) Tessy Thomas (d) Anuradha TK

Answer: B

Explanation

- RM Nachammai has created history by becoming the first woman chief superintendent looking after the operations of a functional nuclear power plant under the Nuclear Power Corporation of India Ltd (NPCIL).

- Nachammai takes charge as Chief Superintendent of Karnataka's Kaiga Generating Station Units 3 and 4, effective March 15,

8. Who has taken over as the interim CEO of IndiGo after Pieter Elbers stepped down?

- (a) Rakesh Gangwal
- (b) Rahul Bhatia
- (c) Aditya Ghosh
- (d) Vikram Singh Mehta

Answer: B**Explanation**

- IndiGo CEO Pieter Elbers stepped down from his role, The airline's promoter and Managing Director, Rahul Bhatia, will assume charge of the airline's management in the interim (Interim CEO)

9. Senior Advocate Menaka Guruswamy became the first Member of Parliament elected on a ticket from the All India Trinamool Congress.

- (a) Anglo-Indian
- (b) LGBTQ
- (c) Dalit
- (d) Tribal

Answer: B**Explanation**

- Senior Advocate Menaka Guruswamy was elected to the Rajya Sabha on a ticket by the All India Trinamool Congress, become the country's first member from the LGBTQ community to be elected as a Member of Parliament.

10. Dr. Partha Biswas has recently assumed charge as:

- (a) Member, National Commission for Scheduled Tribes
- (b) Member, National Commission for Scheduled Castes
- (c) Chairperson, National Commission for Backward Classes
- (d) Member, National Human Rights Commission

Answer: B**Explanation**

- Dr. Partha Biswas assumed charge as Member of the National Commission for Scheduled Castes (NCSC)
- The National Commission for Scheduled Castes (NCSC) was established under Article 338 of the Constitution of India.

11. Who has been elected as the Prime Minister of Thailand?

- (a) Anutin Charnvirakul
- (b) Srettha Thavisin
- (c) Prayut Chan-o-cha
- (d) Abhisit Vejjajiva

Answer: A**Explanation**

- Mr. Anutin Charnvirakul elected as Prime Minister of the Kingdom of Thailand
- Capital City: Bangkok.

12. Who has been appointed as India's new Ambassador to China?

- (a) Harsh Vardhan Shringla
- (b) Vikram Doraiswami
- (c) Pradeep Kumar Rawat
- (d) Vinay Mohan Kwatra

Answer: B**Explanation**

- Senior diplomat Vikram Doraiswami has been appointed as India's new ambassador to China.
- He will succeed Pradeep Kumar Rawat.

13. Bhumika Shrestha recently made headlines for becoming

- (a) first LGBTQ activist from India to win a UN award
- (b) first transgender woman member of parliament in Nepal
- (c) first gender rights activist in South Asia
- (d) first woman minister in Nepal

Answer: B**Explanation**

- Bhumika Shrestha, a 37-year-old LGBTQ rights activist, has made history by becoming Nepal's first transgender woman member of parliament.
- Bhumika Shrestha is a prominent transgender rights advocate from Nepal who has long worked for the dignity and recognition of sexual minorities.

14. Atanu Chakraborty, who recently resigned as part-time chairman and independent director, was associated with which bank?

- (a) State Bank of India
- (b) ICICI Bank
- (c) HDFC Bank
- (d) Axis Bank

Answer: C**Explanation**

- HDFC Bank's part-time chairman and independent director Atanu Chakraborty resigned with immediate effect.

15. Sarah Mullally was recently in news for becoming:

- (a) First female Prime Minister of the UK
- (b) First female Archbishop of Canterbury
- (c) First woman Pope
- (d) First female head of the Anglican Communion

Answer: B

Explanation

- Sarah Mullally was enthroned as the Church of England's first female Archbishop of Canterbury, taking the helm as the spiritual leader of 85 million Anglicans worldwide in a historic ceremony blending tradition with global symbolism.

16. Shri Periasamy Kumaran has been appointed as the High Commissioner of India to which country?

- (a) United Kingdom
- (b) United States
- (c) Australia
- (d) Canada

Answer: A

Explanation

- Shri Periasamy Kumaran (IFS:1992), presently Secretary in the Ministry, has been appointed as the next High Commissioner of India to the United Kingdom.

17. Who has assumed charge as the Chairperson of the National Commission for Backward Classes (NCBC)?

- (a) Smriti Irani
- (b) Sadhvi Niranjana Jyoti
- (c) Meenakshi Lekhi
- (d) Nirmala Sitharaman

- Sadhvi Niranjana Jyoti has assumed charge as Chairperson and Mrs. Kiran Umesh Mahalle has assumed charge as Member of the National Commission for Backward Classes (NCBC) with effect from 18.03.2026 & 20.03.2026, respectively.

18. Kompella Venkata Ramana Murthy, recently in news, has been appointed as:

- (a) Governor of RBI
- (b) Whole-time member of SEBI
- (c) Chairman of UPSC
- (d) Finance Secretary

Answer: B

Explanation

- The government has appointed Kompella Venkata Ramana Murthy as a whole-time member of Sebi for a period of three years.
- With this addition, the regulatory board now has its full team of four full-time members.
- The other three whole-time members are Amarjeet Singh, Kamlesh Chandra Varshney, and Sandip Pradhan.

Awards

1. Consider the following statements regarding the Jnanpith Award:

1. R. Vairamuthu has been selected for the 60th Jnanpith Award.

2. The award carries a cash prize of ₹11 lakh, a bronze statue of Goddess Vagdevi, and a citation.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Explanation

- Poet and lyricist R. Vairamuthu has been selected for the prestigious 60th Jnanpith Award for the year 2025, becoming the third Tamil writer to receive the country's highest literary honour.
- The award carries with it a cash of Rs 11 lakh, a bronze statue of the Hindu Goddess Vagdevi and a citation.

2. Consider the following pairs regarding the Sahitya Akademi Awards 2025:

Author	Work
1. Mamta Kalia	Jeete Jee Allahabad
2. Navtej Sarna	Crimson Spring
3. Pritpal Singh Betab	Safar Jaari Hai
4. Devabrat Das	Karhi Khelar Sadhu

3. Which of the pairs given above are correctly matched?

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 only
- (b) 1, 2 and 4 only
- (c) 2, 3 and 4 only
- (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: D

Explanation

- Recently, the Sahitya Akademi has announced its annual Sahitya Akademi Awards in 24 Indian languages recognised by it.
- Prominent writer Mamta Kalia will be awarded for her Hindi memoir Jeete Jee Allahabad.
- The noted diplomat Navtej Sarna will be awarded for his English novel Crimson Spring.

- The award will also be conferred to the Urdu Poetry titled Safar Jaari Hai by Pritpal Singh Betab.
- Devabrat Das for his novel Karhi Khelar Sadhu in the Assamese language and Prasun Bandyopadhyay for his Bengali poetry Shrestha Kabita.

4. Which Indian athlete was named 'Para Archer of the Year 2025' by World Archery?

- (a) Deepika Kumari
- (b) Sheetal Devi
- (c) Jyothi Surekha Vennam
- (d) Aditi Swami

Answer: B

Explanation

- India's Sheetal Devi has been named 'Para Archer of the Year 2025' by World Archery. The 2025 World Archery Awards, launched in 2011, honour excellence and outstanding contributions to the sport, celebrating the athletes who have defined the international archery season.

5. Which Indian author was awarded the United States National Book Critics Circle Award (2026) in the Autobiography category?

- (a) Kiran Desai
- (b) Arundhati Roy
- (c) Jhumpa Lahiri
- (d) Anita Desai

Answer: B

Explanation

- Indian Booker-winning novelist Arundhati Roy was awarded the United States National Book Critics Circle award for her memoir, Mother Mary Comes to Me in the Autobiography section.

6. Consider the following statements regarding Rashtriya Vigyan Puraskar (RVP):

1. Vigyan Yuva–Shanti Swarup Bhatnagar (VY-SSB) category is meant to encourage young scientists up to 65 years of age.
2. Vigyan Ratna (VR) is awarded for lifetime achievements in science and technology.
3. Persons of Indian Origin (PIOs) living abroad are also eligible for the award.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 2 and 3 only
- (b) 1 and 2 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A

Explanation

- The central government has opened nominations for the Rashtriya Vigyan Puraskar (RVP) 2026
- People of Indian Origin staying abroad with

exceptional contributions benefiting the Indian communities or society shall also be eligible for the awards.

- Vigyan Yuva–Shanti Swarup Bhatnagar (VY-SSB): To encourage young scientists (up to 45 years) showing exceptional promise.

- Vigyan Ratna (VR): For lifetime achievements in science and technology.

7. Which web series won the Best Web Series award at the Critics' Choice Awards 2026?

- (a) Paatal Lok S2
- (b) Khauf
- (c) Black Warrant
- (d) Sacred Games

Answer: C

Explanation

- The Film Critics Guild announced the winners of the 8th Critics' Choice Awards 2026. Leading was Homebound, which bagged four major honours — Best Film, Best Director for Neeraj Ghaywan, Best Actor for Vishal Jethwa, and Best Supporting Actress for Shalini Vatsa.

Web Series

- Best Web Series: Black Warrant
- Best Director: Vikramaditya Motwane, Satyanshu Singh, Arkesh Ajay, Rohin Raveendran Nair, Ambiecka Pandit —Black Warrant
- Best Actor: Jaideep Ahlawat — Paatal Lok S2
- Best Actress: Monika Panwar — Khauf

8. Which bank received the National Award for Outstanding Performance in Self-Help Group (SHG) Bank Linkage (2024– 25)?

- (a) NABARD
- (b) Karnataka Grameena Bank
- (c) State Bank of India
- (d) Canara Bank

Answer: B

Explanation

- Karnataka Grameena Bank has been honoured with the National Award for Outstanding Performance in Self-Help Group (SHG) Bank Linkage for 2024–25 by the Union Ministry of Rural Development.

9. Adani Gangavaram Port Limited (AGPL) received the Gold Award for 'Best Safety Performer 2025' in which category at the CII Andhra Pradesh Industrial Safety Excellence Awards?

- (a) Energy
- (b) Ports and Logistics
- (c) Manufacturing
- (d) Infrastructure

Answer: B

Explanation

- Adani Gangavaram Port Limited (AGPL) has been honored with the Gold Award for 'Best Safety Performer 2025' in the Ports and Logistics category at the CII Andhra Pradesh Industrial Safety Excellence Awards. The port has integrated advanced safety protocols, including technology-driven monitoring, a vehicle management system focused on driver wellness, and robust emergency response mechanisms.

10. Who was honoured with the Lifetime Achievement Award at the International Film Festival of Delhi (IFFD) 2026?

- (a) Chiranjeevi
(b) Rajinikanth
(c) Nandamuri Balakrishna
(d) Mohanlal

Answer: C

Explanation

- Veteran Telugu actor Nandamuri Balakrishna was honoured with the Lifetime Achievement Award at the International Film Festival of Delhi (IFFD) 2026.
- The recognition marks his remarkable contribution to Indian cinema spanning five decades.

11. At the BRICS CCI WE Annual Women Summit 2026, the "Trailblazer: Living Legend" award was conferred upon:

- (a) Kalpana Soren
(b) Shabana Azmi
(c) Debjani Ghosh
(d) Sudha Murty

Answer: B

Explanation

- Jharkhand MLA Kalpana Soren was honoured with the 'Women Empowerment Trailblazer Award' at the BRICS CCI WE Annual Women Summit and Felicitation 2026
- Veteran actor Shabana Azmi, honoured with the "Trailblazer: Living Legend" award.
- Debjani Ghosh, recipient of the Lifetime Achievement Award.

12. Who won Outstanding Performance by a Male Actor in a Leading Role at the Actor Awards 2026?

- (a) Michael B. Jordan
(b) Cillian Murphy
(c) Ryan Gosling
(d) Bradley Cooper

Answer: A

Explanation

- The Actor Awards 2026, previously known as the Screen Actors Guild Awards (SAG Awards), took place on March 1 at the Shrine Auditorium in Los Angeles.
- Catherine O'Hara wins posthumous Best Actress award - The late actor won the Actors Award for Best Female Actor in a Comedy Series for her role in The Studio.

Category**Winner**

Outstanding performance by a male actor in a leading role	Michael B. Jordan, Sinners
Outstanding performance by a female actor in a leading role	Jessie Buckley, Hamnet

13. Which city recently entered the Guinness World Records by planting 2,51,446 saplings within one hour?

- (a) Lucknow (b) Prayagraj
(c) Varanasi (d) Kanpur

Answer: C

Explanation

- Varanasi has entered the Guinness World Records by planting 2,51,446 saplings within one hour during a mega plantation drive at the Sujabad Domari area surpassing China's 2018 record of 1,53,981 saplings.
- The plantation was carried out over nearly 350 bighas.

14. Which film won the Best International Film award at the 53rd Saturn Awards?

- (a) Parasite 2
(b) Sisu 2: Road to Revenge
(c) The Zone of Interest
(d) All Quiet on the Western Front

Answer: B

Explanation

- The 53rd Saturn Awards were announced on March 8, 2026 at Universal Hilton in Los Angeles, California.

CATEGORY**WINNER**

Best Independent Film	Dust Bunny (Roadside Attractions / Lionsgate)
Best International Film	Sisu 2: Road to Revenge (Screen Gems / Sony Pictures)
Best International Animated Film	Demon Slayer: Kimetsu no Yaiba Infinity Castle (Crunchyroll / Sony Pictures)

15. Recently seen in the news, “Fancy,” recognized by Guinness World Records, is known for which of the following achievements?

- (a) World’s fastest racing horse
- (b) World’s oldest living horse
- (c) First cloned horse in the world
- (d) Tallest horse ever recorded

Answer: B

Explanation

- At 37 years old, Fancy — she’s officially the world’s oldest living horse, recognised by Guinness World Records, the Virginia-based Quarter Horse earned the title at 37 and is set to turn 38 in April 2026.

16. Who will receive the Lifetime Achievement Award at the 21st Mahindra Excellence in Theatre Awards (META) 2026?

- (a) Naseeruddin Shah
- (b) Amol Palekar
- (c) Anupam Kher
- (d) Paresh Rawal

Answer: B

Explanation

- Veteran actor, director and theatre practitioner Amol Palekar will be honoured with the Lifetime Achievement Award at the 21st Mahindra Excellence in Theatre Awards (META) 2026.
- The prestigious theatre festival will be held in New Delhi from 19 to 25 March 2026.

17. Sportstar Aces Awards 2026 – Best State for Promotion of Sports was awarded to:

- (a) Haryana
- (b) Odisha
- (c) Bihar
- (d) Gujarat

Answer: C

Explanation

- The eighth edition of the Sportstar Aces Awards 2026 was held at the Taj Mahal Palace

Category	Winner
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Best State for Promotion of Sports	Bihar
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Sportsman of the Year (Olympic Sports)	Samrat Rana (Shooting).
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Sportswoman of the Year (Olympic Sports)	Shared by Mirabai Chanu (Weightlifting) and Suruchi Singh (Shooting).
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Sportswoman of the Year (Team Sports)	Deepti Sharma (Cricket).
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18. Consider the following pairs regarding the BCCI Naman

Awards (2026):

1. Polly Umrigar Award (Best International Men’s Cricketer) — Shubman Gill
2. Col. C. K. Nayudu Lifetime Achievement Award — Rahul Dravid

3. Best International Debut (Men) — Harshit Rana

Which of the pair/s given above is/are correctly matched?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 1 and 2 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation

The BCCI Naman Awards 2026

- The BCCI Naman Awards 2026 were celebrated the achievements and contributions of Indian cricket with grand ceremony held in New Delhi on March 15 2026

Category	Winner
Polly Umrigar Award (Best international men’s cricketer)	Shubman Gill
Col. C.K. Nayudu Lifetime Achievement Award	Rahul Dravid
Best International Debut in 2024-25 – Men	Harshit Rana

19. Which film won the Best International Feature Film award at the 98th Academy Awards?

- (a) The Secret Agent
- (b) Sentimental Value
- (c) Sinners
- (d) Mr. Nobody Against Putin

Answer: B

Explanation.

- All the Oscar winners at the 98th Academy Awards

Category	Winner
Best Picture	'One Battle After Another'
Best Actress	Jessie Buckley
Best Actor	Michael B. Jordan
Best Director	Paul Thomas Anderson
Best International Feature Film	'Sentimental Value'

20. The Sikkimese film “Shape of Momo”, recently seen in news, is directed by:

- (a) Tribeny Rai
- (b) Pa. Ranjith
- (c) Prashant Nair
- (d) Rima Das

Answer: A

Explanation

- Sikkimese film ‘Shape of Momo’ continues its successful journey on the international festival circuit, adding new selections across Europe after its earlier screening at the Glasgow Film Festival.
- Sikkimese film ‘Shape of Momo’ directed by Tribeny Rai

21. Which airport was named the World's Best Airport in the Skytrax World Airport Awards 2026?

- (a) Hamad International Airport
- (b) Tokyo Haneda Airport
- (c) Singapore Changi Airport
- (d) Dubai International Airport

Answer: C**Explanation**

- Hyderabad's Rajiv Gandhi International Airport (RGIA) has once again secured global recognition, winning the 'Best Airport Staff in India and South Asia 2026' award at the Skytrax World Airport Awards.
- Singapore Changi Airport has been named the world's best airport for the second consecutive year in the 2026 Skytrax

22. Consider the following statements regarding the Stockholm Water Prize:**1. It has been awarded annually since 1991.****2. It is awarded only to European countries.****Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?**

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A**Explanation**

- Kaveh Madani has been named the 2026 recipient of the Stockholm Water Prize

- He is the youngest laureate and first UN official to receive the award for linking water science with policy, diplomacy, and public outreach.
- It has been presented annually since 1991.
- It is awarded by the Stockholm Water Foundation in collaboration with the Royal Swedish Academy of Sciences.
- The Prize is awarded to a person or organization who contributes to the conservation and protection of water resources, and to the well-being of the planet and its inhabitants.
- Everyone who has made extraordinary water-related achievements is eligible.

23. Who has been awarded the Mark Lynton History Prize 2026?

- (a) Ramachandra Guha
- (b) Romila Thapar
- (c) William Dalrymple
- (d) Irfan Habib

Answer: C**Explanation**

- Historian William Dalrymple has been awarded the 2026 Mark Lynton History Prize for his book "The Golden Road: How Ancient India Transformed the World" for combining "literary grace, commitment to serious research and social concern".
- The Mark Lynton History Prize is an annual USD 10,000 award given to a book "of history, on any subject, that best combines intellectual or scholarly distinction with felicity of expression".

Obituaries**1. Kushal Das, who recently passed away, was associated with which organization?**

- (a) BCCI – Board of Control for Cricket in India
- (b) AIFF – All India Football Federation
- (c) FIFA – Fédération Internationale de Football Association
- (d) IOA – Indian Olympic Association

Answer: B**Explanation**

- Former All India Football Federation (AIFF) General Secretary Kushal Das passed away at the age of 66.
- Das served the federation for 12 years spanning 2010 to 2022.

2. Renowned Urdu writer Jeelani Bano, who passed away recently, was honoured with the Padma Shri in which year?

- (a) 1995
- (b) 2001
- (c) 2010
- (d) 2015

Answer: B**Explanation**

- Renowned Urdu writer Jeelani Bano passes away at 90
- She received the Padma Shri in 2001.

3. Ayatollah Ali Khamenei, who reportedly died recently, was the Supreme Leader of which country?

- (a) Iraq
- (b) Iran
- (c) Syria
- (d) Saudi Arabia

Answer: B**Explanation.**

- Iranian Supreme Leader Ayatollah Ali Khamenei died following a major attack by Israel and the United States.
- Ayatollah Ali Khamenei had been Iran's hardline spiritual guide and top political authority since 1989, when he succeeded Ayatollah Ruhollah Khomeini as supreme leader.

4. Senior Congress leader K. P. Unnikrishnan, who recently passed away, hailed from which state?

- (a) Tamil Nadu
- (b) Kerala
- (c) Karnataka
- (d) Andhra Pradesh

Answer: B

Explanation

- Senior Congress leader, socialist and seven-term parliamentarian K P Unnikrishnan died in Kozhikode, He was 89.
- Represented Kerala's Vadakara Lok Sabha constituency for seven consecutive terms from 1971 to 1996.

5. Eminent historian and Indologist Prof Hermann Kulke, who recently passed away, was awarded which civilian honour in 2010?

- (a) Padma Shri
- (b) Padma Bhushan
- (c) Padma Vibhushan
- (d) Bharat Ratna

Answer: A

Explanation

- Eminent historian and Indologist, Prof Hermann Kulke, considered the foremost global voice of Odisha's culture and history, died. He was 87 years old.
- He was based in Odisha for several years and was conferred with the Padma Shri in 2010.

6. Lance Havildar K. G. George, who recently passed away, was honoured with which gallantry award for his role in the Indo-Pakistani War of 1965?

- (a) Param Vir Chakra
- (b) Maha Vir Chakra
- (c) Vir Chakra
- (d) Ashoka Chakra

Answer: C

Explanation

- Lance Havildar K.G. George (retd), who was awarded a Vir Chakra for his heroics in the 1965 India-Pakistan War, passed away in Kerala at the age of 95.
- Vir Chakra is the country's third highest wartime gallantry award.

7. S. Thyagarajan, who recently passed away, was associated with which newspaper?

- (a) Indian Express
- (b) The Hindu
- (c) Times of India
- (d) Hindustan Times

Answer: B

Explanation

- S. Thyagarajan, 85, veteran sports correspondent, who worked with The Hindu for more than five decades, passed away

- Specialised in covering hockey

8. Surikumeri K. Govinda Bhat, who recently passed away, was associated with which art form?

- (a) Kathakali
- (b) Yakshagana
- (c) Bharatanatyam
- (d) Kuchipudi

Answer: B

Explanation

- Senior Yakshagana artist Surikumeri K. Govinda Bhat passed away at Heddur, near Tirthahalli.

- A recipient of the Kendra Sangeet Natak Akademi Award for 2016 and Karnataka Rajyotsava Award for 2008

9. Vijaypat Singhania, recently in news, was associated with which sector?

- (a) Information Technology
- (b) Textile and Fashion Industry
- (c) Aviation Manufacturing
- (d) Banking

Answer: B

Explanation

- Air Commodore (Dr.) Vijaypat Singhania, recipient of Padma Bhushan, former chairman of Raymond Group and former Sheriff of Bombay passed away

- He held the world record for highest altitude gained in a hot air balloon and winning the gold medal in an around-the-world air race.

10. Tracy Kidder, who recently passed away, was associated with which of the following fields?

- (a) Literature
- (b) Politics
- (c) Science
- (d) Sports

Answer: A

Explanation

- Pulitzer-winning author Tracy Kidder, who turned unlikely subjects into bestsellers, dies at 80, Kidder won the Pulitzer Prize and the National Book Award for his 1981 work "The

National

1. The mascots 'Pragati' and 'Vikas' are associated with which of the following initiatives in India?

- (a) Digital India Mission
- (b) National Population Register
- (c) National Family Health Survey
- (d) Census of India

Answer: D

Explanation

- Union Home Minister Amit Shah launched four digital tools that will drive the country's first fully digital Census, with the first phase starting April 1.
 - The Census will be conducted in two phases – houselisting and housing census from April to September 2026, and population enumeration (PE) in February 2027.
 - The mascots — 'Pragati' (female) and 'Vikas' (male) — symbolise equal participation of women and men in fulfilling the resolve to make India a developed nation by 2047.
- 2. India's first-ever standards for cloud computing, data centre performance, and ethical AI deployment were notified by:**

- (a) NITI Aayog
- (b) Bureau of Indian Standards
- (c) Ministry of Electronics and IT
- (d) Telecom Regulatory Authority of India

Answer: B

Explanation

- The Indian government, through the Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS), notified the nation's first-ever standards for cloud computing, data centre performance, and ethical AI deployment.
 - The notification under the BIS Rules, 2018, establishes a voluntary but formal framework for digital infrastructure.
- 3. Who has been invited as the Chief Guest for the Raisina Dialogue 2026?**
- (a) Olaf Scholz
 - (b) Emmanuel Macron
 - (c) Alexander Stubb
 - (d) Justin Trudeau

Answer: C

Explanation

- 11th Edition of the Raisina Dialogue 2026 Organized by the Observer Research Foundation in partnership with the Ministry of External Affairs.
- The theme for 2026 is "Saṃskāra: Assertion, Accommodation, Advancement".

- Finland President Alexander Stubb will be the Chief Guest of the premier geopolitical forum.

4. Consider the following statements about the Bureau of Energy Efficiency (BEE):

- 1. It is a statutory body under the Ministry of Power.**
- 2. It was established under the Energy Conservation Act, 2001.**

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Explanation

- Recently, the 25th Foundation Day of the Bureau of Energy Efficiency (BEE), Ministry of Power, Government of India, was celebrated in New Delhi on 1st march.
 - It is a statutory body which was established in 2002 under the provisions of the Energy Conservation Act, 2001.
 - Nodal Ministry: Ministry of Power.
- 5. The Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana (PMMSY) was launched in which year?**
- (a) 2018
 - (b) 2019
 - (c) 2020
 - (d) 2021

Answer: C

Explanation

- The Union Government has allocated ₹2,500 crore for the fisheries sector under the Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana (PMMSY) in the Union Budget 2026– 27.
 - PM Matsya Sampada Yojana (PMMSY) is a flagship umbrella scheme for the sustainable and responsible development of India's fisheries sector, designed to modernize the fisheries value chain and improve the socio-economic welfare of fishers and fish farmers.
 - Launched in: The scheme was launched on 10 September 2020.
- 6. The Union Cabinet has approved the extension of the Jal Jeevan Mission (JJM) till which year?**
- (a) 2026
 - (b) 2027
 - (c) 2028
 - (d) 2030

Answer: C

Explanation

- The Union Cabinet approved the extension of Jal Jeevan Mission (JJM) till 2028, with an allocation of Rs 1.51 lakh crore.

- Launched in August 2019, the JJM aimed to provide Functional Household Tap Connections (FHTC) to deliver 55 litres per capita per day (lpcd) drinking water to all rural households in the country by 2024.

- It is a Centrally Sponsored Scheme, implemented by the Ministry of Jal Shakti.

7. Consider the following statements regarding the removal of the Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) in India:

1. The procedure for removal is provided under Article 324(5) of the Constitution of India.
2. The Chief Election Commissioner can be removed in the same manner and on the same grounds as a Judge of the Supreme Court of India.

8. Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Explanation

- The INDIA bloc parties, led by the Trinamool Congress, are set to move an impeachment motion against Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar.
 - The removal of the CEC is a formal, quasi-judicial process designed to ensure the independence of the Election Commission of India (ECI) from executive interference.
 - To protect the sanctity of the democratic process, the CEC is granted security of tenure similar to that of a judge of the Supreme Court of India.
 - Article 324(5): This article explicitly states that the Chief Election Commissioner shall not be removed from his office except in like manner and on the like grounds as a Judge of the Supreme Court.
- 9. Under the Viksit Bharat — Guarantee for Rozgar and Aajeevika Mission (Gramin) Act, 2025, rural households are provided a statutory guarantee of wage employment for up to how many days in a financial year?**
- (a) 90 days (b) 100 days
(c) 125 days (d) 150 days

Answer: C

Explanation

- The Rural Development Ministry said a logo design competition for the Viksit Bharat-Guarantee for Rozgar and Aajeevika Mission (Gramin) Act (VB-G RAM G) has been launched.
- The Viksit Bharat — Guarantee for Rozgar and Aajeevika Mission (Gramin) Act, 2025, replaces

the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act, 2005

- It provides a statutory guarantee of up to 125 days of wage employment in a financial year to rural households whose adult members volunteer for unskilled manual work.

10. The term “Sarpanch Pati” refers to:

- (a) Husband of a Sarpanch who assists in village administration
- (b) Male relatives exercising authority on behalf of elected women sarpanches
- (c) Male candidates contesting elections against women
- (d) Government-appointed village administrators

Answer: B

Explanation

- The Union government has launched a nationwide social media campaign to address the practice of “Sarpanch Pati”, where male relatives exercise authority in place of elected women leaders in village governance.
- Announced by the Ministry of Panchayati Raj (MoPR), the campaign titled “Say No To Proxy Sarpanch” aims to empower women sarpanches and strengthen democratic participation in grassroots governance.

11. The Sashakt Panchayat–Netri Abhiyan was launched on:

- (a) January 26, 2025 (b) March 4, 2025
(c) August 15, 2025 (d) October 2, 2025

Answer: B

Explanation

- The Sashakt Panchayat–Netri Abhiyan was launched on March 4, 2025, as a targeted capacity-building initiative aimed at strengthening the leadership and governance role of women elected representatives at the grassroots.

12. The “Blue Book” in India refers to:

- (a) A manual for parliamentary procedures
- (b) A confidential protocol and security manual for visits of high constitutional authorities
- (c) A document outlining financial rules of the government
- (d) A handbook for election procedures

Answer: B

Explanation

- The Blue Book is a confidential protocol and security manual issued by the Union Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA).
- It lays down detailed procedures for the reception, security, and logistics during visits of the President, Vice-President, and Prime Minister within India.

13. The Jal Mahotsav campaign is organised under which of the following taglines?

- (a) जल है तो कल है
- (b) गाँव का उत्सव, देश का महोत्सव
- (c) हर घर जल, हर घर खुशहाल
- (d) जल संरक्षण, राष्ट्र निर्माण

Answer: B

Explanation

- Union Minister of Jal Shakti, Shri C. R. Paatil, marked the Shubharambh of Jal Mahotsav 2026, a nationwide campaign of the Department of Drinking Water and Sanitation (DDWS), Ministry of Jal Shakti, from Gujarat.
- Jal Mahotsav campaign will be observed annually from 8th to 22nd March.
- Under the tagline “गाँव का उत्सव, देश का महोत्सव”.

14. The Sexual Harassment Incident Notification for Empowerment (SHINE) app has been launched by which organisation?

- (a) Ministry of Women and Child Development
- (b) Ministry of Labour and Employment
- (c) National Commission for Women
- (d) Indian Railways

Answer: D

Explanation

- The Indian Railways has launched Sexual Harassment Incident Notification for Empowerment (SHINE) a customised app for women employees to lodge complaints about sexual harassment at the workplace.
- Sexual Harassment Incident Notification for Empowerment (SHINE) was made operational on the occasion of the International Women's Day on Sunday (March 8, 2026).

15. C-DOT functions under which ministry/department of the Government of India?

- (a) Department of Science and Technology
- (b) Department of Telecommunications
- (c) Ministry of Electronics and IT
- (d) Department of Space

Answer: B

Explanation

- India's Centre for Development of Telematics (C-DOT) received global recognition at the Mobile World Congress 2026 in Barcelona for its AI-driven fraud detection solution Fraud Pro.
- C-DOT is India's premier telecom research and development (R&D) organization working on indigenous telecom technologies and digital

network solutions.

- It functions as an autonomous telecom technology centre under the Department of Telecommunications (DoT).
- Established in August 1984 by the Government of India.

16. Which country was announced as the Partner Country for AAHAR 2026?

- (a) France
- (b) Germany
- (c) Italy
- (d) Japan

Answer: C

Explanation

- The Union Commerce & Industry Minister Piyush Goyal will inaugurate the 40th edition of AAHAR 2026, one of the world's premier B2B trade platforms for the food and hospitality industry, on March 10 at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi.
 - Italy will feature as the Partner Country for AAHAR 2026
- 17. The SWAYATT initiative (Startups, Women and Youth Advantage through e-Transactions) is associated with which platform?**
- (a) Digital India
 - (b) Government e-Marketplace (GeM)
 - (c) Startup India Portal
 - (d) National Single Window System

Answer: B

Explanation

- Recently, the Government e-Marketplace (GeM) celebrated the seven-year journey of its flagship initiative, SWAYATT – Startups, Women and Youth Advantage through e-Transactions.
- SWAYATT Initiative was launched in February 2019.
- It was conceptualised with a clear objective of invigorating participation of women-led enterprises and youth in public procurement.
- It democratizes government procurement by enabling startups, women entrepreneurs, youth, Micro and Small Enterprises (MSEs), Self Help Groups (SHGs) and last-mile sellers to directly participate in the public procurement ecosystem through Government e-Marketplace.
- It is rooted in GeM's foundational pillar of social inclusion

18. The 'Dirghavadhi Krishak Punji Sahakar Yojana' has been launched by:

- (a) National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (NABARD)
- (b) Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare
- (c) National Cooperative Development Corporation (NCDC)
- (d) Reserve Bank of India (RBI)

Answer: C

Explanation

- National Cooperative Development Corporation a statutory organization working under administrative control of Ministry of Cooperation launched 'Dirghavadhi Krishak Punji Sahakar Yojana' to ensure increased and uninterrupted credit flow for capital formation in agriculture and allied sectors.

19. In the budgetary process, the Appropriation Bill is introduced after:

- (a) Presentation of the Annual Financial Statement in Parliament
- (b) General discussion on the Budget in both Houses
- (c) Voting on Demands for Grants in the Lok Sabha
- (d) Approval of the Budget by the President

Answer: C**Explanation****Budgetary Process:**

- Presentation: The Finance Minister presents the Annual Financial Statement (Budget).
- Discussion: General discussion takes place in both Houses.
- Voting on Demands for Grants: The Lok Sabha votes on the specific expenditure requests of various ministries.
- Introduction of the Bill: Once the Demands for Grants are voted upon, the Appropriation Bill is introduced in the Lok Sabha.

20. Consider the following statements regarding the Jan Vishwas (Amendment of Provisions) Bill, 2025:

1. It seeks to amend various laws to decriminalise and rationalise minor offences.
2. It provides for an automatic increase of 10 per cent in fines and penalties every three years to maintain deterrence.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C**Explanation****Government Withdraws Jan Vishwas Amendment Bill 2025**

- Union Minister Piyush Goyal will move a motion in the Lok Sabha seeking permission to withdraw The Jan Vishwas (Amendment of Provisions) Bill, 2025, as Parliament continues the second phase of the Union Budget 2026-27 session.

- The Bill, originally introduced in 2025, seeks to amend various laws to decriminalise and rationalise minor offences, with the aim of promoting trust-based governance and improving ease of living and doing business.

Key Features of the Bill

- First-time contraventions: For 76 offences under 10 different Acts, the Bill provides that first-time violations will attract only an advisory or warning instead of punishment.
- Decriminalization of minor offences: Removes imprisonment clauses with monetary penalties or warnings for minor, technical, and procedural defaults.
- E.g., Some Acts like the Tea Act, 1953, Legal Metrology Act, 2009 (already amended in 2023 are further decriminalized).
- Rationalization of penalties: Fines are rationalized and made proportionate, with incremental penalties for repeat offences.
- Automatic revision of fines: Provides for an automatic increase of 10 per cent in fines and penalties every three year which ensures that penalties remain effective as a deterrent without the need for frequent legislative amendments.

21. In India, which of the following statements regarding euthanasia is correct?

- (a) Both active and passive euthanasia are legal
- (b) Active euthanasia is legal but passive euthanasia is illegal
- (c) Passive euthanasia is permitted under strict safeguards
- (d) Both active and passive euthanasia are illegal

Answer: C**Explanation**

- The Supreme Court of India has allowed the withdrawal of life- sustaining treatment for Harish Rana, a 32-year-old in a permanent vegetative state since 2013, the first practical application of passive euthanasia in the country, emphasizing the right to die with dignity.
- Euthanasia refers to the deliberate act of ending the life of a person suffering from an incurable disease or irreversible condition to relieve pain and suffering. Euthanasia can only be administered by a physician.
- Passive euthanasia is legally permitted in India under strict safeguards laid down by the Supreme Court of India

22. Consider the following statements regarding the “Creamy Layer” principle for OBCs:

1. The concept of creamy layer was introduced by the Supreme Court in the Indra Sawhney vs Union of India case.

2. Creamy layer determination for all OBC candidates is based solely on annual family income.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

Explanation.

- The Supreme Court (SC) of India has ruled that parental income alone cannot determine the “creamy layer” status of Other Backward Classes (OBCs) candidates, clarifying long-standing confusion in applying reservation rules in civil services examinations.
- The concept of “creamy layer” was first applied in the 1992 Indra Sawhney vs Union of India judgment to exclude socially advanced OBCs from reservation benefits.
- The 1993 DoPT OM had clearly stated that income from salaries and agricultural land should not be counted in the income/wealth test for creamy layer determination.

23. Consider the following statements regarding the PM-KISAN scheme:

1. Eligible farmers receive ₹6,000 per year under the scheme.

2. The scheme was conceived in 2018 and launched in 2019.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Explanation

- Prime Minister Narendra Modi will release the 22nd instalment of the Pradhan Mantri Kisan Samman Nidhi Yojana from Guwahati, Assam.
- The PM-KISAN is a central sector scheme launched by the Government of India in 2019 to provide essential income support to landholding farmer families across the country.
- NOTE : inception in 2018,
- Under this initiative, eligible farmers receive a total of Rs 6,000 per year, which is disbursed in three equal installments of Rs 2,000 every four months.

24. Bharat Tex reflects the Prime Minister’s ‘5F’ vision. Which of the following is the correct sequence?

- (a) Farm → Fibre → Factory → Fashion → Foreign Markets
(b) Farm → Factory → Fibre → Fashion → Foreign Markets
(c) Fibre → Farm → Factory → Fashion → Foreign Markets
(d) Farm → Fibre → Fashion → Factory → Foreign Markets

Answer: A

Explanation

- Union Textiles Minister Giriraj Singh launched Bharat Tex 2026, India’s flagship global textile event, which is expected to become one of the largest integrated textile fairs in the world.
- The event will be held from July 14 to July 17, at Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi
- The event reflects the Prime Minister’s 5F vision -Farm to Fibre, Fibre to Factory, Factory to Fashion, and Fashion to Foreign markets – under the Make in India initiative.

25. International Day of Yoga (IDY) is celebrated annually on:

- (a) 5 June (b) 21 June
(c) 11 July (d) 15 August

Answer: B

Explanation

- The Morarji Desai National Institute of Yoga (MDNIY), Ministry of Ayush, Government of India, is organising Yoga Mahotsav-2026 .
- An event to mark the beginning of the 100-day countdown to International Day of Yoga-2026, on March 13, 2026 at Vigyan Bhawan.
- The International Day of Yoga (IDY) 2026 will be celebrated on Sunday, June 21, 2026.

26. Consider the following statements regarding the Transgender Persons (Protection of Rights) Amendment Bill, 2026:

1. It proposes a medical authority headed by a Chief Medical Officer to examine gender certification cases.

2. It introduces graded punishments including fines up to ₹5 lakh for crimes against transgender persons.

Which of the above given statement/s is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Explanation

- The Union Government introduced a Bill in the Lok Sabha to amend the Transgender Persons (Protection of Rights) Act, 2019.
- The Transgender Persons (Protection of Rights) Amendment Bill, 2026 proposes modifications to the 2019 law that protects transgender persons from discrimination and ensures their welfare.
- The Bill introduces the concept of an authority (medical board headed by a Chief Medical Officer) to examine gender certification cases.
- The Bill expands criminal provisions with graded punishments (including imprisonment and fines up to ₹5 lakh) for crimes such as:
 - Denial of access to public places
 - Forced labour
 - Expulsion from homes

27. The Purple Fest, recently seen in the news, is organised by which ministry?

- (a) Ministry of Health and Family Welfare
- (b) Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment
- (c) Ministry of Women and Child Development
- (d) Ministry of Culture

Answer: B

Explanation

- Rashtrapati Bhavan hosted the 'Purple Fest' to celebrate the achievements and talents of Divyangjan (persons with disabilities) and promote inclusivity.
- Purple Fest is an inclusive awareness and celebration event organised by the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment to recognise the talent, achievements, and aspirations of Divyangjan.

28. Consider the following statements regarding the Dumpsite Remediation Accelerator Programme (DRAP):

- It aims to achieve 100% dumpsite clearance within one year of adoption.
- It is implemented under the Swachh Bharat Mission – Urban 2.0.

Which of the above given statement/s is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Explanation

- The Government of India has launched the Dumpsite Remediation Accelerator Programme (DRAP) to fast-track the clearance of legacy waste dumpsites across urban India.

- It follows a structured and fast-tracked approach to remove garbage mountains and reclaim land for productive use such as parks, community facilities, and waste-management infrastructure.
- Launched in: November 2025.
- Ministry: Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHUA).
- Implemented under Swachh Bharat Mission – Urban 2.0 (SBM- U 2.0)
- Achieve 100% dumpsite clearance within one year of adoption.

29. The Samridh Gram Phygital Services Pilot Project is built on the digital infrastructure of which initiative?

- (a) Digital India Programme
- (b) PM-WANI
- (c) BharatNet
- (d) National Knowledge Network

Answer: C

Explanation

- The Union Minister of Communications is set to inaugurate the Samridh Gram Phygital Services Pilot Project at Umri village in Madhya Pradesh.
- Samridh Gram is a pilot project for integrated Phygital (Physical + Digital) service delivery in rural areas.
- It aims to create village-level service hubs called Samridhi Kendras that provide multiple citizen services using digital connectivity.
- Implemented by: the Department of Telecommunications.
- Built on the digital infrastructure of BharatNet, one of the world's largest rural broadband connectivity projects.

30. Consider the following statements regarding the Stand-Up India Scheme:

1. The scheme provides loans only for greenfield enterprises.
2. Under the scheme, the minimum loan amount is ₹10 lakh.
3. Each branch of Scheduled Commercial Banks should facilitate loans to at least one SC/ST borrower and one woman borrower.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 1 and 2 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation

- The government will launch a revamped version of the Stand-up India scheme to provide more benefits to SC, ST and Women entrepreneurs across the country.
- The Stand-up India scheme, which was launched in April 2016, came to an end in March last year.
- Objective: Promote entrepreneurship amongst women, SC & ST category; Provide loans for greenfield enterprises in manufacturing, services or the trading sector and activities allied to agriculture;
- Facilitate bank loans between Rs.10 lakh and Rs.1 crore to at least one Scheduled Caste/ Scheduled Tribe borrower and at least one woman borrower per bank branch of Scheduled Commercial Banks.

31. Sujal Gaon ID is best described as:

- (a) A platform for monitoring groundwater and irrigation systems
- (b) A digital identifier for rural piped water schemes enabling asset mapping
- (c) A mobile app for water conservation awareness
- (d) A funding mechanism for rural water infrastructure

Answer: B**Explanation**

- The Union Ministry of Jal Shakti has launched Sujal Gaon ID, a unique digital identifier for mapping rural piped water supply schemes across India.
- Sujal Gaon ID is a scheme-based unique digital identifier assigned to each rural piped drinking water supply scheme in India.
- It enables digital mapping of rural water supply assets and service areas, integrating them into a unified national water management platform.

32. Which company has become the first mining company in India to produce 50 million tonnes of iron ore in a single financial year?

- (a) Coal India Limited
- (b) Hindustan Copper Limited
- (c) NMDC Limited
- (d) SAIL

Answer: C**Explanation**

- NMDC Limited has become the first mining company in India to produce 50 million tonnes (MT) of iron ore in a single financial year.

33. SATHEE' app, recently seen in news, is related to:

- (a) Online health consultation services
- (b) Scholarship portal for higher education
- (c) Digital payment system for students
- (d) Free learning platform for preparation of national-level entrance exams

Answer: D**Explanation**

- The Ministry of Education, in collaboration with the Indian Institute of Technology (IIT), Kanpur, introduced the 'SATHEE' app as a free learning platform to help students prepare for national-level competitive exams such as the Joint Entrance Examination (JEE), National Eligibility cum Entrance Test (NEET), and Common University Entrance Test (CUET).
- SATHEE (Self-Assessment, Test and Help for Entrance Exams) offers video lectures and study notes prepared by experts from IITs and other reputed institutions.

34. Consider the following religions:

1. Hinduism
2. Sikhism
3. Buddhism
4. Christianity
5. Islam

Which of the above religions are recognized for Scheduled Caste status as per the Supreme Court ruling?

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 only
- (b) 1, 2, 3 and 4 only
- (c) 2, 3 and 5 only
- (d) 1, 3, 4 and 5 only

Answer: A**Explanation**

- The Supreme Court ruled that a person who professes a religion other than Hinduism, Sikhism, or Buddhism cannot be a member of a Scheduled Caste.
- A two-judge bench headed by Justice P K Mishra.
- While upholding the April 30, 2025, order of the Andhra Pradesh High Court, the bench said the position is made clear by the Constitution (Scheduled Caste) Order, 1950.
- Mandates that "no person who professes a religion different from Hinduism shall be deemed to be a member of a Scheduled Caste"

35. Consider the following statements regarding the Small Hydro Power (SHP) Development Scheme:

1. It supports hydro projects of capacity up to 50 MW.
2. The scheme mandates 100% domestic sourcing of plant and machinery.
3. It promotes run-of-the-river technology.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 2 and 3 only (b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A

Explanation

- The union cabinet approved the 'Small Hydro Power (SHP) Development Scheme for the period FY 2026-27 to FY 2030-31'
- It supports the installation of small hydro projects (1-25 MW capacity each) with a total capacity of 1,500 MW across the country.
- Mandates 100% sourcing of plant and machinery from domestic manufacturers to boost the local industrial base.
- Its special focus is on hilly and North-Eastern states that hold high untapped potential.
- The initiative emphasises environment-friendly "run-of-the-river" technology that generates power directly from the natural flow of rivers without large dams, minimising displacement, deforestation and ecological disruption.

36. The 'BHAVYA' initiative aims to

- (a) promote rural entrepreneurship
(b) develop world-class industrial infrastructure in India
(c) strengthen agricultural exports
(d) enhance digital governance

Answer: B

Explanation

- The union Cabinet has approved the Bharat Audyogik Vikas Yojna (BHAVYA)
- It aims to develop world-class industrial infrastructure, unlocking manufacturing potential and driving India's growth story.
- Target: Developing 100 plug-and-play industrial parks across the country.

37. What is the primary objective of the RISA: Timeless Tribal initiative?

- (a) To promote industrial manufacturing
(b) To preserve and promote tribal crafts, textiles, and cultural heritage
(c) To boost agricultural exports

(d) To develop urban infrastructure

Answer: B

Explanation

- The Ministry of Tribal Affairs has launched RISA: Timeless Tribal, a premium signature brand to promote tribal crafts and textiles.
- RISA: Timeless Tribal is a premium national brand for tribal textiles, embroidery, and handicrafts, designed to showcase India's indigenous craftsmanship in domestic and global premium markets while preserving cultural heritage.
- Nodal Ministry: Ministry of Tribal Affairs

38. The RELIEF scheme stands for:

- (a) Resilience & Logistics Intervention for Export Facilitation
(b) Regional Logistics Intervention for Export Facilitation
(c) Rapid Logistics Initiative for Export Funding
(d) Resilient Linkages for International Export Framework

Answer: A

Explanation

- Recently, the Government of India has approved the RELIEF (Resilience & Logistics Intervention for Export Facilitation) scheme to support exporters facing severe maritime disruptions in West Asia.
- It is aimed at supporting Indian exporters affected by extraordinary freight escalation, heightened insurance premiums and war-related export risks arising from disruptions in the Gulf and wider West Asia maritime corridor.
- It is a time-bound and targeted intervention launched under the Export Promotion Mission (EPM)

39. ALMM List-III, recently introduced in India, is related to:

- (a) Wind energy certification
(b) Solar manufacturing standards
(c) Hydropower safety norms
(d) Nuclear energy regulation

Answer: B

Explanation

- Recently, the Ministry of New and Renewable Energy has introduced ALMM List-III for ingots and wafers, which will come into effect from the 1st of June, 2028.
- It is a quality-and-reliability framework that ensures solar equipment used in the country's solar projects meet the domestic manufacturing standards.

40. Shaheed Diwas Padyatra 2026 was organised under which of the following themes?

- (a) Youth for Nation
- (b) India First
- (c) MY Bharat, My Responsibility
- (d) Azadi Ka Amrit

Answer: C

Explanation

- In a solemn tribute to the unparalleled sacrifice of India's young freedom fighters - Shaheed Bhagat Singh, Shaheed Shivaram Rajguru, and Shaheed Sukhdev Thapar, the Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports, through Mera Yuva Bharat (MY Bharat), will organise a nationwide Padyatra on March 23rd, 2026, marking Shaheed Diwas.
- The initiative will be conducted under the theme "MY Bharat, My Responsibility."

41. Consider the following statements regarding the National Productivity Council (NPC):

1. It was established in 1958.

2. Its headquarters is in New Delhi.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Explanation

- Recently, the National Productivity Council (NPC) has signed an agreement with the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEF&CC) to function as the Environment Audit Designated Agency (EADA).
- It was established in 1958 as an autonomous organization.
- It works under the Department for Promotion of Industry & Internal Trade, Ministry of Commerce and Industry.
- Headquarters: New Delhi

42. Suraksha Sankalp Karyashala is related to:

- (a) Tuberculosis control
- (b) HIV/AIDS response
- (c) Malaria eradication
- (d) Immunization program

Answer: B

Explanation

- The Ministry of Health & Family Welfare, through NACO, organised the Suraksha Sankalp Karyashala to strengthen district-level HIV/AIDS response in Haryana and Delhi.
- Suraksha Sankalp Karyashala is a national-level workshop initiative aimed at strengthening

district-level HIV/AIDS response through coordinated, data-driven planning and stakeholder engagement.

43. Consider the following statements regarding the Cabinet Committee on Security (CCS):

1. The National Security Advisor chairs the CCS.

2. The Home, Defence, Finance, and External Affairs Ministers are its members.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

Explanation

- Recently, the Prime Minister Of India chaired a meeting of the Cabinet Committee on Security (CCS) to review the global situation and various mitigating measures taken so far across sectors amid the conflict in West Asia.
- It is headed by the Prime Minister, and is responsible for important discussions and decisions on defence policy, expenditure, and matters related to national security.
- With the Prime Minister as its chairperson, the committee typically comprises the Home Minister, Defence Minister, Finance Minister, and External Affairs Minister as members.
- The National Security Advisor (NSA) acts as secretary-level coordinator on matters within its purview.

44. Consider the following statements regarding the Credit Guarantee Scheme for Microfinance Institutions-2.0 (CGSMFI-2.0):

1. It provides credit guarantee to Member Lending Institutions (MLIs).

2. It covers 75% of default for medium MFIs.

3. It is valid indefinitely without any cap.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A

Explanation

- The Government of India has launched the Credit Guarantee Scheme for Microfinance Institutions-2.0 (CGSMFI-2.0) to inject ₹20,000 crore into the microfinance sector.
- A specialized credit guarantee framework where the government provides a guarantee to Member Lending Institutions (MLIs) against potential defaults on loans extended to NBFC-MFIs and other MFIs.

Key Features of the Scheme:

- Provides a safety net covering 80% of the defaulted amount for small MFIs, 75% for medium, and 70% for large MFIs, prioritizing smaller players.
- A nominal fee of 0.50% p.a. is charged to the lending institutions, making the risk-mitigation affordable.
- The scheme is valid until June 30, 2026, or until a total guarantee limit of ₹20,000 crore is reached.

45. 'Jal Seva Aankalan', recently in news, is:

- (a) A river interlinking programme
- (b) A framework to assess rural water service delivery
- (c) A groundwater extraction policy
- (d) A water conservation campaign

Answer: B**Explanation**

- The Government has operationalised the 'Jal Seva Aankalan' framework under the Jal Jeevan Mission to assess rural water service delivery.
- A village-level assessment and monitoring framework under the Jal Jeevan Mission, where service delivery of rural tap water is evaluated through community participation and digital reporting.

46. NHAI-sponsored Raajmarg Infra Investment Trust (RIIT) is being listed on the _____ in March 2026.

- (a) National Stock Exchange (NSE)
- (b) Bombay Stock Exchange (BSE)
- (c) London Stock Exchange (LSE)
- (d) National Association of Securities Dealers Automated Quotations (NASDAQ)

Answer: B**Explanation**

- NHAI-sponsored Raajmarg Infra Investment Trust (RIIT) is being officially listed on the Bombay Stock Exchange (BSE) in March 2026.

47. The Model Context Protocol (MCP), recently in news, is:

- (a) A cybersecurity framework
- (b) Server to link AI tools with the e-Sankhyiki portal
- (c) A satellite communication protocol for ISRO
- (d) A blockchain-based system

Answer: B**Explanation**

- The Government of India has launched a Model Context Protocol (MCP) server to link AI tools with the e-Sankhyiki portal, allowing AI applications to access verified official statistical data directly.
- The Model Context Protocol (MCP) is an open-source standard designed to connect Artificial Intelligence models (like Claude, ChatGPT, or Gemini) to external data sources, tools, and workflows

48. With reference to the GARBH-Ini Initiative, consider the following statements:

1. It operates under the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare.
2. It aims to develop predictive tools for preterm birth using cohort data.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B**Explanation**

- Recently, the Union Minister of State (Independent Charge) for Science & Technology said that India's largest pregnancy cohort study of 12,000 women under the GARBH-INI initiative is aimed at developing indigenous, AI-driven solutions to address preterm births.

GARBH-INI Initiative

- It promotes Maternal and Child Health and develops prediction tools for preterm birth.
- It is an interdisciplinary Group for Advanced Research in Birth outcomes- DBT India Initiative (GARBH-Ini) has initiated a cohort study of pregnant women in May 2015.
- It is an initiative under the Department of Biotechnology of the Union Ministry of Science and Technology as a collaborative interdisciplinary programme.

49. Districts as Export Hubs (DEH) Initiative was launched in:

- (a) 2017
- (b) 2018
- (c) 2019
- (d) 2020

Answer: C**Explanation**

- Recently, the Minister of State for Ministry of Commerce & Industry informed the Lok Sabha about the Districts as Export Hubs (DEH) Initiative. It was launched in August 2019 to foster balanced regional development across all districts of the country.

50. With reference to the Remission of Duties and Taxes on Exported Products (RoDTEP) Scheme, consider the following statements:

1. It became effective from January 1, 2021.
2. Both manufacturer exporters and merchant exporters (traders) are eligible for the scheme.
3. Labour-intensive sectors are accorded priority under the scheme.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation

- The Government of India has decided to restore the rates and value caps under the Remission of Duties and Taxes on Exported Products (RoDTEP) Scheme for all eligible export products.
- It was introduced through an amendment to the Foreign Trade Policy 2015-20, and it became effective for exports starting January 1, 2021.
- Labor-intensive sectors will be accorded priority.
- Both manufacturer exporters and merchant exporters (traders) are eligible for the scheme.

51. Which of the following best describes the primary objective of Vehicle-to-Vehicle (V2V) technology?

- (a) Enhancing fuel efficiency of vehicles
- (b) Preventing accidents through real-time communication
- (c) Replacing human drivers with autonomous systems
- (d) Improving road construction quality

Answer: B

Explanation

- The government is planning to launch Vehicle-to-Vehicle (V2V) safety technology to prevent road accident deaths and reduce traffic.
- — V2V or vehicle-to-vehicle communication is a wireless technology that will enable the vehicles to communicate or talk with one another to share real-time information like speed, location, acceleration, braking, etc.

52. The GlobE Network is:

- (a) A global climate change platform
- (b) A cyber security alliance
- (c) An international trade organization

(d) A global platform of anti-corruption law enforcement authorities

Answer: D

Explanation

- India hosted the 12th Steering Committee Meeting of the Global Operational Network of Anti-Corruption Law Enforcement Authorities (GlobE Network) in New Delhi.
- The GlobE Network is a global platform of specialised anti-corruption law enforcement authorities.

53. With reference to the Immigration, Visa, Foreigners Registration & Tracking (IVFRT) Scheme, consider the following statements:

1. It was originally approved in 2010.

2. The newly approved phase will run from April 1, 2026, to March 31, 2031.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Explanation

- The Union Cabinet has approved the continuation of the Immigration, Visa, Foreigners Registration & Tracking (IVFRT) Scheme for five years (2026–2031) with an outlay of ₹1,800 crore.
- The newly approved phase will run from April 1, 2026, to March 31, 2031.
- It was originally approved in 2010; the project has undergone multiple phases of expansion and extension.

54. The PRISM-SG Portal, recently launched, is related to:

- (a) Digital banking services
- (b) Rail-road infrastructure coordination
- (c) Agricultural supply chain management
- (d) Urban housing projects

Answer: B

Explanation

- Recently, the Minister for Road Transport and Highways launched the PRISM-SG Portal in New Delhi.
- PRISM-SG (Portal for Rail-Road Inspection & Stages Management – Steel Girders) Portal aimed at enhancing efficiency, transparency, and inter-agency coordination in infrastructure development.

55. Under the Transgender Persons (Protection of Rights) Amendment Bill, 2026, the maximum penalty for specified offences can include:

- (a) Fine up to ₹1 lakh only
- (b) Imprisonment up to 1 year only
- (c) Imprisonment along with fine up to ₹5 lakh
- (d) Community service without monetary penalty

Answer: C

Explanation

- The Transgender Persons (Protection of Rights) Amendment Bill, 2026 proposes modifications to the 2019 law that protects transgender persons from discrimination and ensures their welfare.
- IT expands criminal provisions with graded punishments (including imprisonment and fines up to ₹5 lakh) for crimes such as:
 - Denial of access to public places
 - Forced labour
 - Expulsion from homes

56. The UDAN (Ude Desh ka Aam Nagrik) Scheme was originally launched in which year?

- (a) 2014
- (b) 2015
- (c) 2016
- (d) 2018

Answer: C

Explanation

- The Union Cabinet has approved the Regional Connectivity Scheme – Modified UDAN with an outlay of ₹28,840 crore for 2026–2036.
- While the original scheme began in 2016, the Modified UDAN was approved by the Union Cabinet on March 25, 2026, for implementation starting from FY 2026-27.

57. India's updated NDC targets a _____ reduction in emissions intensity of GDP by 2035 and covers the period _____.

- (a) 45% ; 2030–2035
- (b) 47% ; 2031–2035
- (c) 50% ; 2025–2030
- (d) 40% ; 2035–2040

Answer: B

Explanation

- The Union Cabinet has approved India's updated Nationally Determined Contribution (NDC) for 2031- 2035 to be submitted to the UNFCCC.
- Term: This specific NDC covers the period from 2031 to 2035, building upon the targets previously set for 2030.
- Emissions Intensity: Reduce the emissions intensity

of its GDP by 47% by 2035 (from 2005 levels).

58. The theme of the first BRICS Youth Coordination Meeting 2026 was:

- (a) Inclusive Growth and Digital Transformation
- (b) Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability
- (c) Youth Empowerment for Global Peace and Security
- (d) Sustainable Development through Technology and Governance

Answer: B

Explanation

- The Department of Youth Affairs, Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports, Government of India organized the first BRICS Youth Coordination Meeting on 25th March 2026 in virtual format.
- the theme "Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability," .

59. The B28 bullet trainset, recently in news, is being manufactured by:

- (a) Bharat Heavy Electricals Limited (BHEL)
- (b) Bharat Earth Movers Limited (BEML)
- (c) Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL)
- (d) Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL)

Answer: B

Explanation

- The B28 train is the Bharat made Bullet trainset.
- The manufacturing of B28 bullet trainset is currently underway at BEML's (Bharat Earth Movers Limited) Bengaluru rail coach complex.
- The defence PSU was awarded the contract in October 2024 by Chennai-based Integral Coach Factory (ICF) to design, manufacture and commission two high-speed trainsets

60. Superior Kerosene Oil (SKO) is best described as:

- (a) A heavy residual fraction of crude oil
- (b) A highly refined middle distillate fraction of crude oil
- (c) A gaseous hydrocarbon mixture
- (d) A biofuel derived from biomass

Answer: B

Explanation

- The Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas has issued a gazette notification allowing the distribution of Superior Kerosene Oil (SKO) under the Public Distribution System (PDS) across 21 States and UTs, including Delhi and Gujarat.
- Superior Kerosene Oil (SKO) is a highly refined middle distillate fraction of crude oil.

- In India, it is primarily distributed through the Public Distribution System (PDS) to provide energy security to low-income households.

61. With reference to the Central Armed Police Forces (General Administration) Bill, 2026, consider the following statements:

1. It mandates that all CAPF posts must be filled only by IPS officers.
2. It empowers the Central Government to frame rules for recruitment, deputation, and service conditions, overriding any existing laws or court orders.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

Explanation

- The Central Government introduced the Central Armed Police Forces (General Administration) Bill, 2026 in the Rajya Sabha.
- The Bill is a regulatory framework designed to govern the recruitment, promotion, and service conditions of Group 'A' General Duty Officers and other personnel within specified CAPFs.
- Mandatory IPS Deputation: Explicitly earmarks high-level posts for IPS officers:
 - 50% of Inspector General (IG) posts.
 - Minimum 67% of Additional Director General (ADG) posts.
 - 100% of Special Director General (SDG) and Director General (DG) posts.

Eminent Personalities in News

1. Consider the following statements regarding Sambhaji Maharaj:

1. He succeeded Shivaji Maharaj as the ruler of the Maratha Empire.
2. He was executed by Mughal Emperor Aurangzeb in 1689.

3. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Explanation

- Sambhaji Maharaj death anniversary
- He was born on 14 May 1657 at Purandar Fort near Pune
- Predecessor: Shivaji Maharaj
- Cause of Death : Executed by the Mughal Emperor Aurangzeb in 1689

2. Consider the following statements regarding Dr. Ram Manohar Lohia:

1. He was born on 23rd March, 1910.
2. His works include "Wheel of History" and "Marx, Gandhi and Socialism".

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Explanation

- Dr Ram Manohar Lohia birth Birth: 23rd March, 1910 in Akbarpur, Uttar Pradesh.
- Ram Manohar Lohia was an Indian political activist of the Indian independence movement and a socialist politician.
- Some of his works include: 'Wheel of History',

'Marx, Gandhi and Socialism', 'Guilty Men of India's Partition', etc.

3. Stuti Pradhan, selected to represent India at the World Youth Parliament, belongs to which state?

- (a) Assam (b) Sikkim
(c) Manipur (d) Meghalaya

Answer: B

Explanation

- Stuti Pradhan, a promising young leader from Sikkim, has been selected to represent India at the prestigious World Youth Parliament.

4. Consider the following statements regarding Mahavir Jayanti:

1. It is celebrated on the Trayodashi Tithi of Shukla Paksha in the Chaitra month.
2. Lord Mahavira was born as Vardhamana in Kundagram, present-day Bihar.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

- Mahavir Jayanti, or Mahaveer Janma Kalyanak, is one of the most important festivals of Jainism, marking the birth of Lord Mahavir, the 24th and last Tirthankara.

- Lord Mahavir was born on the Trayodashi Tithi during the Shukla Paksha of the Chaitra month, which is the 13th day of the rising moon of March and April as per the Gregorian calendar, resulting in different dates each year.

6 The publication The Indian Sociologist was founded by whom?

- (a) Bal Gangadhar Tilak
- (b) Shyamji Krishna Varma
- (c) Dadabhai Naoroji
- (d) Lala Lajpat Rai

Answer: B

Explanation

- Shyamji Krishna Varma was born on 4th October, 1857 in Mandvi town of Kachchh district of Gujarat.
- He was an Indian freedom fighter, lawyer and journalist.
- Indian Sociologist: It was started in London. The monthly Indian Sociologist became an outlet for nationalist ideas.

State

Jammu & Kashmir

1. The multi-genre youth festival "Goonj 2026" is organised by which institution?

- (a) University of Delhi
- (b) University of Jammu
- (c) Jawaharlal Nehru University
- (d) Banaras Hindu University

Answer: B

Explanation

- The University of Jammu is going to organise 3rd edition of its flagship multi-genre youth festival, Goonj 2026.
 - The journey of Goonj was started in 2024 and the initiative was conceived with a clear vision, to promote holistic development of students
- 2. Sharansthi initiative, recently seen in news, is related to:**
- (a) Rehabilitation of displaced border villagers
 - (b) Providing government jobs to families of terror victims
 - (c) Skill development for unemployed youth in Jammu & Kashmir
 - (d) Housing assistance for migrant workers

Answer: B

Explanation

- Sharansthi is a rehabilitation initiative of the Jammu & Kashmir administration aimed at supporting families of victims who lost their lives due to terrorism.
 - Under the programme, compassionate government employment is provided to the next of kin of terror victims to help them rebuild their livelihoods and restore dignity.
- 3. Which of the following correctly describes the sequence while traveling from Srinagar to Leh via Zojila?**
- (a) Srinagar → Kargil → Zojila → Leh
 - (b) Srinagar → Sonmarg → Zojila → Dras → Kargil → Leh
 - (c) Srinagar → Leh → Zojila → Kargil

(d) Srinagar → Dras → Sonmarg → Zojila → Leh

Answer: B

Explanation

- A tragic avalanche at the high-altitude Zojila Pass, resulted in the death of five individuals and left several others injured or trapped.
 - Often referred to as the mountain pass of blizzards (though scientifically named after the Tibetan goddess Du-Zhi-lha-mo), it serves as the only terrestrial link between the Kashmir Valley and the high-altitude cold desert of Ladakh.
 - It is situated at an elevation of approximately 3,580 metres (though some sections reach up to 5,008 metres), making it the second-highest pass on the Srinagar–Leh Highway after Fotu La. It connects Sonmarg (Kashmir) to the Dras and Suru valleys, eventually leading to Leh.
- 4. Consider the following statements regarding Himachal Pradesh Budget 2026–27:**
1. The estimated economic growth rate for 2025–26 is 8.3%.
 2. The fiscal deficit is pegged at 3.49% of the State GSDP.
- Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?**
- (a) 1 only
 - (b) 2 only
 - (c) Both 1 and 2
 - (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Explanation

- Himachal Pradesh chief minister Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu presented the state budget for the financial year 2026–27, with a total outlay of Rs 54,928 crore.
- The budget estimates an economic growth rate of 8.3 per cent for 2025-26, a per capita income of 2,83,626 Rs. and a GSDP of 2.54 lakh crore Rs.
- The Budget for 2026-27 pegs fiscal deficit at Rs 9,698 crore, or 3.49 per cent of the State Gross Domestic Product.

Uttarakhand

5. Consider the following statements regarding

the “Devbhoomi Family Bill-2026”:

1. It proposes a unified family-based database called “Devbhoomi Family”.
2. The eldest female member (18+) will be registered as the head of the family.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Explanation

- The Uttarakhand government introduced the “Devbhoomi Family Bill-2026” in the Assembly during the budget session at Gairsain.
 - The bill aims to ensure the effective implementation of welfare schemes and provide transparent assistance to beneficiaries.
 - It will establish a unified and verified family-based database called the “Devbhoomi Family”. Under this system, the eldest female member of the family, aged 18 or above, will be registered as the head of the family.
6. **Roopkund Lake, often called “Skeleton Lake”, is located in which state of India?**
- (a) Uttarakhand (b) Himachal Pradesh
(c) Sikkim (d) Arunachal Pradesh

Answer: A

Explanation

- Roopkund Lake, often called Skeleton Lake, is famous for the hundreds of human skeletons found around its icy waters.
 - Roopkund, also known as the “lake of skeletons” is a glacial lake in Uttarakhand.
 - It is situated at 5,029 metres (16,500 ft) above sea level at the base of Mt. Trishul in the Garhwal Himalayas.
7. **Lipulekh Pass, recently seen in news, is located in:**
- (a) Himachal Pradesh
(b) Sikkim
(c) Uttarakhand
(d) Arunachal Pradesh

Answer: C

Explanation

- The historic cross-border trade between India and China through the Lipulekh Pass in Uttarakhand’s Pithoragarh district is set to resume this June.
- Location: It is a high-altitude mountain pass located in the Kumaon region of Uttarakhand, near the trijunction of India, Nepal, and China.
- It links the Indian state of Uttarakhand with the

Tibet region of China.

Punjab

8. **‘Punjab Sikhya Kranti 2.0’, recently in news, has been launched in collaboration with which of the following?**

- (a) Asian Development Bank
(b) World Bank
(c) UNICEF
(d) UNESCO

Answer: B

Explanation

- The Punjab Government has launched a new phase of school education reform, ‘Punjab Sikhya Kranti 2.0’, in collaboration with the World Bank to prepare the state’s education system to compete with the best in the world.
9. **Consider the following statements regarding the Mukh Mantri Mawan Dhian Satikar Yojna:**
1. All eligible women receive ₹1,500 per month under the scheme.
 2. Government employees, income tax payees, and current or former MPs/MLAs are excluded from the scheme.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

Explanation

- Mukh Mantri Mawan Dhian Satikar Yojna, a direct benefit transfer scheme.
- Government will transfer ₹1,000 per month to all adult women. For women belonging to the Scheduled Caste community, the monthly payout is set at ₹1,500.
- The only exclusions are government employees, income tax payees, and current or former MPs/MLAs.
- Women already receiving social security pensions (old-age, widow, or disability) will remain eligible for this additional benefit.

10. **The Sri Guru Tegh Bahadur World Class University will be established in which city of Punjab?**

- (a) Amritsar (b) Ludhiana
(c) Sri Anandpur Sahib (d) Patiala

Answer: C

Explanation

- Punjab Vidhan Sabha has unanimously passed Sri Guru Tegh Bahadur World Class University Punjab Bill, 2026, to establish a cutting-edge world-class university on the name of the 9th Guru on the sacred land of Sri Anandpur Sahib.
- A total of 300 crore rupees has been proposed for investment over the next three years, with an initial allocation of Rs. 20 crore in the current budget.

11. Consider the following statements regarding Guru Angad Dev:

1. He standardized the Gurmukhi script.
2. He abolished the Langar system.
3. He composed 62 hymns in various ragas.

Which of the statement/s given above are correct?

- (a) 1 and 3 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 2 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A

Explanation

- Guru Angad (31 March 1504–29 March 1552) was born with the birth name of Lahna the village of Matte-di- Sarai (now known as Sarai Naga), near Muktsar of Punjab, India.
- He introduced the Gurmukhi script, standardizing the Punjabi language.
- He introduced the teaching of Punjabi in Gurmukhi script by modifying the existing alphabet.
- He composed 62 hymns in 10 Ragas.
- He consolidated the institution of Langar started by Guru Nanak Dev Ji.

Haryana**12. 'Abhedya', a mobile-based system to counter cyber harassment, has been launched by which state police?**

- (a) Uttar Pradesh Police
(b) Haryana Police
(c) Rajasthan Police
(d) Punjab Police

Answer: B

Explanation

- Haryana Police launched 'Abhedya', a mobile-based system that prevents citizens from even coming into contact with threatening or abusive communication.
- The application works by automatically rejecting suspicious calls, blocking numbers and removing

messages, voice notes or notifications before they can be accessed by the user

Chandigarh**13. Chandigarh has become the Union Territory in India to be declared fully literate.**

- (a) First (b) Second
(c) Third (d) Fourth

Answer: B

Explanation

- Chandigarh attained 99.93% literacy rate, thus making it a fully literate Union Territory,
- It is the sixth State/U.T. in the country and the second Union Territory to achieve the feat.
- Among Union Territories, only Ladakh had earlier achieved the milestone.

Delhi**14. The 'SMART' platform (Swachhata Monitoring & Automated Reporting Tool) was launched by which organisation?**

- (a) Chennai Municipal Corporation
(b) Bengaluru Development Authority (BDA)
(c) Mumbai Metropolitan Region Development Authority (MMRDA)
(d) Delhi Cantonment Board (DCB))

Answer: D

Explanation

- The Delhi Cantonment Board (DCB) has launched a new digital platform called Swachhata Monitoring & Automated Reporting Tool (SMART) to improve transparency, efficiency and real-time monitoring of sanitation and civic services across the cantonment area.
- The initiative aims to address long-standing challenges such as manual reporting, delays in data collection and fragmented monitoring systems by introducing an automated and integrated digital solution.

15. India's first fully operational 'Ring Metro' has been created by which line of the Delhi Metro?

- (a) Red Line (b) Blue Line
(c) Pink Line (d) Yellow Line

Answer: C

Explanation

- Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated two new corridors of the Delhi Metro, including India's first fully operational 'Ring Metro'.
- With the addition of this stretch, the Pink Line has expanded to about 71.56 km, making it India's first fully operational 'Ring Metro'.

16. Consider the following statements regarding the Delhi Lakhpati Btiya Yojana:

1. The scheme provides financial assistance of

₹56,000 to beneficiaries.

2. The benefits under the scheme are restricted to only one girl per family.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

Explanation

The new Delhi Lakhpati Bitiya Yojna

Aid	Rs 56,000
Eligibility	Domicile or resident of Delhi for last three years
Annual family income	Rs 1.2 lakh
Deposits	Rs 11,000 within one year of birth Rs 5,000 each on admission to classes I, 6, 8, 10 and 12; Rs 25,000 in all Rs 20,000 in phases after diploma or graduation
Cap	2 girls per family
Transfer of aid	To be credited phase wise via Aadhar-linked DBT
Maturity amount	After Class 12 and 18 years of age, or completed graduation/ diploma and 21 years of age
Unclaimed amounts	To be credited back to the government
Aid under existing Delhi Ladli Scheme	Rs 36,000

17. The “smog-eating” photocatalytic coating recently studied by the Delhi government on roads was conducted in collaboration with which institution?

- (a) Indian Institute of Technology Madras
(b) Indian Institute of Technology Delhi
(c) Indian Institute of Technology Bombay
(d) Indian Institute of Science

Answer: A

Explanation

- Recently, the Delhi government and Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Madras collaborated to study “smog-eating” photocatalytic coatings on roads.

- It is designed to neutralize harmful gases like nitrogen dioxide and volatile hydrocarbons that contribute to toxic air.

Uttar Pradesh

18. The Yaksh App, recently seen in the news, has been launched by which organization?

- (a) Uttar Pradesh Police
(b) Central Bureau of Investigation
(c) National Crime Records Bureau
(d) Ministry of Home Affairs

Answer: A

Explanation

- The Uttar Pradesh Police’s recently launched Yaksh App helped in tracing and identifying robbers within three hours of the incident in Jaunpur.
- The app maintains multi-angle photographs of criminals, enabling the victim to confirm the identity of the perpetrator(s).

19. Kalinjar Fort, recently declared a National Geo-Heritage Site, is located in:

- (a) Madhya Pradesh (b) Rajasthan
(c) Uttar Pradesh (d) Chhattisgarh

Answer: C

Explanation

- The hill region surrounding the Kalinjar Fort in Banda was officially declared a National Geo-Heritage Site by the Geological Survey of India (GSI) recently.
- It is located in the Banda district of Uttar Pradesh.
- It is situated on an isolated hilltop, surrounded by the Vindhya Mountains and the Ken River.

20. ‘Kavach’, recently in news, is:

- (a) A satellite navigation system
(b) A railway ticketing platform
(c) A missile defence system
(d) An Automatic Train Protection system

Answer: D

Explanation

- Kavach is an indigenously developed Automatic Train Protection (ATP) system designed to enhance railway operational safety.
- It has been developed by the Research Design and Standards Organisation (RDSO) under Indian Railways (IR) in collaboration with Medha Servo Drives Pvt Ltd, HBL Power Systems Ltd, and Kernex Microsystems.

21. Ram Navami is celebrated in which of the following months of the Hindu calendar?

- (a) Kartika (b) Chaitra
(c) Magha (d) Phalguna

Answer: B**Explanation**

- RamNavami is a spring Hindu festival.
- The festival marks the birth of Lord Rama, the seventh incarnation of Lord Vishnu.
- The day is the ninth and last day of Chaitra Navaratri.

22. The Surya Tilak Project primarily operates using which of the following mechanisms?

- Electrochemical energy conversion system
- Opto-mechanical system
- Nuclear-based solar simulation system
- Thermal conduction-based mechanism

Answer: B**Explanation**

- The Surya Tilak Project represents a unique fusion of technology and tradition, meticulously engineered to illuminate the forehead of Lord Ram's idol with a precise beam of sunlight during the revered festival of Ram Navami.
- Core: Opto-mechanical system → integrates optical + mechanical components for precise sunlight control.
- Works like a periscope system (mirrors/prisms to redirect light).
- Uses 19-gear mechanism → adjusts yearly for Sun's position.

Bihar

23. Consider the following statements regarding Bihar:

1. It shares an international border with Nepal.
2. In November 2000, the new state of Jharkhand was created from Bihar's southern provinces.

Which of the above given statement/s is/are correct?

- 1 only
- 2 only
- Both 1 and 2
- Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C**Explanation**

- March 22- Bihar Diwas
- The day commemorates the establishment of Bihar as an independent province in 1912 after it was separated from the Bengal Presidency.
- It is bounded by Nepal to the north and by West Bengal to the northeast and Uttar Pradesh to the west.
- In November 2000 the new state of Jharkhand was created from Bihar's southern provinces and now forms the state's southern and

southeastern borders.

Jharkhand

24. Consider the following statements regarding Sarhul:

1. It is associated with the worship of the Sal tree.
2. It celebrates the symbolic union of the Sun and the Earth.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- 1 only
- 2 only
- Both 1 and 2
- Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C**Explanation**

- The President of India extended greetings to the countrymen on the occasion of the Sarhul festival.
- Sarhul, literally "worship of the Sal tree", is among the most revered Adivasi festivals.
- It is rooted in nature worship and celebrates the symbolic union of the Sun and the Earth.
- The Sal tree is revered as the abode of Sama Maa, the village-protecting deity.

Chhattisgarh

25. The proposed Chhattisgarh Dharm Swatantraya Vidheyak, 2026 provides that a person intending to convert to another religion must give prior notice to the district administration. The minimum notice period is:

- 15 days
- 30 days
- 60 days
- 90 days

Answer: C**Explanation**

- The cabinet approved the draft of the Chhattisgarh Dharm Swatantraya Vidheyak, 2026 (Chhattisgarh Freedom of Religion Bill, 2026), which seeks to effectively curb conversion from one faith to another through force, allurement, undue influence or false representation.
- The new proposed anti-conversion law of the State government would have a provision to curb 'changai sabha' or faith healing meetings.
- The draft made after studying laws in nine states, suggests to follow a standard procedure for religious conversion, that includes prior intimation to the district administration, 60 days before taking up another religion.

26. The minimum fine prescribed under the Chhattisgarh Freedom of Religion Bill, 2026 is:

- ₹50,000
- ₹1 lakh

(c) ₹5 lakh

(d) ₹10 lakh

Answer: C**Explanation**

- Chhattisgarh Assembly passes Chhattisgarh Freedom of Religion Bill, 2026
- The legislation seeks to prohibit religious conversions carried out through deceit, force, allurements, or digital means.
- The legislation prescribes stringent punishment, including imprisonment ranging from seven to ten years.
- Convicts will also face a minimum fine of five lakh rupees.

Odisha**27. Kusunpur village, recently in news, is located in:**

- (a) Odisha (b) Jharkhand
(c) Chhattisgarh (d) West Bengal

Answer: A**Explanation**

- Kusunpur village in Odisha's Kendrapada district is set to become the state's first "smart village" under a technology-driven rural development initiative led by the Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR).
- 28. The Sulphuric Acid Plant-III (SAP-III), recently inaugurated in Paradeep, is associated with which organization?**
- (a) National Fertilizers Limited
(b) Indian Farmers Fertiliser Cooperative Limited
(c) Rashtriya Chemicals and Fertilizers
(d) Fertilizer Corporation of India

Answer: B**Explanation**

- Union Home and Cooperation Minister Amit Shah dedicated the newly commissioned Sulphuric Acid Plant- III (SAP-III) at the Indian Farmers Fertiliser Cooperative Limited (IFFCO) complex in Paradeep, Odisha.
- The plant has a production capacity of nearly 2,000 metric tonnes per day.

29. The medieval Gajapati Empire, recently seen in news due to a newly discovered inscription, originated in which present-day Indian state?

- (a) Andhra Pradesh (b) Telangana
(c) Odisha (d) Karnataka

Answer: C**Explanation**

- A Telugu medieval inscription associated with the Gajapathi rulers of Odisha has been recently discovered on a stone pillar of the historic Lakshmi Narasimha Swamy Temple at Ramachandrapura Agraharam in Guntur city.

- Gajapati Empire was a medieval Hindu dynasty in the Indian subcontinent, originally from the region of Odisha, that reigned from (c) 1434 to 1541.

West Bengal**30. The Matua Dharma Mela, recently seen in news, is held in which state?**

- (a) West Bengal (b) Assam
(c) Tripura (d) Odisha

Answer: A**Explanation**

- The 2026 Matua Dharma Mela, celebrating the 215th birth anniversary of Sri Sri Harichand Thakur, is held in North 24 Parganas, West Bengal, in March 2026
- The Matua Dharma Mela is an important religious and cultural gathering for followers of the Matua faith and is observed annually to commemorate the legacy and teachings of Harichand Thakur.

31. The Haldia Bulk Terminal, recognised as India's first fully automated dry bulk cargo facility on the Hooghly River, has been developed by.

- (a) Larsen & Toubro
(b) Reliance Infrastructure
(c) Tata Projects
(d) Adani Ports and Special Economic Zone Limited

Answer: D**Explanation**

- Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated the Haldia Bulk Terminal, a fully automated dry bulk handling facility developed by Adani Ports and Special Economic Zone Limited (APSEZ) at the Haldia Dock Complex of Syama Prasad Mookerjee Port in Kolkata.
- The terminal has an annual handling capacity of 4 million metric tonnes (MMTPA).

32. The longest double-leaf bascule bridge in the world is:

- (a) Tower Bridge, London
(b) Broadway Bridge, Portland
(c) Golden Gate Bridge, San Francisco
(d) Sydney Harbour Bridge

Answer: B**Explanation**

- The Union government recently approved a Rs 117.54 crore project for the renovation of the Bascule Bridge at Syama Prasad Mookerjee Port, Kolkata.
- Bascule Bridge is a type of bridge that can be raised to provide clearance for waterway traffic and is also referred to as a lifting bridge or a

drawbridge.

- The longest double-leaf bascule bridge in the world is the Broadway Bridge in Portland, Oregon, USA.

Sikkim

33. Gurudongmar Lake, recently in the news due to revival of tourism, is located in which state?

- (a) Sikkim (b) Arunachal Pradesh
(c) Uttarakhand (d) Himachal Pradesh

Answer: A

Explanation

- Gurudongmar Lake is located on the northernmost edge of Sikkim, very close to the Chinese Tibetan border.
- It is one of the highest lakes in the world and in India, located at an altitude of 17,800 ft (5,430 m).

Assam

34. Consider the following statements regarding Joha rice:

1. It is a short-grain aromatic rice variety.
2. It received Geographical Indication (GI) status in 2017 from Mizoram.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

Explanation

- Joha rice is a short-grain aromatic rice variety known for its distinctive fragrance, soft texture, and traditional cultivation practices.
- It received Geographical Indication (GI) status in 2017.
- The rice originates from Assam in Northeast India, where it has been cultivated for centuries as part of traditional agricultural systems.

35. National Waterway-2 is developed along which river in India?

- (a) Ganga (b) Brahmaputra
(c) Barak (d) Godavari

Answer: B

Explanation

- Union Minister of Ports, Shipping and Waterways (MoPSW), Sarbananda Sonowal, inaugurated three major inland waterways infrastructure projects in Dibrugarh on National Waterway-2 (River Brahmaputra),
- The projects include the Customs and Immigration Complex at Bogibeel, the Customs and Immigration Complex at Dhubri, and the

renovated Heritage Building of the Inland Waterways Authority of India (IWA) at Dibrugarh.

36. Mission Basundhara is an initiative of which state government?

- (a) Assam (b) Meghalaya
(c) Arunachal Pradesh (d) Tripura

Answer: A

Explanation

- Under the Assam Government's Mission Basundhara 3.0 initiative, land allotment certificates were formally distributed across Sonitpur district to ensure land rights for indigenous people as well as educational, social, and religious institutions.
- Mission Basundhara was launched to streamline historically disorganised land records that denied families legal ownership and access to institutional credit

37. With reference to Karbi Anglong Ginger, consider the following statements:

1. It is traditionally grown using Jhum and Tila cultivation methods.
2. It is known for mild taste and low pungency compared to other ginger varieties.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

Explanation

- Assam has marked a major agricultural milestone by flagging off its first-ever trial export consignment of 1.2 metric tonnes of GI-tagged Karbi Anglong Ginger to London.
- Karbi Anglong Ginger is a premium variety of ginger known for its distinct aroma, strong pungency, and medicinal properties.
- It has received a Geographical Indication (GI) tag, certifying its unique origin and quality attributes.
- Cultivated mainly in the Singhasan Hills using traditional Jhum (shifting cultivation) and Tila cultivation methods.

Nagaland

38. The Morung system is best described as:

- (a) A state-regulated formal education system based on standardized curricula
(b) A commercial training centre
(c) A religious monastic institution
(d) A community-based indigenous knowledge

system

Answer: D

Explanation

- In the 132nd edition of Mann Ki Baat, Prime Minister highlighted the Naga community's Morung education system.
- He praised its blend of traditional cultural learning with modern subjects like mathematics and science.
- Morung is a traditional community-based indigenous education system of the Naga tribes.

Manipur

39. The Third North-East India Film Festival (NEIFF) 2026 was held in which North-East state?

- (a) Assam (b) Tripura
(c) Meghalaya (d) Manipur

Answer: D

Explanation

- Third North-East India Film Festival (NEIFF) 2026 begins at TanthaPolis Cinema Lamphel, Imphal, Manipur
- The two-day film festival will showcase nine films from across the North East Region, including four Manipuri, four Assamese and one Meghalaya (Khasi) film.

Mizoram

40. Consider the following statements:

1. Chapchar Kut is a spring festival of Mizoram.
2. The Cheraw (bamboo dance) is a major highlight of the festival.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are NOT correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: D

Explanation

- Recently, Mizoram's most important and largest spring festival Chapchar Kut concluded a week-long series of cultural festivities.
- It is a spring festival celebrated in the state of Mizoram.
- It is celebrated during March after completion of their most arduous task of jhum operation i.e., jungle-clearing (clearing of the remnants of burning).
- One of the greatest highlights of Chapchar Kut is the popular bamboo dance called Cheraw

Rajasthan

41. Consider the following statements regarding Human Papillomavirus (HPV):

1. HPV is the most common sexually transmitted infection.
2. There is a permanent cure available for HPV infection.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

Explanation

- The HPV vaccine is a series of shots that can protect you from an HPV infection.
- HPV is the most common sexually transmitted infection (STI), and there are more than 100 types of HPV. Most do not cause health problems.
- Once a person gets HPV, the vaccine may not be as effective.
- It prevents HPV infections that can progress to cancer or genital warts.
- There's no cure for HPV

42. Mount Abu in Rajasthan has been renamed as:

- (a) Abu Nagar (b) Abu Raj
(c) Aravalli Raj (d) Abu Dham

Answer: B

Explanation

- Rajasthan Chief Minister Bhajan Lal Sharma announced in the Assembly that three historic cities will be renamed.
- Mount Abu will now be called Abu Raj.
- Mount Abu is the only hill station in Rajasthan. It is perched on the Aravalli Range while Kaman and Jahazpur have been renamed Kamvan and Yagyapur, respectively.

43. Which state recently removed the two-child eligibility criterion and leprosy-based disqualification for candidates in local body elections?

- (a) Rajasthan (b) Madhya Pradesh
(c) Gujarat (d) Uttar Pradesh

Answer: A

Explanation

- A day after scrapping the two-child norm for panchayat elections, the Rajasthan Assembly passed a Bill for removing the restriction preventing individuals with more than two children from contesting the urban local body (ULB) elections along with removing disqualification based on leprosy.

- The provision for disqualification existed in the State for the last three decades.

44. Nagauri Pan Methi' has been registered under which category by the Protection of Plant Varieties and Farmers' Rights Authority (PPVFRA)?

- (a) Extant variety
- (b) Hybrid variety
- (c) Community farmers' variety
- (d) Transgenic variety

Answer: C

Explanation

- The Protection of Plant Varieties and Farmers' Rights Authority (PPVFRA) formally granted a patent to 'Nagauri Pan Methi' (Nagori fenugreek) (*Trigonella corniculata* L.) under the 'community farmers' variety' category.
- So far, in the absence of intellectual property rights, the 'methi variety' was being categorised as grass and sold as 'kasuri methi' by traders and businessmen.

45. Consider the following statements regarding Rajasthan Day:

1. Rajasthan Day is celebrated on 30 March marking the foundation of the state in 1949.

2. Greater Rajasthan was formed by merging Jaipur, Bikaner, Jodhpur and Jaisalmer.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

- 30 March is celebrated every year as Rajasthan Day.
- Marking the foundation of the state in 1949.
- On January 14, 1949, Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel announced the merger of the princely states of Jaipur, Bikaner, Jodhpur, and Jaisalmer in a public meeting in Udaipur. To implement this announcement, Patel inaugurated Greater Rajasthan in a ceremony in Jaipur on March 30, 1949.

Gujarat

46. Consider the following statements regarding Foot and Mouth Disease (FMD):

1. Vaccination is the only effective preventive measure against FMD.

2. It is characterised by fever and blister-like sores on the tongue, lips, mouth, teats, and between the hooves.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Explanation

- Gujarat Launches Statewide Vaccination Drive Against Foot and Mouth Disease It is a highly contagious viral infection that affects cloven-hoofed animals such as cattle, buffaloes, sheep and goats.
- Cause: It is caused by an Aphthovirus of the family Picornaviridae.
- FMD is characterised by fever and blister-like sores on the tongue and lips, in the mouth, on the teats and between the hooves.
- Treatment: Vaccination is the only effective preventive measure against FMD.

47. The 'Lake and Air Watch' initiative, recently in the news, has been launched by which state government?

- (a) Maharashtra
- (b) Gujarat
- (c) Karnataka
- (d) Tamil Nadu

Answer: B

Explanation

- The Gujarat government has launched the 'Lake and Air Watch' initiative to monitor and improve lake health and air quality across cities using satellite and real-time monitoring systems.
- The 'Lake and Air Watch' initiative is a technology-driven environmental monitoring programme launched by the Gujarat Urban Development Mission (GUDM) under the Urban Development and Urban Housing Department of Gujarat.

48. Madhavpur Mela is associated with:

- (a) Birth of Lord Krishna
- (b) Lifting of Govardhan Hill
- (c) Marriage of Lord Krishna and Rukmini
- (d) Raas Leela celebrations

Answer: C

Explanation

- Prime Minister Narendra Modi extended greetings on the occasion of the Madhavpur Mela being held in Gujarat's Porbandar
- The Madhavpur Mela, which began on Ram Navami, commemorates the marriage of Lord Krishna and Rukmini.

Maharashtra

49. What is the penalty for repeat offenders under the Maharashtra Dharma Swatantrya (Freedom of Religion) Bill, 2026?

- (a) 5 years imprisonment and ₹2 lakh fine

- (b) 7 years imprisonment and ₹5 lakh fine
- (c) 10 years imprisonment and ₹7 lakh fine
- (d) Life imprisonment

Answer: C

Explanation.

- The Maharashtra government introduced the Dharma Swatantrya or Freedom of Religion Bill, 2026, in the Legislative Assembly to regulate religious conversions and provide for punitive action
- The proposed law places the burden of proving voluntary, non-coercive conversion on the person causing or aiding it, and makes offences cognisable and non-bailable.
- The fine increases to Rs. 5 lakh if the offence is committed against a person of unsound mind, a minor, a woman or a person belonging to the Scheduled Castes or the Scheduled Tribes.
- Mass conversions will also attract seven years' imprisonment and a fine of Rs. 5 lakh.
- For repeat offenders, including individuals or organisations, the Bill stipulates a stricter jail term of ten years and a fine of Rs. 7 lakh.

50. Consider the following statements regarding the Maharashtra Land Revenue Code (Amendment) Bill, 2026:

1. It allows municipal corporations and municipal councils to utilise gairan (uncultivated grazing) land within municipal limits for public purposes.
2. The land utilised under the amendment will be recorded as Collector's land.

51. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Explanation

- The Maharashtra Legislative Assembly passed two key revenue related bills aimed at improving administrative efficiency and unlocking unused government land for development works.
- The House cleared the Maharashtra Land Revenue Code Amendment Bill 2026,
- which seek to decentralise administrative powers, enable the use of unused grazing land within municipal limits for public works and speed up the disposal of stamp duty refund cases.
- These lands can only be used for public interest works and cannot be used for commercial purposes. They will be recorded as Collector's land and prior approval from the district

collector will be mandatory.

52. The Yadava dynasty originally served as feudatories of the:

- (a) Western Chalukyas of Badami
- (b) Eastern Chalukyas of Kalyani
- (c) Rashtrakutas
- (d) Hoysalas

Answer: B

Explanation

- the Yadava Dynasty, also known as the Seuna Dynasty, were rulers of a 12th–14th-century Hindu kingdom of central India.
- Originally a feudatory of the Eastern Chalukyas of Kalyani, the dynasty became paramount in the Deccan under Bhillama ((c) 1187–91), who founded Devagiri (later Daulatabad) as his capital.

53. The chemical representation of Oleum is:

- (a) H_2SO_4
- (b) H_2SO_3
- (c) $\text{H}_2\text{SO}_4 \cdot x\text{SO}_3$
- (d) SO_3

Answer: C

Explanation

- A major oleum gas leak at Bhageria Industries Ltd in Boisar, Maharashtra, forced the evacuation of over 2,000 residents, including 1,600 students.
- Oleum, commonly referred to as fuming sulfuric acid, is a highly corrosive chemical consisting of dissolved sulfur trioxide (SO_3) in concentrated sulfuric acid (H_2SO_4). It releases dense white fumes when exposed to moist air.
- Chemical Name: Oleum (Fuming Sulfuric Acid)
- Chemical representation: $\text{H}_2\text{SO}_4 \cdot x\text{SO}_3$

54. The 'Hatti Risala' procession, recently seen in the news, is celebrated in which state?

- (a) Gujarat
- (b) Rajasthan
- (c) Maharashtra
- (d) Madhya Pradesh

Answer: C

Explanation

- In Maharashtra, the historic 'Hatti Risala' procession, a cherished cultural tradition of Jalna, marked its 138th year this Dhulivandan.
- Organized annually on the occasion of Dhulivandan (the day following Holi), the grand procession passes through the city's main roads.

55. 'Gau-Tech 2026', recently in news, is being held in which state?

- (a) Gujarat
- (b) Maharashtra
- (c) Rajasthan
- (d) Madhya Pradesh

Answer: B

Explanation

- The Maharashtra Goseva Commission, in collaboration with the Global Confederation of Cow- Based Industries (GCCBI) and various service-oriented organizations, will organize a grand exhibition titled 'Gau-Tech 2026' from March 20 to 23 at the Agriculture College in Pune

56. Gudi Padwa is observed on which day of the Hindu calendar?

- (a) First day of Chaitra month
- (b) Full moon of Chaitra
- (c) Last day of Phalguna
- (d) First day of Kartik

Answer: A**Explanation**

- Gudi Padwa, also known as Samvatsar Padvo, is observed in Maharashtra and Goa.
- It marks the beginning of Marathi New Year and is also observed as the first day of Chaitra Month.
- Marks the beginning of the Hindu New Year and the Marathi New Year.

57. Bhogapuram International Airport is located in which state?

- (a) Odisha
- (b) Karnataka
- (c) Tamil Nadu
- (d) Andhra Pradesh

Answer: D**Explanation****Airports in News**

- Several greenfield and upgraded airports across India have been inaugurated or are nearing completion during 2025–26.

Bhogapuram International Airport:

- A greenfield airport project to enhance connectivity in coastal Andhra Pradesh.
- Location: Near Visakhapatnam, Andhra Pradesh

Dholera International Airport:

- A greenfield airport supporting the Dholera Special Investment Region (SIR).
- Location: Gujarat

Goa**58. The term "Peth" in the context of the traditional Peth festival of Goddess Kelbai refers to:**

- (a) A sacred forest path used during the procession
- (b) A shrine located in Mayem village
- (c) A ceremonial chariot used for carrying idols
- (d) A wooden rectangular box made of cane in

which the goddess is seated

Answer: D**Explanation**

- The traditional "Peth" festival of goddess Kelbai is being observed at Mulgao in Bicholim, Goa, with rituals commencing at midnight on March 23.
- It is believed that the goddess Kelbai, seated in a peth (a wooden rectangular box made of cane), travels to Gaonkarwada Mayem to meet her sister from the Maya
- Goddess Kelbai meets her sister once a year on the day of Chaitra Shuddha Panchami.

Telangana**59. With reference to petroglyphs, consider the following statements:**

1. They are images engraved or carved on rock surfaces.
2. They are created by removing part of the rock surface.
3. They are the same as paintings made on rocks.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A**Explanation**

- Researchers recently found two ancient rock carvings (petroglyphs) on a flat rock inside a rock shelter on a hill behind Beerappa Temple in Manchirevula, Telangana.
- Petroglyphs (also known as rock engravings) are symbolic images sculpted or engraved on the surface of rocks by removing material from its surface layer with instruments of superior hardness.
- The techniques used to create these images include pecking, incising, abrading, sculpting, polishing, drilling, and scratching.
- These processes remove part of the rock and therefore are different from images simply painted or drawn on rock, which are called petrographs.

60. "Panchanga Sravanam" is associated with which of the following festivals?

- (a) Ugadi
- (b) Gudi Padwa
- (c) Baisakhi
- (d) Vishu

Answer: A**Explanation**

- Ugadi (Yugadi) is the Telugu and Kannada New Year observed in Andhra Pradesh, Telangana and Karnataka.
- The terms Yugadi or Ugadi stem from the Sanskrit words yuga (age) and adi (beginning), denoting the start of a new age.
- Panchanga Sravanam, the reading of the almanac for the new year, is an important ritual.

61. Consider the following statement/s regarding Nd-Fe-B magnets:

1. They are highly resistant to demagnetization.
2. They are used in Magnetic Resonance Imaging (MRI) machines and other diagnostic tools.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Explanation

- India has inaugurated a state-of-the-art pilot plant for manufacturing Nd-Fe-B (Neodymium-Iron-Boron) rare earth permanent magnets at the ARCI, Hyderabad.
- They are highly resistant to becoming demagnetized once they have been charged.
- Nd-Fe-B magnets, often called super magnets, are the strongest type of permanent magnets commercially available today.
- Essential for robotics, industrial automation, and high-precision sensors.
- Used in Magnetic Resonance Imaging (MRI) machines and other diagnostic tools.

62. The World Buddhist Peace Conference 2026 will be hosted in which state?

- (a) Telangana
(b) Andhra Pradesh
(c) Karnataka
(d) Tamil Nadu

Answer: A

Explanation

- Hyderabad is set to host the World Buddhist Peace Conference 2026, an international gathering aimed at promoting peace and cultural exchange with participation over 20 countries.

Andhra Pradesh

63. Which organisation is set to become the first in India to receive the Government of India's Pramaan certification under IFWCS?

- (a) Forest Survey of India

- (b) Andhra Pradesh Forest Development Corporation
(c) National Afforestation Programme Authority
(d) Indian Council of Forestry Research and Education

Answer: B

Explanation

- Andhra Pradesh Forest Development Corporation (APFDC) is set to become the first agency in the country to receive the Government of India's Pramaan certification under the Indian Forest and Wood Certification Scheme (IFWCS),
- The Pramaan (Programme for Recognition and Accreditation of Sustainable Management Practices for Agroforestry and Natural Forestry Resources), was launched in 2023 by the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change.

64. The world's first Autonomous Maritime Shipbuilding and Systems Centre is being established in:

- (a) Tamil Nadu (b) Gujarat
(c) Andhra Pradesh (d) Maharashtra

Answer: C

Explanation

- India has taken a major step towards strengthening its maritime and defence manufacturing capabilities with the foundation of the world's first Autonomous Maritime Shipbuilding and Systems Centre in Andhra Pradesh.
- The facility is being developed by Mumbai-based Sagar Defence Engineering at the Juvvaladinne fishing harbour in Nellore district

65. Project HANUMAN, recently launched by the Government of Andhra Pradesh, primarily aims to:

- (a) Promote eco-tourism in forest areas
(b) Address human-wildlife conflict and rehabilitate wildlife
(c) Increase agricultural productivity near forest regions
(d) Develop new wildlife sanctuaries

Answer: B

Explanation

- The Government of Andhra Pradesh launched Project HANUMAN on World Wildlife Day 2026 to address the rising human-wildlife conflict in the state.
- Project HANUMAN stands for Healing and Nurturing Units for Monitoring, Aid and Nursing of Wildlife.

- It is a state-level wildlife protection and conflict mitigation initiative aimed at rescuing, treating, rehabilitating, and monitoring wildlife while protecting communities near forests.

66. Operation Vajra Prahar is associated with:

- (a) Counter-terrorism operations
- (b) Drug trafficking crackdown
- (c) Cybersecurity initiative
- (d) Anti-corruption drive

Answer: B

Explanation

- Police launch 'Operation Vajra Prahar' to combat drug trafficking in Anantapur
- The Anantapur district police launched Operation Vajra Prahar in March 2026 as a major initiative to combat drug trafficking and substance abuse.
- This operation is part of a statewide crackdown in Andhra Pradesh aimed at eliminating the sale and distribution of narcotics, particularly ganja (cannabis)

Karnataka

67. Karnataka government proposed banning the use of social media for which age group of children?

- (a) Below 12 years (b) Below 14 years
- (c) Below 16 years (d) Below 18 years

Answer: C

Explanation

- Karnataka Chief Minister announced in the 2026–27 Karnataka State Budget that the state plans to ban social media use for children below 16 years.
- The initiative seeks to protect minors from digital addiction, cyberbullying, misinformation exposure, and mental health issues linked to excessive online engagement.

68. Aghanashini River, recently in news, flows into:

- (a) Arabian Sea
- (b) Bay of Bengal
- (c) Andaman Sea
- (d) Lakshadweep Sea

Answer: A

Explanation

Aghanashini River:

- It is in central Uttara Kannada district of Karnataka originates in the Western Ghats and flows westward towards Arabian Sea.
- Aghanashini, meaning the "Remover of Sins"

69. CALM-Brain is best described as:

- (a) A mental health awareness campaign
- (b) A national insurance scheme for mental health
- (c) A drug development program
- (d) A digital database integrating multi-dimensional psychiatric data

Answer: D

Explanation

- Researchers at the Rohini Nilekani Centre for Brain and Mind (CBM), a partnership between the National Institute of Mental Health and Neuro Sciences (NIMHANS) and the National Centre for Biological Sciences (NCBS) - TIFR, have developed CALM-Brain,
- It is a first-of-its-kind digital repository of data in India on brain structure and function from a range of psychiatric disorders.

Kerala

70. Nirbhaya Nisha initiative, recently seen in the news, has been launched by which state?

- (a) Kerala (b) Tamil Nadu
- (c) Karnataka (d) Maharashtra

Answer: A

Explanation

- The Kerala Police has announced the launch of the Nirbhaya Nisha initiative to enhance the safety of women travelling at night across the state.
- Nirbhaya Nisha is a women's safety initiative launched by the Kerala Police to provide immediate assistance to women travelling at night.

71. The "MeHEALTH" mobile application, which provides information on nearby government health facilities, doctor appointments, laboratory tests, and hospital services, has been launched by which state government?

- (a) Tamil Nadu (b) Karnataka
- (c) Kerala (d) Telangana

Answer: C

Explanation

- Kerala Health Department has launched the MeHEALTH app for getting information about the nearby government health facilities. With the help of this app, users can find details of nearby hospitals within 10 kilometres, including available specialities, laboratory tests and their rates.
- Information on services such as blood banks, radiology units, pharmacies, and pay wards in

hospitals is also available on the platform.

72. The AI-powered “G-SPIDER” robot, recently seen in the news for canal cleaning, has been deployed in which city?

- (a) Kochi (b) Thiruvananthapuram
(c) Chennai (d) Bengaluru

Answer: B

Explanation

- Recently, under Swachh Bharat Mission–Urban 2.0, Thiruvananthapuram Municipal Corporation has deployed an AI-powered G- SPIDER robot
- It is an automated canal cleaning robot, created by Genrobotic Innovations.

73. Consider the following statements regarding the Attukal Pongala festival:

- The festival is dedicated to Goddess Kannaki, identified with Bhadrakali.
- It is known as one of the largest congregations of men in the world.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

Explanation

- Attukal Pongala festival - It is a 10-day long festival celebrated annually at Attukal Bhagavathy Temple in Trivandrum, Kerala.
- This festival is dedicated to Attukal Bhagavathy, also known as Goddess Kannaki or Bhadrakali.
- It is one of the largest congregation of women for a festival in the world.

74. A 2,000-year-old laterite rock-cut chamber discovered in Panayal, Kerala, is associated with which archaeological period?

- (a) Neolithic Period
(b) Chalcolithic Period
(c) Megalithic Period
(d) Gupta Period

Answer: C

Explanation

- A 2,000-year-old laterite rock-cut chamber from the Megalithic period was recently unearthed during construction work in Panayal, Kasaragod district of Kerala.
- These are subterranean burial structures carved directly into laterite rock.

75 ‘Akasha300’, recently in news, is:

- (a) A satellite launch vehicle
(b) A high-temperature 3D printer

(c) A space telescope

(d) A missile system

Answer: B

Explanation

- e Kerala start-up delivers cutting-edge Akasha300 3D Printer to ISRO in a major step towards India’s self-reliance in advanced manufacturing.
- a high-temperature multi-material extrusion 3D printer.
- is backed by the Space Technology Innovation and Incubation Centre at IIST and the Kerala Startup Mission

76. Which state launched MLATrack.com, India’s first platform to track legislative interventions of MLAs?

- (a) Tamil Nadu (b) Karnataka
(c) Kerala (d) Maharashtra

Answer: C

Explanation

- Kerala has launched ‘MLATrack.com’, India’s first platform to track the legislative interventions of MLAs.
- MLATrack.com is a public digital database platform that aggregates and presents data on the performance and legislative activities of Members of the Kerala Legislative Assembly (2021–2026).

Tamil nadu

77. The “Digital Twin” initiative, recently seen in news in the context of port management in India, is best described as:

- (a) A satellite-based navigation system for ships in deep sea
(b) A blockchain system used for maritime trade payments
(c) A digital platform for online cargo booking and customs clearance
(d) A virtual replica of physical infrastructure that uses real-time data for monitoring and analysis

Answer: D

Explanation

- Digital Twin is a virtual representation of a physical object or system that uses real-time data to accurately reflect its real-world counterpart’s behavior, performance and conditions.
- Digital twins enable continuous monitoring, simulation and analysis of an object, product or system over the course of its lifecycle, from

design and production to maintenance and decommissioning.

- Digital Twin for Port Management: It will create a real-time virtual replica of the port's infrastructure, operational assets, and maritime ecosystem, enabling enhanced operational visibility, predictive analytics, and data-driven decision-making across the port.

78. 'Kovai Digi Cop', recently seen in the news, was introduced by the police of which state?

- (a) Karnataka (b) Tamil Nadu
(c) Kerala (d) Telangana

Answer: B

Explanation.

- The Coimbatore District Police, Tamil Nadu introduced 'Kovai Digi Cop,' a new WhatsApp-based chatbot designed to provide citizens with easy digital access to various police services and emergency assistance.
- 'Kovai Digi Cop' is a first-of-its-kind chatbot aimed at providing easy digital access for the public.

79. Tamil Nadu's first Dark Sky Park has been inaugurated at:

- (a) Anamalai Tiger Reserve

- (b) Mudumalai National Park
(c) Ariyur Shola Reserve Forest
(d) Kalakkad Mundanthurai Tiger Reserve

Answer: C

Explanation

- Tamil Nadu has inaugurated its first Dark Sky Park at the Ariyur Shola Reserve Forest in Kolli Hills, Namakkal district.

80. Masi Magam festival is celebrated by which of the following communities?

- (a) Toda (b) Irular
(c) Bhil (d) Santhal

Answer: B

Explanation

- Masi Magam, an auspicious day in the Tamil calendar holds significance for the Irular community which is deeply tied to their culture and collective identity.
- They are a Dravidian ethnic group; they reside in the Nilgiri Mountains of the Western Ghats, spread across Tamil Nadu and Kerala.
- They are one of India's oldest indigenous communities.

Defence

1. Pinaka, recently in news, is a:

- (a) Surface-to-air missile system
(b) Multi-barrel rocket launcher system
(c) Ballistic missile
(d) Anti-tank guided missile

Answer: B

Explanation

- Pinaka is an indigenous, multi-barrel rocket launcher (MBRL) system capable of firing a salvo of 12 rockets in under 44 seconds.
- It is a high-volume, area-saturation weapon designed to neutralize enemy troop concentrations and infrastructure over large areas.
- Developed By: the Armament Research and Development Establishment (ARDE).

2. The Sejjil ballistic missile, recently seen in the news, is developed by which country?

- (a) Iran (b) Israel
(c) Russia (d) North Korea

Answer: A

Explanation

- Iran officially deployed the Sejjil ballistic missile for the first time in active combat during Wave

54 of its military operations against US and Israeli positions.

- The missile, nicknamed the dancing missile for its evasive maneuvers, reportedly struck strategic infrastructure.
- The Sejjil (also known as Sajjil or Ashura) is an indigenous, two-stage, medium-range ballistic missile (MRBM).
- Developed By: The missile was indigenously developed by Iran's aerospace industries.

3. Freedom Shield 26 is a joint military exercise between:

- (a) USA and Japan
(b) USA and South Korea
(c) USA and Australia
(d) South Korea and Japan

Answer: B

Explanation

- The United States and South Korea officially launched the annual Freedom Shield 26 joint military exercise on March 9, 2026.
- The large-scale drills are scheduled to run for 11 days, concluding on March 19, 2026.

4. Operation Sankalp, recently seen in the news,

was launched by which country?

- (a) United States (b) India
(c) United Kingdom (d) France

Answer: B

Explanation

- Against the backdrop of escalating tensions in West Asia, Indian Navy warships deployed under Operation Sankalp have been placed on standby for potential Humanitarian Assistance and Disaster Relief (HADR) operations.
- Operation Sankalp (Sanskrit for Commitment) is the Indian Navy's proactive maritime security initiative launched to ensure the safety of Indian-flagged merchant vessels and maintain regional stability in the Indian Ocean Region (IOR).

5. The 2026 edition of Exercise Sea Dragon is being conducted at:

- (a) Diego Garcia (b) Guam
(c) Okinawa (d) Hawaii

Answer: B

Explanation

- The Indian Navy is participating in Exercise Sea Dragon 2026, a United States-led multinational anti-submarine warfare (ASW) drill being conducted at Andersen Air Force Base in Guam.
- Exercise Sea Dragon is a US-led multinational anti-submarine warfare (ASW) exercise conducted in the Western Pacific Ocean near Guam.
- Initiated by the United States Navy as an annual multinational ASW training exercise to strengthen Indo-Pacific maritime security cooperation.

6. The approximate maximum range of the Minuteman III intercontinental ballistic missile is:

- (a) 5,000 km (b) 8,000 km
(c) 10,000 km (d) 13,000 km

Answer: D

Explanation

- The United States has carried out a test launch of the Minuteman III intercontinental ballistic missile (ICBM), often referred to as the "doomsday missile", at a time when tensions with Iran remain high.
- The LGM-30G Minuteman III is an American-made intercontinental ballistic missile (ICBM).
- Range: It has a maximum range of approximately 13,000 kilometres.

7. The Vajra Corps was raised in which year?

- (a) 1947 (b) 1950
(c) 1962 (d) 1971

Answer: B

Explanation

- The Indian Army's Vajra Corps marked its 76th Raising Day on 2nd march, commemorating over seven decades of distinguished service to the Nation.
- Raised in 1950, it was the first Indian Army Corps to be raised post-Independence.

8. The 'Vayu Shakti-2026' exercise was held in which state?

- (a) Gujarat (b) Rajasthan
(c) Haryana (d) Madhya Pradesh

Answer: B

Explanation

- The President of India Smt Droupadi Murmu witnessed the 'Vayu Shakti-2026' exercise at the Pokhran Firing Range, Jaisalmer, Rajasthan.

- Conducted By : Indian Air Force

9. Prachand, India's indigenous Light Combat Helicopter, has been designed and manufactured by:

- (a) Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)
(b) Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)
(c) Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL)
(d) Bharat Dynamics Limited (BDL)

Answer: C

Explanation

- Prachand is India's first indigenously designed and developed dedicated combat helicopter, built specifically for offensive roles in high-altitude and battlefield environments.
- It is a multi-role light attack helicopter capable of air-to-air and air-to-ground missions, including anti-armour and counter-insurgency operations.
- Designed and manufactured by Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL) under the Light Combat Helicopter (LCH) programme.

10. The ALH Mk-III (MR) helicopters will be supplied by:

- (a) Bharat Electronics Limited
(b) Hindustan Aeronautics Limited
(c) Larsen & Toubro
(d) Bharat Dynamics Limited

Answer: B

Explanation

- Ministry of Defence, on March 03, 2026, signed contracts worth a total of Rs 5,083 crore for the acquisition of six Advanced Light Helicopters (ALH) Mk- II (Maritime Role) for the Indian Coast Guard and Surface-to-Air Vertical Launch - Shtil

missiles for the Indian Navy.

- The contract for ALH Mk-III (MR) along with operational role equipment, an engineering support package, and performance-based logistics support, has been inked with Hindustan Aeronautics Limited, Bengaluru .
- The contract for the procurement of Surface-to-Air Vertical Launch - Shtil missiles and associated missile holding frames, has been signed with JSC Rosoboronexport, Russian Federation.

11. The Central Industrial Security Force (CISF) was established in which year?

- (a) 1965 (b) 1968
(c) 1969 (d) 1971

Answer: C

Explanation

- Union Home Minister and Minister of Cooperation Shri Amit Shah will address the 57th Raising Day ceremony of the Central Industrial Security Force (CISF) as the Chief Guest on, 06 March 2026, in Mundali, Odisha.
- India celebrates CISF Raising Day on March 10 every year to honour the Central Industrial Security Forces of India (CISF)
- The Central Industrial Security Force (CISF) is the Union's military force, founded by an Act of Parliament in 1968 (50 of 1968), and was established in 1969.

12. With reference to Shahed attack drones, consider the following statements:

1. They are developed by Iran.
2. Russia refers to these drones as Geran-1 and Geran-2.
3. The Shahed-131 drone has an approximate range of 700–2500 km.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation

- Shahed (meaning witness in Farsi) drones are low-cost, one- way-attack unmanned aerial vehicles (UAVs) developed by Iran.
- Often referred to as “kamikaze” or “suicide” drones, they function essentially as guided missiles that fly towards a pre- designated target and explode on impact.
- Most widely used variants: Shahed-131 and Shahed-136
- Russia refers to the Shahed-131 and Shahed-136 as “Geran-1” and “Geran-2,” respectively.
- The Shahed-131 has a range of 700–900 km, while the Shahed- 136 has the longer range, i.e.,

between 2,000 and 2,500 kilometres.

13. Which one of the following best distinguishes a gravity bomb from a missile?

- (a) A gravity bomb is powered by rocket propulsion.
- (b) A missile relies entirely on gravity for its trajectory.
- (c) A gravity bomb is unpowered and follows a free-fall trajectory after release.
- (d) A gravity bomb can only be launched from submarines.

Answer: C

Explanation

- A gravity bomb, often referred to as a free-fall or dumb bomb, is an unpowered munition that does not possess an internal propulsion system or engine.
- Unlike a missile, which flies under its own power, a gravity bomb relies entirely on the laws of physics and the momentum of the aircraft to reach its target.

14. With reference to the Exercise LAMITIYE, consider the following statements:

1. It is a joint military exercise conducted between India and Seychelles.
2. The exercise has been conducted in Seychelles since 2001.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Explanation

- Indian Armed Forces contingent arrived at Seychelles to participate in the Eleventh edition of Joint Military Exercise “LAMITIYE-2026” with Seychelles Defence Forces (SDF).
- The Joint Exercise will be conducted at Seychelles Defence Academy from 09-20 March 2026.
- ‘LAMITIYE’ meaning ‘Friendship’ in the Creole language is a biennial training event
- It has been conducted in Seychelles since 2001.

15. Cold Response is a military exercise conducted by which organisation?

- (a) European Union
- (b) North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO)
- (c) Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO)
- (d) Organisation for Security and Co-operation in Europe (OSCE)

Answer: B

Explanation

- NATO has begun the 2026 edition of the Cold Response military exercise in the Arctic.
- Cold Response is a large-scale biennial NATO military exercise conducted in the European Arctic, primarily in northern Norway and surrounding regions, designed to test the alliance's ability to defend NATO territory under extreme Arctic conditions.
- Nations Involved: North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO)

16. The Terminal High Altitude Area Defense (THAAD) system, recently in the news, has been developed by which country?

- (a) Russia (b) China
(c) United States (d) Israel

Answer: C

Explanation

- Recently, Iran has destroyed a key Terminal High Altitude Area Defence (THAAD) radar system used by the US to detect and intercept ballistic missiles in the Middle East.
- The Terminal High Altitude Area Defence (THAAD) system is one of the most advanced missile defence platforms.
- It is developed by the United States to counter ballistic missile threats.

17. The "Blue Sparrow" missile, recently seen in the news, has been developed by which country?

- (a) United States (b) Russia
(c) Israel (d) France

Answer: C

Explanation

- Israel reportedly used the Blue Sparrow missile to kill Ayatollah Ali Khamenei in Tehran recently.
- It is part of a family of three air-launched ballistic missiles, which also includes the Black Sparrow and the Silver Sparrow.
- They are developed by Rafael Advanced Defense Systems, an Israeli defense technology company.

18. With reference to the Precision Strike Missile (PrSM), consider the following statements:

1. It has a strike range of about 60 km to over 499 km.
2. It is designed for air-to-air combat operations.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

Explanation

- The Precision Strike Missile (PrSM) is a long-range, surface-to-surface precision-guided missile designed for deep-strike operations against enemy targets such as air defenses, command centers, and logistics hubs.
- It is intended to replace the Army Tactical Missile System (ATACMS) used by the United States.
- Developed by: Lockheed Martin (USA) for the United States Army.
- Can be launched from M270 Multiple Launch Rocket System (MLRS) and M142 High Mobility Artillery Rocket System (HIMARS). Can strike targets from about 60 km to over 499 km, significantly farther than ATACMS (~300 km).

19. The in-flight release trials of the Air Droppable Container (ADC-150) were conducted jointly by which of the following?

- (a) ISRO and Indian Navy
(b) DRDO and Indian Air Force
(c) DRDO and Indian Navy
(d) HAL and Indian Navy

Answer: C

Explanation

- Defence Research & Development Organisation (DRDO) and the Indian Navy jointly conducted four successful in-flight release trials of the indigenous Air Droppable Container 'ADC-150' from the P8I aircraft off the coast of Goa between February 21 to March 01, 2026
- Indigenously designed and developed to deliver 150 kg payload, the Air Droppable Container enhances the naval operational logistics capabilities for providing quick response to naval vessels under distress, needing critical stores/equipment, medical assistance etc at blue sea deployed far from the coast.

20. "Team Kalki", recently seen in the news, is associated with:

- (a) A pan-India drug distribution network busted by the Narcotics Control Bureau
(b) A cyber-security task force of the Government of India
(c) A counter-terrorism operation by the National Investigation Agency
(d) A financial fraud investigation by the Enforcement Directorate

Answer: A

Explanation

- Recently, the Narcotics Control Bureau (NCB) has

dismantled a pan-India drug distribution network operating under the name Team Kalki.

- Narcotics Control Bureau is the nodal drug law enforcement and intelligence agency under the Ministry of Home Affairs, Government of India.

21. Sargam 2026 is related to which of the following?

- (a) A joint naval military exercise
- (b) A maritime security conference
- (c) A naval technology exhibition
- (d) A musical performance by the Indian Naval Symphonic Orchestra

Answer: D

Explanation

- Sargam 2026, a performance by the Indian Naval Symphonic Orchestra that celebrates the Indian Navy's rich traditions through a blend of military, classical, and contemporary music, at Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi
- The band presented a vibrant musical repertoire featuring Hindustani fusion to Brazilian samba-inspired compositions.

22. Sheshnaag-150, recently in the news, is:

- (a) A hypersonic cruise missile
- (b) A long-range swarm attack drone
- (c) A satellite launch vehicle
- (d) An anti-tank guided missile

Answer: B

Explanation

- India is developing the Sheshnaag-150, a long-range swarm attack drone that can fly over 1,000 km, carry powerful warheads and strike targets.
- It is being developed by NewSpace Research and Technologies (NRT), a Bengaluru-based aerospace startup focusing on AI-driven unmanned systems and swarm robotics.

23. "Sagar Kavach" is a:

- (a) Cybersecurity exercise
- (b) Coastal security drill
- (c) Air defence exercise
- (d) Space mission

Answer: B

Explanation

- A mock drill titled "Sagar Kavach" is being conducted along the Mahe and Kerala coasts as part of efforts to strengthen national security and safeguard India's coastline.
- The exercise is aimed at preventing destructive and other unlawful activities in coastal areas.

24. Operation Sagar Bandhu primarily aims to:

- (a) Strengthen coastal surveillance along India's borders
- (b) Rapidly deploy specialised engineering support to friendly nations
- (c) Conduct joint naval combat exercises in the Indian Ocean
- (d) Monitor maritime trade routes in the Arabian Sea

Answer: B

Explanation

- Operation Sagar Bandhu demonstrates the Indian Army's ability to rapidly deploy specialised engineering capabilities in support of friendly nations.
- The operation reflects the country's strengthened regional resilience, vision of cooperative security and humanitarian partnership in the Indian Ocean region.

25. INS Sudarshini has been built by:

- (a) Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited
- (b) Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers
- (c) Hindustan Shipyard Limited
- (d) Goa Shipyard Limited

Answer: D

Explanation

- INS Sudarshini arrived at Valletta, Malta for expedition Lokayan-26
- INS Sudarshini was built by Goa Shipyard Limited.

26 Future Combat Air System (FCAS) was initially established by _____ and _____.

- (a) United Kingdom and Italy
- (b) France and Germany
- (c) United States and Canada
- (d) Russia and China

Answer: B

Explanation

About Future Combat Air System (FCAS):

- A Next Generation Weapon System (NGWS) that includes a Next- Generation Fighter (NGF), unmanned Remote Carriers, and an Air Combat Cloud.
- The FCAS is Europe's other major 6th-generation project, designed to create a networked combat environment for the mid-21st century.
- Established By: France and Germany, later joined by Spain.
- Members: France, Germany, and Spain.

27. INS Taragiri has been built by _____.

- (a) Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL)
- (b) Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)
- (c) Mazagon Dock Shipbuilding Limited (MDL)
- (d) Cochin Shipyard Limited (CSL)

Answer: C

Explanation

- The Indian Navy is preparing to commission its latest stealth Frigate, Taragiri (F41), on 03 Apr 2026.
- It is the fourth ship of Nilgiri Class (Project 17A) built by Mazagon Dock Shipbuilding Ltd (MDL).
- It is designed by the Warship Design Bureau (WDB).

28. Exercise Amogh Jwala, recently in news, was conducted in which state?

- (a) Uttar Pradesh (b) Rajasthan
- (c) Madhya Pradesh (d) Maharashtra

Answer: A

Explanation

- The Pune-based Southern Command of the Indian Army conducted Exercise Amogh Jwala at the Babina field firing ranges in Uttar Pradesh
- The 13-day exercise from March 6 to 18 validated the deployment of mechanised forces with newly inducted Apache attack helicopters, fighter aircraft, drone and counter-drone systems and network-enabled battlefield platforms.

29. The Tunguska Air Defence Missile System is procured from which country?

- (a) Russia (b) France
- (c) USA (d) Israel

Answer: A

Explanation

- The Ministry of Defence signed a Rs 445 crore contract with Russia's JSC Rosoboronexport, to procure the Tunguska Air Defence Missile System for the Indian Army.
- The Tunguska (NATO reporting name: SA-19 Grison) is a Soviet-origin, tracked, self-propelled anti-aircraft weapon system.

30. Consider the following statements regarding the Advanced Short Range Air-to-Air Missile (ASRAAM):

1. It is a European-designed missile developed by MBDA.
2. It operates on a fire-and-forget principle.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are NOT correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only

- (c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: D

Explanation

- The Indian Air Force is set to equip its fleet of MiG- 29 fighter jets with the Advanced Short Range Air- to-Air Missile, or ASRAAM(Advanced Short Range Air-to-Air Missile).
- It is a European-designed short-range air-to-air missile built by the multinational company MBDA.
- It operates on a fire-and-forget principle, which means once launched; the missile guides itself to the target without further input from the pilot.

31. IMEX TTX 2026 was conducted at which of the following locations?

- (a) Eastern Naval Command, Visakhapatnam
- (b) INS Kadamba, Karwar
- (c) Maritime Warfare Centre, Southern Naval Command, Kochi
- (d) Western Naval Command, Mumbai

Answer: C

Explanation

- The Indian Navy hosted IONS Maritime Exercise (IMEX) TTX 2026 at the Maritime Warfare Centre, Southern Naval Command, Kochi on 27 March 2026.
- As India assumes the IONS Chairmanship for the 2026– 2028 cycle after a gap of sixteen years, IMEX TTX 2026 .

32. Shaurya Squadrons are best described as:

- (a) Artillery units for long-range missiles
- (b) Cyber warfare units
- (c) Special forces for counter-terrorism
- (d) Drone sub-units embedded within armoured regiments

Answer: D

Explanation

- The Indian Army recently began fielding Shaurya Squadrons, dedicated drone sub-units embedded within armoured regiments.
- Shaurya Squadrons are dedicated drone sub-units being inducted into the Indian Army's armoured egiments.

33. What is Operation Urja Suraksha?

- (a) A renewable energy mission to boost solar power in India
- (b) A maritime security operation to safeguard India's energy supply routes
- (c) A scheme to increase domestic oil production
- (d) A diplomatic initiative for energy trade agreements

Answer: B**Explanation**

- Operation Urja Suraksha is a strategic maritime security mission launched by the Indian Navy to ensure the safe transit of India-bound energy cargo vessels from the Persian Gulf region.

34. The Qader missile has been developed by:

- (a) Iran (b) United States
(c) China (d) Russia

Answer: A**Explanation**

- Recently, Iran fired Qader cruise missiles at the USS Abraham Lincoln aircraft carrier.

- It is a medium-range shore-based anti-ship cruise missile developed by Iran and deployed by its naval forces.

35. 'Vayu Baan', recently seen in news, is:

- (a) surface-to-air missile
(b) A satellite system
(c) A fighter aircraft
(d) A helicopter-launched drone system

Answer: D**Explanation**

- The Indian Air Force (IAF) has initiated Vayu Baan, a pioneering project to develop India's first helicopter-launched drone system.
- It is a small, autonomous drone designed to be dropped from a moving helicopter mid-flight.

Science & tech

1. Which one of the following correctly represents the composition of 'X' in MXenes?

- (a) Only oxygen
(b) Sulphur
(c) Hydrogen
(d) Carbon and/or nitrogen

Answer: D**Explanation**

- Recently, the IIT Guwahati research team developed a MXene- based catalyst that can both produce hydrogen efficiently from water and act as a photocatalyst for desalination.
- MXenes are a group of two-dimensional materials first discovered in 2011.
- They are made from a bulk crystal called MAX.
- They have the general formula of $M_{n+1}X_nT_x$, where M is an early transition metal, X is carbon and/or nitrogen, and T is a functional group on the surface of an MXene (typically O, OH, and F).
- Among various types of MXenes, titanium carbide (Ti_3C_2Tx) is the most widely used.

2. The Floating LiDAR Buoy System, recently in news, was tested by which of the following institutions?

- (a) Indian National Centre for Ocean Information Services (INCOIS)
(b) National Institute of Ocean Technology (NIOT)
(c) National Centre for Coastal Research (NCCR)
(d) Indian Institute of Tropical Meteorology (IITM)

Answer: B**Explanation**

- Recently, the National Institute of Ocean

Technology (NIOT) has successfully tested an indigenously developed Floating LiDAR Buoy System off the coast of Muttom in Tamil Nadu.

- It is a high-tech ocean-based instrument used to measure wind conditions over the sea.
- It combines a floating platform (buoy) with LiDAR technology, short for Light Detection and Ranging.

3. The Ladakh Magmatic Arc developed due to:

- (a) Divergence of tectonic plates
(b) Continental rifting
(c) Transform plate boundaries
(d) Convergence and subduction of tectonic plates

Answer: D**Explanation**

- Recently, scientists have traced the evolution of the Ladakh Magmatic Arc (LMA) in North West Himalaya.
- It is a belt of igneous rocks in the Trans-Himalaya formed in the period Jurassic to Eocene– 201.3 million years ago to 33.9 Million Year (Ma).
- The LMA is a long-extinct volcanic system evolved through three major phases of geological activity over tens of millions of years.
- Millions of years before the region that is now called Ladakh lay above an ocean called the Neo-Tethys Ocean.
- Below that ancient sea, giant slabs of Earth's crust slowly plunged into the mantle in a process known as subduction leading to the formation of the Ladakh Magmatic Arc (LMA).

4. Progerinin, recently seen in news, is being developed for the treatment of:

- (a) Alzheimer's disease
- (b) Hutchinson-Gilford Progeria Syndrome
- (c) Parkinson's disease
- (d) Muscular dystrophy

Answer: B

Explanation

- U.S.-based Sentyln Therapeutics (part of Zydus Lifesciences) recently signed a deal with South Korea's PRG S&T to develop Progerinin, a pill aimed at treating Hutchinson-Gilford progeria syndrome (HGPS).

Hutchinson-Gilford Progeria Syndrome (HGPS)

- Progeria, also known as HGPS, is an extremely rare genetic disease that causes rapid aging in children.
- Progeria is extremely rare. It occurs in 1 in every 4 million live births worldwide.

5. The principle behind the functioning of an atomic clock used in satellite navigation systems is based on the:

- (a) Oscillation of quartz crystals
- (b) Vibrations of atoms such as rubidium or cesium
- (c) Rotation of electrons around the nucleus
- (d) Mechanical spring oscillations

Answer: B

Explanation

- ISRO recently reported that the atomic clock on the IRNSS-1F satellite has failed, reducing the number of functional positioning satellites in the NavIC constellation.
- An atomic clock is an ultra-precise timekeeping device that uses the vibrations of atoms (usually Rubidium or Cesium) to measure time.
- In navigation satellites, these clocks are essential because even a billionth of a second of error can lead to a location inaccuracy of several meters on the ground.

6. The Silverpit Crater, recently in the news, is located beneath the seabed of the:

- (a) Baltic Sea
- (b) Mediterranean Sea
- (c) North Sea
- (d) Barents Sea

Answer: C

Explanation

- New research has confirmed that the Silverpit Crater was formed by a massive asteroid impact millions of years ago.

- Location: It lies about 700 meters beneath the seabed in the North Sea, roughly 80 miles off the coast of Yorkshire, United Kingdom.
- Silverpit is buried under a huge layer of sediment and was only discovered in 2002.

6. Consider the following statements regarding the Artemis II mission:

- 1. It will be the first crewed mission of NASA's Artemis program.**
- 2. The mission aims to land astronauts on the Mars' surface.**

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

Explanation

- NASA clears its Artemis 2 moon rocket for April launch with four astronauts. The rocket will be crewed by three American astronauts – mission commander Reid Wiseman, Victor Glover and Christina Koch — and Canadian astronaut Jeremy Hansen.
- NASA is set to launch its first crewed mission to the lunar vicinity since 1972. The mission, known as Artemis II, involves the Space Launch System (SLS) rocket and the Orion spacecraft.
- Artemis II is a 10-day mission aiming to validate critical life support and re-entry systems in deep space.

7. The DART mission (Double Asteroid Redirection Test), recently seen in news, was launched by:

- (a) European Space Agency (ESA)
- (b) Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)
- (c) National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA)
- (d) Japan Aerospace Exploration Agency (JAXA)

Answer: C

Explanation

- A recent scientific study has revealed that NASA's Double Asteroid Redirection Test (DART) mission produced a greater impact than initially expected.
- The experiment not only changed the motion of a small asteroid within its binary system but also slightly altered the entire system's orbit around the Sun.
- The DART mission targeted Dimorphos, a small asteroid that orbits a larger asteroid called Didymos.

8. The Van Allen spacecraft, recently in the news, was launched by which space agency?

- (a) European Space Agency (ESA)
- (b) National Aeronautics and Space

- Administration (NASA)
- (c) Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)
- (d) Japan Aerospace Exploration Agency (JAXA)

Answer: B

Explanation

- The Van Allen Probes (A and B) were launched by NASA
 - The Van Allen spacecraft, which is more than 600 kilogrammes, is expected to re-enter Earth's atmosphere almost 14 years after its launch.
 - According to Nasa, the Van Allen Probe A and its twin, Van Allen Probe B, were launched on August 30, 2012, to study the radiation belts around Earth after which they are named.
- 9. Asteroid 2024 YR4 belongs to which category of asteroids?**
- (a) Amor-type asteroid
 - (b) Main-belt asteroid
 - (c) Trojan asteroid
 - (d) Apollo-type asteroid

Answer: D

Explanation

- NASA has officially ruled out the possibility of asteroid 2024 YR4 colliding with the Moon on December 22, 2032.
 - Refined calculations using the James Webb Space Telescope (JWST) have confirmed the object will pass at a safe distance of 21,200 km.
 - 2024 YR4 is a Near-Earth Object (NEO) classified as an Apollo-type asteroid (Earth-crossing).
- 10. The Proba-3 mission is being developed by which space agency?**
- (a) National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA)
 - (b) Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)
 - (c) European Space Agency (ESA)
 - (d) Japan Aerospace Exploration Agency (JAXA)

Answer: C

Explanation

- Recently, the European Space Agency (Esa) has lost contact with one of the two spacecraft powering its Proba-3 mission.
 - It is the European Space Agency's (ESA) first mission dedicated to precision formation flying.
 - It is the innovative mission which will demonstrate precision formation flying between two satellites to create an artificial eclipse, revealing new views of the Sun's faint corona.
- 11. Recently, Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL) signed an MoU with which space-tech startup to develop Very Low Earth Orbit (VLEO) satellite systems?**
- (a) Skyroot Aerospace

- (b) Dhruva Space
- (c) Agnikul Cosmos
- (d) Bellatrix Aerospace

Answer: D

Explanation

- State-run defense major Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL) and space-tech startup Bellatrix Aerospace have signed an MoU to jointly develop Very Low Earth Orbit (VLEO) satellite systems.
 - The collaboration is a strategic partnership to design, develop, and manufacture next-generation satellite platforms and payloads specifically for the Very Low Earth Orbit (VLEO). It combines high-end defense electronics manufacturing with innovative satellite propulsion technologies.
- 12. Devon Island, recently in the news as a Mars research site used by NASA, is located in which country?**
- (a) Norway
 - (b) Russia
 - (c) Canada
 - (d) Denmark

Answer: C

Explanation

- NASA uses Devon Island to study Mars, primarily because it's barren and its freezing, polar desert conditions allow researchers to test next-generation rovers.
 - It is located in the Canadian arctic archipelago, within the zone classified as the High Arctic.
 - It is the world's largest uninhabited island.
 - Ellesmere Island lies to the north of Devon Island and Baffin Bay lies to its east.
- 13. What is the primary objective of the Moonshot Project?**
- (a) To develop advanced satellite communication technologies
 - (b) To build quantum computing systems
 - (c) To develop brain co-processors that decode neural signals and restore lost brain functions
 - (d) To develop new vaccines for neurological diseases

Answer: C

Explanation

- The Indian Institute of Science has launched a Moonshot project on brain co-processors in partnership with the Pratiksha Trust.
- The project is led by the Indian Institute of Science.
- It is funded by the Pratiksha Trust, founded by Kris Gopalakrishnan and Sudha Gopalakrishnan.
- The Moonshot Project is an advanced research

initiative to develop brain co-processors— devices that interface with the human brain to decode neural signals, process them using AI, and stimulate the brain to restore lost functions.

14. A lunar eclipse occurs when:

- (a) The Moon comes between the Earth and the Sun
- (b) The Earth comes between the Sun and the Moon
- (c) The Sun comes between the Earth and the Moon
- (d) The Moon blocks the Earth's shadow

Answer: B

Explanation

- The first total lunar eclipse of the year will take place on March 3, 2026.
- In India, the phenomenon is known as Chandra Grahan, and can be viewed with the naked eye.
- A lunar eclipse occurs when the Earth moves between the Sun and the Moon, causing the Earth's shadow to fall on the Moon's surface.

15. The Clarion–Clipperton Zone, often mentioned in the context of polymetallic nodules, is located in the:

- (a) Atlantic Ocean
- (b) Indian Ocean
- (c) Arctic Ocean
- (d) Pacific Ocean

Answer: D

Explanation

- Scientists exploring the deep Pacific Ocean have reported the discovery of what they describe as “dark oxygen”, detected about 4,000 metres below the ocean surface where sunlight never reaches.
- “Dark oxygen” refers to oxygen detected in deep-sea environments where sunlight is completely absent.
- The Clarion–Clipperton Zone in the Pacific Ocean is rich in polymetallic nodules containing manganese, nickel, and cobalt.

16. Cassava Brown Streak Disease (CBSD) is caused by:

- (a) Virus
- (b) Fungus
- (c) Bacteria
- (d) Nematode

Answer: A

Explanation

- Recently, a study warns that more than a third of Africa is at risk of Cassava Brown Streak Disease
- It is a devastating disease that causes loss of cassava root (tuber) production and quality.

- It is caused by two types of virus, Cassava Brown Streak Virus (CBSV) and Ugandan Cassava Brown Streak Virus (UCBSV).

17. Project Helix, recently in the news, is associated with which of the following companies?

- (a) Sony
- (b) Nintendo
- (c) Microsoft
- (d) Electronic Arts

Answer: C

Explanation

- Microsoft has unveiled 'Project Helix,' its next-generation Xbox console, hinting at a fusion of console and PC gaming.

18. “Atoms”, recently in news, is a startup launched by:

- (a) Elon Musk
- (b) Jeff Bezos
- (c) Travis Kalanick
- (d) Sundar Pichai

Answer: C

Explanation

- Uber co-founder Travis Kalanick launched a startup called Atoms that is focused on specialised industrial robotics designed to automate tasks in the mining, transport, and food sectors.

19 The Minor Planet Centre is located in:

- (a) Houston
- (b) Cambridge
- (c) California
- (d) Florida

Answer: B

Explanation

- The Minor Planet Centre (MPC) announced 15 new moons had been found, four around Jupiter and 11 around Saturn
- It is the world's primary repository for all observations of small bodies in the solar system.
- It is Located in Cambridge, Massachusetts
- It operates at the Smithsonian Astrophysical Observatory under the International Astronomical Union

20. Titanium is obtained commercially by:

- (a) Hall–Héroult process
- (b) Kroll process
- (c) Bessemer process
- (d) Bayer process

Answer:

Explanation

The moon's titanium-rich rocks

- A new study by researchers from IIT-Kharagpur and the Physical Research Laboratory (PRL), Ahmedabad decoded the moon's titanium-rich

rocks.

- It is present in meteorites and the sun.
- Ores of Titanium: The two prime commercial minerals are Ilmenite (FeTiO_3) and Rutile (TiO_2).
- Titanium is obtained by the Kroll process.

21. Which of the following is a characteristic feature of Sahiwal cattle?

- (a) High milk yield with strong heat tolerance
- (b) High wool production and cold resistance
- (c) Primarily used as a draught breed with low milk yield
- (d) Native to temperate European regions

Answer: A

Explanation

- Recently, the Indian Council of Agricultural Research– Indian Veterinary Research Institute, Izatnagar, Bareilly successfully produced indigenous Sahiwal cattle calves by using ultrasound- guided ovum pick-up, in vitro fertilization, and embryo transfer (OPU–IVF–ET).
- It is considered to be one of the best milch cattle breeds of India.
- Characteristics: Its unique traits are, tick-resistant, heat tolerant, high milk production and noted for its high resistance to parasites, both internal and external

22. The “Terafab” project, recently in news, is associated with which individual?

- (a) Elon Musk
- (b) Jeff Bezos
- (c) Sundar Pichai
- (d) Satya Nadella

Answer: A

Explanation

- Elon Musk officially launched the "Terafab" project
- The project is a joint venture between Tesla and SpaceX, with significant integration for xAI,
- Facility Location: Near Austin, Texas

23. The SWOT Satellite, recently in news, is primarily designed to study:

- (a) Variations in ocean surface height and circulation
- (b) Surface water and ocean topography
- (c) Subsurface ocean mineral distribution
- (d) Atmospheric water vapour distribution

Answer: B

Explanation

- Recently, NASA has developed a new map of the ocean floor by using satellite data from SWOT

Satellite

- The Surface Water and Ocean Topography (SWOT) satellite was launched in 2022.
- It is a joint mission of NASA and CNES (French Space Agency).
- Objective: Satellite will collect detailed measurements of how water bodies on Earth change over time

24. Waste foundry sand, recently in news, is a by-product of:

- (a) Cement manufacturing
- (b) Metal casting industry
- (c) Plastic recycling
- (d) Thermal power plants

Answer: B

Explanation

- Recently, the Institute of Indian Foundrymen (IIF) and CSIR-Central Road Research Institute (CSIR-CRRI) entered into an agreement to develop and facilitate solutions for the utilisation of waste foundry sand in road construction.
- It is a byproduct from the production of both ferrous and nonferrous metal castings.
- It is high quality silica sand.

25. Consider the following statements about biologics:

1. They are derived from living organisms.
2. They bind to specific cell receptors.
3. They are extremely sensitive to environmental factors like temperature and light.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) only
- (b) 1 and 2 only
- (c) 2 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation

- Biologicals are a class of advanced medicines produced using living organisms. Unlike traditional small molecule drugs (like aspirin) which are synthesized through chemical processes, biologics are large, complex proteins derived from biological sources.
- Derived from living systems such as microorganisms, plant cells, or animal/human cells and plasma.
- They bind to specific cell receptors, which allows for precision medicine with fewer off-target effects.
- Extremely sensitive to environmental factors like temperature and light; they usually require a

cold chain for storage.

26. Which company/app has launched the AI-powered social networking app “Attie”?

- (a) Meta (b) Bluesky
(c) X (Twitter) (d) Google

Answer: B

Explanation

- Bluesky, a decentralised social networking app, has unveiled a new AI-powered app that lets users design their algorithm, create custom feeds, and essentially ‘vibe-code’ their own social media experience.
- The new agentic AI social app, called Attie.

Environment

1. Consider the following statements regarding Kanha Tiger Reserve:

1. It has a wildlife corridor with Pench Tiger Reserve.
2. It is connected to Achanakmar Tiger Reserve.
3. It is located in Maharashtra.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A

Explanation

- Kanha Tiger Reserve is located in the “Maikal” ranges of the Satpuras in the state of Madhya Pradesh.
 - Corridor: It has an active corridor between Kanha and Pench Tiger Reserves.
 - Kanha is also connected with the Achanakmar Tiger Reserve of Chhattisgarh State.
- 2. The Nagoya Protocol primarily deals with:**
- (a) Climate change mitigation
(b) Conservation of wetlands
(c) Access and benefit sharing of genetic resources
(d) Protection of endangered species

Answer: C

Explanation

- The Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change has submitted India’s First National Report on the implementation of the Nagoya Protocol on Access Benefit Sharing to the Secretariat of the Convention on Biological Diversity.
 - The Nagoya Protocol on Access to Genetic Resources and the Fair and Equitable Sharing of Benefits Arising from their Utilization (ABS) to the Convention on Biological Diversity is a supplementary agreement to the Convention on Biological Diversity.
- 3. Gynandromorphy refers to:**

- (a) Sex change during life
(b) Functional male & female organs
(c) Asexual reproduction
(d) Presence of male & female traits in different parts of the same organism

Answer: D

Explanation

- Researchers have discovered a rare dual-sex condition in a freshwater crab species within the Silent Valley National Park of the Western Ghats.
 - This finding marks the first recorded instance of gynandromorphy in the crab family Gecarcinucidae.
 - Gynandromorphy happens due to genetic errors during early embryonic development.
 - In this condition, a single organism shows both male and female physical traits on the same body.
- 4. The Anavaran Deforestation Alert System, recently in the news, was developed by which organisation?**
- (a) National Remote Sensing Centre
(b) National Biodiversity Authority
(c) Indian Space Research Organisation
(d) Forest Survey of India

Answer: D

Explanation

- Recently, the Forest Survey of India stopped its Anavaran-Deforestation Alert System on deforestation.
 - Anavaran Portal has been operational since January 2024.
 - It has been using satellite data and machine learning to enable Forest Survey of India to issue location alerts on the loss of forest cover to states every 15 days so that targeted field inspections can be carried out.
 - It uses Sentinel-2 satellite images as input data.
- 5. The LaBL 2.0 (Lighting a Billion Lives 2.0) initiative was launched by which organisation?**
- (a) The Energy and Resources Institute (TERI)
(b) NITI Aayog
(c) Ministry of New and Renewable Energy

(d) International Solar Alliance

Answer: A

Explanation

- The Energy and Resources Institute (TERI) launched LaBL 2.0 (Lighting a Billion Lives 2.0) in New Delhi to expand decentralized renewable energy solutions across India.
- LaBL 2.0 is a next-generation decentralised renewable energy (DRE) programme aimed at expanding clean energy access while enabling productive rural livelihoods and climate action.

6. Consider the following statements regarding the National Highways Green Cover Index (NH-GCI):

1. It was prepared in coordination with the National Remote Sensing Centre (NRSC) of ISRO.

2. The analysis is conducted for every 1-km highway segment using the Normalized Difference Vegetation Index (NDVI).

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Explanation

- The National Highways Authority of India (NHAI) released the first National Highways Green Cover Index (NH-GCI).
- It is an initiative of National Highways Authority of India.
- It has been prepared in coordination with the National Remote Sensing Centre (NRSC) of the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO).
- The initiative aims to provide a scientific and quantitative assessment of green cover within the Right of Way (RoW) along the National Highways network by leveraging advanced space-based technologies. The analysis is conducted for every one-kilometre highway segment using the Normalized Difference Vegetation Index (NDVI) derived from satellite imagery.

7. The species *Chelonus (Carinichelonus) mahadeb* was discovered at:

- (a) Kaziranga National Park
- (b) Nahortoli Tea Estate
- (c) Manas Biosphere Reserve

(d) Jorhat Botanical Garden

Answer: B

Explanation

- A rare parasitic wasp *Chelonus (Carinichelonus) mahadeb* named has been recently recorded from a tea estate in Assam.
- It is a new species of parasitic wasp.
- It was discovered from Nahortoli Tea Estate in Assam.

8. Which of the following countries have proposed the inclusion of the Striped Hyena in Appendix I and II of the Convention on Migratory Species (CMS)?

- (a) Kazakhstan and Kyrgyzstan
- (b) Iran and Iraq
- (c) Tajikistan and Uzbekistan
- (d) India and Nepal

Answer: C

Explanation

- Tajikistan and Uzbekistan have formally proposed including the striped hyena in Appendix I and II of the Convention on Migratory Species (CMS) at the upcoming CMS COP15 in Brazil.
- The striped hyena is a medium-sized, nocturnal carnivore and the only hyena species found in the Indian subcontinent.

9. 'Gitchak nakana', the newly discovered groundwater fish species, was recently found in which state?

- (a) Assam
- (b) Meghalaya
- (c) Arunachal Pradesh
- (d) Manipur

Answer: A

Explanation

- A new groundwater fish species, 'Gitchak Nakana', has been recently discovered in Assam
- This miniature, blind loach was discovered from a dug-out well in Assam, marking the first aquifer-dwelling (phreatobitic) fish recorded from Northeast India.

10. The Indian Bison Fest is hosted at:

- (a) Simlipal Wildlife Sanctuary
- (b) Debrigarh Wildlife Sanctuary
- (c) Satkosia Tiger Reserve
- (d) Bhitarkanika National Park

Answer: B

Explanation

- The Debrigarh Wildlife Sanctuary is set to host the second edition of the two-day 'Indian Bison Fest'.
- Debrigarh Wildlife Sanctuary is situated in the

Bargarh district of Odisha.

11. In India, the only breeding site of the Ruddy Shelduck is:

- (a) Sunderbans (b) Chilika Lake
(c) Ladakh (d) Rann of Kutch

Answer: C

Explanation

- Residents of Mudh village in Ladakh have been protecting the Ruddy Shelduck for over two decades, escorting fledglings safely to the Indus River during breeding season.
- The Ruddy Shelduck (*Tadorna ferruginea*), also known as the Brahminy duck, is a large migratory waterfowl species found across Europe, Central Asia, and parts of Africa, wintering in South Asia.
- In India, Ladakh is its only breeding site, where it nests in high-altitude wetlands between June and August.

12. PARIVESH 2.0, recently seen in the news, primarily aims to:

- (a) Monitor forest fires through satellite systems
(b) Streamline environmental clearances through a digital platform
(c) Regulate wildlife trade in India
(d) Manage national parks and biosphere reserves

Answer: B

Explanation

- The launch of PARIVESH 2.0 has streamlined environmental clearances, integrating biodiversity data into infrastructure planning.

13. "Osbeckia zubeengargiana", recently discovered, is a:

- (a) Mammal species (b) Bird species
(c) Plant species (d) Insect species

Answer: C

Explanation

- New Plant Species Discovered in Manas Named After Zubeen Garg
- "Osbeckia zubeengargiana" is a newly discovered plant species from Manas National Park in Assam.
- It belongs to the Melastomataceae family and the genus "Osbeckia".
- The plant is a perennial shrub
- named it after renowned Assamese singer Zubeen Garg.

14. Chokramudi Hills, recently in news, are located in:

- (a) Tamil Nadu

(b) Karnataka

(c) Kerala

(d) Andhra Pradesh

Answer: C

Explanation

- The Chokramudi hills in Kerala, previously a hub for illegal encroachment and construction, have been reclaimed by the government.
- This restoration has led to the return of the endangered Nilgiri tahr and the revival of the rare Neelakurinji

15. Hypercapnic hypoxia refers to:

- (a) High oxygen and low carbon dioxide levels
(b) Low temperature and high oxygen levels
(c) High nitrogen and low oxygen levels
(d) Low oxygen and high carbon dioxide levels

Answer: D

Explanation

- A new study revealed that most mangrove sites are already experiencing mild or severe hypercapnic hypoxia.
- Hypercapnic Hypoxia is a high CO₂ and low oxygen state.
- It pushes estuaries into a stressful chemical state.

16. Consider the following statements regarding Prosopis juliflora:

1. It is an invasive species in arid and semi-arid regions.
2. It consumes large amounts of water and degrades ecosystems.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Explanation

- Recently, the Madras High Court issued a set of 34 directions for the eradication of the exotic and invasive species prosopis juliflora from Tamil Nadu.
- It is a shrub or small tree in the family Fabaceae, a kind of mesquite.
- It is native to Mexico, South America and the Caribbean.
- It is one of the most invasive species in arid and semi-arid areas.
- This tree absorbs more than four litres of water to obtain one kilogram of biomass.

17. The species Chhapgarus ngankeae has been

named in honour of Ngan Kee Ng. He is:

- (a) A wildlife conservationist from India
- (b) A marine biologist from Singapore
- (c) A botanist from Australia
- (d) An environmental activist from the USA

Answer: B

Explanation

- Recently, researchers from the Zoological Survey of India discovered a new crab species from the Goan mangroves and named it as Chhagargus ngankeeae.
- It is a new species of marine crab.
- The species has been named in honour of the late Dr Ngan Kee Ng, a noted marine biologist from the National University of Singapore.

18. The 15th Conference of the Parties (COP-15) to the Convention on Migratory Species (CMS) is being held in which country?

- (a) Germany
- (b) Kenya
- (c) Brazil
- (d) Switzerland

Answer: C

Explanation

- The 15th meeting of the Conference of the Parties (COP 15) to the Convention on Conservation of Migratory Species (CMS) of Wild Animals in Campo Grande, Brazil, is underway.
- It started on March 23 and end on March 29, 2026.
- The theme for this year is "Connecting Nature to sustain life."

19. Which of the following organizations initiated Earth Hour?

- (a) United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP)
- (b) Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (IPCC)
- (c) World Wide Fund for Nature (WWF)
- (d) International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN)

Answer: C

Explanation

- Earth Hour is a global movement encouraging individuals, communities, and businesses to turn off non-essential lights for one hour.
- It aims to raise awareness about climate change and biodiversity loss, while inspiring people to adopt sustainable lifestyles and take meaningful actions for environmental protection.
- Earth Hour began in 2007 in Sydney, initiated by the WWF (World Wide Fund for Nature)

20. The IUCN Red List status of the Steppe Eagle is:

- (a) Vulnerable
- (b) Near Threatened
- (c) Endangered
- (d) Critically Endangered

Answer: C

Explanation

- The western part of Rajasthan has been recognised as a stronghold of the Steppe Eagle.
- Threats: The major threats to the Steppe eagle include habitat loss, persecution, wildfires, predation (and trampling by cattle) of chicks.
- IUCN Red List: Endangered
- It is the only eagle to nest primarily on the ground.
- It mainly breeds in central Asian countries, including Kazakhstan, Russia, and Mongolia.

21. Euthalia zubeengargi, recently in news, is a:

- (a) Bird species
- (b) Butterfly species
- (c) Amphibian species
- (d) Reptile species

Answer: B

Explanation

- Recently, a new butterfly species was recorded in Arunachal Pradesh and named it as Euthalia zubeengargi, named after Zubeen Garg
- Habitat: It is found in semi-evergreen forests at elevations of 600-750 metres

22. The newly discovered frog species Nyctibatrachus kali derives its name from:

- (a) A local tribe
- (b) A mountain range
- (c) A river
- (d) A scientist's name

Answer: C

Explanation

- Recently, the new frog species was discovered and named it as Nyctibatrachus kali.
- It was found in the Kali Tiger Reserve in Uttara Kannada district of Karnataka.
- It was named after the nearby Kali River (the reserve is also named after the river which flows through it).

23. Keelback snakes are most commonly found in:

- (a) Desert ecosystems
- (b) High-altitude glaciers
- (c) Areas near water bodies
- (d) Dense tropical rainforests only

Answer: C**Explanation**

- Keelback snakes are typically non-venomous.
- Habitat: These are often found near water bodies such as streams and wetlands.
- Diet: Frogs, lizards and occasionally fish and tadpoles

24. Mount Fuji is located on which island of Japan?

- (a) Hokkaido (b) Honshu
(c) Kyushu (d) Shikoku

Answer: B**Explanation**

- Honshu, historically known as Akitsushima, is the largest of the four main islands of Japan.
- It lies between the Pacific Ocean (east) and the Sea of Japan (west).
- It is the second-most populous island in the world after the Indonesian island of Java.
- It contains Japan's highest mountain, Mount Fuji (an active stratovolcano), and its largest lake, Lake Biwa.

25. Veerangana Durgavati Tiger Reserve is located in which state?

- (a) Madhya Pradesh
(b) Maharashtra
(c) Chhattisgarh
(d) Rajasthan

Answer: A**Explanation**

- Madhya Pradesh Chief Minister has laid the foundation for a new soft release Boma (enclosure) at the Veerangana Durgavati Tiger Reserve (VDTR), marking the start of India's third home for cheetahs.
- It is a massive protected area formed by the notification of the erstwhile Nauradehi Wildlife Sanctuary and Durgavati Wildlife Sanctuary.
- It is unique for being a Land of Wolves and is now slated to become the first reserve in India where cheetahs will co-exist with a significant population of tigers and leopards.

26. Nor'westers are:

- (a) Severe thunderstorms in eastern India
(b) Cold winds from the Himalayas
(c) Cyclones in the Arabian Sea
(d) Winter monsoon winds

Answer: A**Explanation**

- Nor'westers: They are extremely severe thunderstorms that occur in eastern and

northeastern India and Bangladesh. They form during the pre-monsoon season (March–May).

- Nor'westers are locally called Kalbaisakhi in Bengal, meaning "the calamity of the month of Baisakh," and Bardoli Cheerha or Bordoisila in Assam.

27. Cyclone Narelle recently affected which of the following country?

- (a) Indonesia
(b) Australia
(c) Philippines
(d) Madagascar

Answer: B**Explanation**

- Tropical Cyclone Narelle triggered a powerful dust storm, turning the skies over parts of Western Australia a blood red.
- A tropical cyclone is formed only over warm ocean waters near the equator.

28. The headquarters of the National Biodiversity Authority is located in:

- (a) Chennai (b) Bengaluru
(c) New Delhi (d) Hyderabad

Answer: A**Explanation**

- National Biodiversity Authority Launches 3-Month Internship Programme for Graduates and Postgraduates It is a statutory body established under the Biological Diversity Act, 2002.
- It was formally set up in 2003.
- Headquarters: It is located in Chennai, Tamil Nadu.

29. What is the IUCN Red List status of the Hudsonian godwit?

- (a) Least Concern
(b) Near Threatened
(c) Vulnerable
(d) Endangered

Answer: C**Explanation**

- The Hudsonian godwit population has plunged 95% in four decades due to a complex mix of environmental changes across multiple countries. IUCN Red List: Vulnerable.

30. The IUCN Red List status of the Great Indian Bustard is:

- (a) Critically Endangered
(b) Vulnerable
(c) Endangered

(d) Near Threatened

Answer: A

Explanation

- For the first time in a decade, Gujarat saw the birth of a Great Indian Bustard (GIB) chick—after a “trans-state conservation effort” that involved an “arduous 770-km road journey”

across a “halt-free corridor” to transport a 15-day old fertile egg from Sam in Rajasthan’s Jaisalmer district to Naliya in Gujarat’s Kutch district. Protection Status:

- IUCN: Critically Endangered
- Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972: Schedule I
- CITES: Appendix I

Index

1. Consider the following statements regarding the Fiscal Health Index (FHI) 2026:

1. Arunachal Pradesh topped the North-Eastern & Himalayan States category.

2. Assam, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Sikkim and Tripura are placed in the Performer category among the North-Eastern & Himalayan States.

3. Odisha ranked first among the large states.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation.

- The NITI Aayog released the second annual edition of the “Fiscal Health Index 2026” in New Delhi.
- Key Highlights of Fiscal Health Index (FHI) 2026 For 18 Large Indian States
- Achiever: Odisha (1); Goa (2); Jharkhand (3)
- For North-Eastern & Himalayan States
- Achiever States: Arunachal Pradesh (First); Uttarakhand (Second)
- Performer States: Assam, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Sikkim, Tripura

2. According to the World Obesity Atlas 2026, India ranks globally for children who are overweight and living with obesity.

- (a) First
- (b) Second
- (c) Third
- (d) Fourth

Answer: B

Explanation

- On World Obesity Day (4th March), the World Obesity Federation released the second edition of the World Obesity Atlas 2026.
- According to the Atlas, India now ranks second globally for children who are overweight and living with obesity after China, beating the US and other Western nations.

- India could have 41 million children with high body mass index (BMI) and 14 million living with obesity.

3. Consider the following statements regarding the World Happiness Report 2026:

1. India is ranked within the top 100 countries.

2. Finland has topped the report.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

Explanation

- World Happiness Report 2026 - by the Wellbeing Research Centre at the University of Oxford, in partnership with Gallup, the UN Sustainable Development Solutions Network
- Finland remains the happiest country in the world in 2026, holding the top spot for the ninth consecutive year.
- Among the 147 countries featured in the report, India ranks 116th

4. India’s rank in the Forbes World’s Billionaires List 2026 is:

- (a) First
- (b) Second
- (c) Third
- (d) Fourth

Answer: C

Explanation

- India now ranks third globally behind China and the United States in the Forbes World’s Billionaires List 2026
- Among the 229 Indian citizens on the Forbes’ World’s Billionaires list, richest and second richest Indians are business tycoons Mukesh Ambani and Gautam Adani.

5. Among large states, which recorded the highest case disposal performance according to the Consumer Justice Report 2026?

- (a) Karnataka
- (b) Tamil Nadu
- (c) Andhra Pradesh
- (d) Telangana

Answer: C

Explanation

- The India Justice Report (IJR) released its Consumer Justice Report 2026 in March 2026, the first comprehensive, data-driven assessment of India's three-tiered consumer dispute redressal system covering District, State, and National Consumer Disputes Redressal Commissions under the Consumer Protection Act, 2019.

State-wise Performance

- Among large states, Andhra Pradesh recorded the highest case disposal, with only 4.8% of cases pending beyond three years.
- In contrast, Telangana ranked lowest among large states despite a high disposal rate, due to gaps in leadership and insufficient coverage.

6. Consider the following statements regarding the Global Terrorism Index (GTI) 2026:

1. Pakistan ranked as the most terrorism-affected country in the latest index.
2. India was among the top 10 most affected countries.
3. It is published by the United Nations.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 1 and 2 only
and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A

Explanation

- Recently, the Global Terrorism Index, 2026 was published by the Institute for Economics and Peace (IEP).
- For the first time, Pakistan leads the Index as the country most impacted by terrorism.
- India is placed 13th on the list.

7. Prime Minister _____ became the longest-serving head of an elected government in India, completing _____ days in office.

- (a) Narendra Modi – 8,931
(b) Manmohan Singh – 8,500
(c) Atal Bihari Vajpayee – 9,100
(d) Jawaharlal Nehru – 8,700

Answer: A

Explanation

PM Modi Becomes Longest-Serving Elected Head of Government in India

- Prime Minister Narendra Modi became the longest-serving head of an elected government in India, surpassing former Sikkim Chief Minister Pawan Kumar Chamling.
- PM Modi completed 8,931 days in office being the head of the government, combining his days

as the Chief Minister of Gujarat and then becoming the Prime Minister.

- Assuming the office as the Chief Minister of Gujarat on October 7, 2001, he remained in his post until May 21, 2014, serving for more than ten years. He was later sworn in as the Prime Minister on May 26, 2014.

8. With reference to the QS World University Rankings by Subject 2026, consider the following statements:

1. IIT (ISM) Dhanbad and IIM Ahmedabad secured India's highest global rank.
2. India ranked fourth globally in terms of new entries.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Explanation

- QS World University Rankings by Subject 2026
- The Indian Institute of Management-Kozhikode (IIM-K) has achieved a global milestone by breaking into the Top 100 of the prestigious QS World University Rankings by Subject 2026 for the first time.
- India recorded 120 new entries this year, placing it fourth globally for fresh appearances, behind only the US (287), China (181), and the UK (159).

9. With reference to the World Air Quality Report, consider the following statements:

1. Pakistan topped the list of most polluted countries.
2. New Delhi is the most polluted capital city in the world.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Explanation

- World Air Quality Report, a yearly global compilation of air quality by IQAir, a Swiss company.
- In the 2025 report, India stands at 6th, now also behind Tajikistan.
- New Delhi remains the top most-polluted capital city in the world.
- Loni, in Uttar Pradesh's Ghaziabad district was the most polluted region in India in 2025

10. Consider the following statements with

reference to the State of the Global Climate Report 2025:

1. It was released by the World Meteorological Organization on World Meteorological Day.
2. It states that 2025 was the hottest year on record.
3. It includes Earth's energy imbalance as a key climate indicator for the first time.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: C

Explanation

- The State of the Global Climate report 2025 released on World Meteorological Day, is based on scientific contributions from National Meteorological and Hydrological Services, WMO Regional Climate Centres, United Nations partners and dozens of experts.
- It also mentioned that 2025 was the second or third hottest year on record, at about 1.43 °C above the 1850-1900 average.
- The 2025 report for the first time included the earth's energy imbalance as one of the key climate indicators.

International

1. Fujairah Port, recently in news due to attacks, is located in:

- (a) Saudi Arabia
(b) Oman
(c) United Arab Emirates
(d) Qatar

Answer: C

Explanation

- Recent missile/drone attacks on Fujairah port and the Shah gas field in the UAE have disrupted oil loading and gas operations.
- A major deep-water, multipurpose port and global oil storage/bunkering hub serving as a critical export outlet for UAE's hydrocarbons.
- Located in: Fujairah Emirate, United Arab Emirates (UAE) on the eastern coast.

2. Prambanan Temple, recently in news, is located in which country?

- (a) Thailand (b) Indonesia
(c) Cambodia (d) Vietnam

Answer: B

Explanation

- India and Indonesia have partnered for the restoration of the Prambanan Temple complex
- It is the largest Hindu temple complex in Indonesia, located in Sleman, Yogyakarta, Southern Java.
- It is known locally as the Temple of the Slender Virgin (Roro Jonggrang).

3. The oil tanker 'Shenlong', recently seen in the news, is related to which of the following?

- (a) India's first indigenous LNG carrier project
(b) Transportation of Saudi crude oil to India through the Strait of Hormuz
(c) Launch of India's first offshore floating

refinery

(d) A naval exercise conducted in the Arabian Sea

Answer: B

Explanation

- The Liberia-flagged crude oil tanker 'Shenlong' carrying Saudi crude oil reached Mumbai Port after transiting the Strait of Hormuz amid escalating tensions in the Middle East.
- Shenlong is a Suezmax-class crude oil tanker transporting crude oil from Ras Tanura Oil Terminal to India.
- It is Liberia-flagged, meaning the ship is registered under the maritime registry of Liberia, a common practice known as flag of convenience.

4. The theme of the International Malaria Conference (IMC) 2026 was:

- (a) Malaria-Free World by 2030
(b) Discovery, Development and Delivery: Driving Malaria Elimination and Beyond
(c) Global Strategies for Infectious Disease Control
(d) Innovations in Vector-Borne Disease Management

Answer: B

Explanation

- The International Malaria Conference (IMC) 2026, organised by the ICMR–National Institute of Malaria Research (ICMR–NIMR) under the Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR), concluded successfully in New Delhi.
- Held from 7th to 9th March 2026
- The conference was organised under the theme "Discovery, Development and Delivery: Driving Malaria Elimination and Beyond."

5. Consider the following statements regarding

Qeshm Island:**1. It is the largest island in the Persian Gulf.****2. It belongs to Israel.****Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?**

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A**Explanation**

- Iran's Foreign Minister recently accused the United States of attacking a desalination plant on Qeshm Island, saying it had set a precedent.
- Qeshm Island is the largest island in the Persian Gulf near the Straits of Hormoz.
- It belongs to Iran.

6. The Commission on the Status of Women (CSW) was established in which year?

- (a) 1945 (b) 1946
(c) 1950 (d) 1965

Answer: B**Explanation**

- The Minister of State for Women and Child Development to participate in the 70th Session of the Commission on the Status of Women (CSW-70) at the United Nations Headquarters. Commission on the Status of Women
 - It is a functional commission of the Economic and Social Council (ECOSOC).
 - It was established by ECOSOC resolution of 21 June 1946.
- 7. Recently, which country became the first in the Americas and the second globally to eliminate leprosy, as verified by the World Health Organization and the Pan American Health Organization?**
- (a) Brazil (b) Peru
(c) Argentina (d) Chile

Answer: D**Explanation**

- The World Health Organization (WHO) and the Pan American Health Organization (PAHO) officially verified Chile as the first country in the Americas— and the second globally—to have eliminated leprosy.
- 8. Upemba National Park, recently seen in the news due to an armed attack, is located in which country?**
- (a) Kenya (b) Congo
(c) Uganda (d) Tanzania

Answer: B**Explanation**

- The International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN) and its World Commission on Protected Areas (WCPA) condemned an

armed attack on Upemba National Park headquarters in the Democratic Republic of the Congo (DRC).

- Upemba National Park is one of Africa's oldest national parks and an important biodiversity hotspot in the Congo Basin ecosystem.

9. Kharg Island belongs to which country?

- (a) Saudi Arabia (b) Qatar
(c) Iraq (d) Iran

Answer: D**Explanation**

- The United States is considering seizing Iran's Kharg Island to choke off the regime's oil revenues, a US official has suggested.
- It is a small coral island in Iran in the northern Persian Gulf.
- It lies about 30 Km from the Iranian mainland.
- This rocky limestone island is unique because it is one of the few islands in the Persian Gulf with freshwater, which has collected within the porous limestone.

10. The capital city of Malawi is:

- (a) Blantyre (b) Lilongwe
(c) Lusaka (d) Harare

Answer: B**Explanation****About Malawi**

- It is a landlocked nation in southeastern Africa.
- Bordering Countries: It is bordered by three countries namely Mozambique on the east, south, and southwest. Tanzania to the north and northeast and Zambia is located to the west.
- Capital City: Lilongwe

11. Which of the following countries is NOT a member of the Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC)?

- (a) Kuwait (b) Oman
(c) Qatar (d) Iraq

Answer: D**Explanation**

- The Gulf nations are at the center of a major regional crisis following a joint U.S.- Israeli military operation on February 28 that escalated into a full-scale war with Iran.
- Gulf nations primarily refers to the six sovereign states that form the Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC).

Member States:**The GCC consists of six monarchies:**

- United Arab Emirates (UAE)
- Kingdom of Bahrain
- Kingdom of Saudi Arabia
- Sultanate of Oman
- State of Qatar
- State of Kuwait

12. Operation Epic Fury' by the United States and Israel was directed against which country?

- (a) Iraq (b) Syria
(c) Iran (d) Yemen

Answer: C**Explanation**

- US, Israel launch Operation Epic Fury against Iran
- 'Operation Epic Fury' targeted key government and military establishments, including the office of Supreme Leader Ayatollah Ali Khamenei and the Iranian President.
- A coordinated missile strike on Iran, with massive explosions across Tehran and multiple other cities

13. Consider the following statements about the Strait of Hormuz:

1. It lies between Iran and the Arabian Peninsula.
2. It connects the Persian Gulf with the Gulf of Oman.
3. It also links the Mediterranean Sea with the Red Sea.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A**Explanation****Strait of Hormuz is shut**

- It is a narrow waterway between Iran and the Arabian Peninsula, specifically the United Arab Emirates, and Musandam (Oman).
- The Gulf of Oman is on the strait's east, while the Persian Gulf is on the west.
- It is the only sea channel linking the oil-rich Persian Gulf (west) with the Gulf of Oman and the Arabian Sea (southeast).
- Iran is located on the north coast, while the UAE is on the south coast.
- At its narrowest point, the Strait of Hormuz is only 29 nautical miles wide (54 km)

14. Which of the following countries does NOT share a land border with Iran?

- (a) Iraq (b) Pakistan
(c) Syria (d) Turkmenistan

Answer: C**Explanation****Iran**

- Location: It is a prominent country located in West Asia.
- Bordering Countries: It shares land boundaries with Armenia, Azerbaijan, and Turkmenistan to the north, Afghanistan and Pakistan to the east,

Iraq to the west, and Turkey to the northwest.

- Capital City: Tehran

15. The Durand Line refers to:

- (a) Maritime boundary between Iran and Pakistan
(b) Border between Pakistan and India
(c) Boundary between Pakistan and Afghanistan
(d) Line separating Central and South Asia

Answer: C**Explanation**

- Tensions between Pakistan and Afghanistan have escalated into an open war following Pakistan's launch of Operation Ghazab lil-Haq in response to alleged unprovoked border aggression.
- The Durand Line: The 2,640 km porous border between the two nations, which Afghanistan has historically refused to recognize as an international boundary.

16. Consider the following statements regarding the Golestan Palace:

1. It is located in Tehran, Iran.
2. It served as the official residence of the Qajar dynasty.
3. It was inscribed as a UNESCO World Heritage Site in 2013.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D**Explanation**

- The Golestan Palace, a UNESCO World Heritage Site in Tehran, reportedly suffered damage due to shockwaves and debris from nearby airstrikes amid escalating US–Israel–Iran tensions in 2026.
- Golestan Palace is a historic royal complex that served as the official residence of the Qajar dynasty
- Status: UNESCO World Heritage Site (inscribed in 2013)

17. Consider the following statements regarding the United Nations Convention on the Law of the Sea (UNCLOS):

1. It was adopted in 1982 at Montego Bay, Jamaica.
2. It establishes maritime zones such as Territorial Sea, Contiguous Zone, and Exclusive Economic Zone (EEZ).
3. The United States has ratified the convention.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A

Explanation

- The United Nations Convention on the Law of the Sea (UNCLOS)
- UNCLOS is the comprehensive international treaty that establishes the legal framework governing the use of the world's oceans and seas.
- It is often called the Constitution of the Oceans because it defines rights and responsibilities of states in maritime zones
- Adopted in 1982 at Montego Bay, Jamaica.
- Entered into force in 1994 after sufficient ratifications.
- Major maritime powers like India are parties, while the United States has signed but not ratified the convention.
- Establishes legal zones such as Territorial Sea, Contiguous Zone, Exclusive Economic Zone (EEZ), and High Seas.

18. The ancestral origins of the Kurdish people are often traced to ancient tribes inhabiting which mountain range?

- (a) Taurus Mountains (b) Caucasus Mountains
(c) Zagros Mountains (d) Atlas Mountains

Answer: C

Explanation

- The Kurds have returned to the global spotlight following reports that the CIA is considering engaging Kurdish armed groups to pressure the Iranian regime.
- This comes as a new Coalition of Political Forces of Iranian Kurdistan was formed in February 2026.
- The Kurds are an Indo-European ethnic group indigenous to the Mesopotamian plains and the highlands of West Asia.
- Widely recognized as the world's largest stateless ethnic group.
- The Kurds trace their ancestry back thousands of years to the ancient tribes of the Zagros Mountains.
- Post-WWI Betrayal: Their modern stateless status stems from the aftermath of World War I.

19. The Ministerial Conference (MC14) of the World Trade Organization in 2026 will be held in:

- (a) Nairobi, Kenya
(b) Geneva, Switzerland

- (c) Yaoundé, Cameroon
(d) Jakarta, Indonesia

Answer: C

Explanation

- India has officially submitted a robust set of proposals for the WTO's 14th Ministerial Conference (MC14), focusing on a permanent solution for food security and protecting the livelihoods of traditional fishermen.
- Location: Yaoundé, Cameroon.

20. The bronze idol of Saint Tirumankai Alvar was originally associated with which temple in Tamil Nadu?

- (a) Brihadeeswara Temple
(b) Meenakshi Temple
(c) Soundararajaperumal Temple
(d) Ranganathaswamy Temple

Answer: C

Explanation

- The Ashmolean Museum (Oxford) is set to return a 16th-century bronze idol of Saint Tirumankai Alvar, after research indicated it was photographed in 1957 at the Soundararajaperumal temple, Thadikombu (Tamil Nadu) and later replaced by a replica.
- Bronze art refers to sculptural and ritual objects made from copper-based alloys (bronze/brass; in South India often panchaloha tradition), used for worship icons, processional deities, lamps, utensils, and decorative forms.

21. The oldest known red hand stencil discovered in Liang Metanduno cave is located in which country?

- (a) Malaysia (b) Indonesia
(c) Philippines (d) Thailand

Answer: B

Explanation.

- A hand stencil discovered in a limestone cave in Indonesia has been dated to at least 67,800 years ago, making it the oldest known example of rock art identified so far.
- Type: Red hand stencil

22. The Villages of Excellence initiative was announced by the Prime Minister of India during a state visit to:

- (a) Israel (b) United States
(c) France (d) UAE

Answer: A

Explanation

- Prime Minister of India announced the Villages of Excellence initiative during his state visit to Israel in February 2026 to scale up agricultural

cooperation.

- The Villages of Excellence is a grassroots-level extension of the Indo-Israel Agriculture Project (IIAP).

- Nations Involved: India and Israel

23. Which of the following indigenous tribes is known for living without clocks, calendars, or a numerical concept of time?

- (a) Amondawa (b) Maasai
(c) Yanomami (d) San

Answer: A

Explanation

- The Amondawa tribe in Brazil's Amazon lives without clocks, calendars, or numerical age, organising life by natural cycles and identity changes, as revealed by researchers.
- They are an indigenous community living deep inside Brazil's Amazon rainforest.
- They were first contacted by the outside world in 1986.

24. In water cremation (alkaline hydrolysis), the body is decomposed using a mixture of:

- (a) Potassium hydroxide and water
(b) Sodium chloride and water
(c) Calcium carbonate and water
(d) Ammonia and water

Answer: A

Explanation

- Scotland has become the first country in the UK where water cremations are now legal.
- The process - called alkaline hydrolysis - will offer families a third option instead of burial or traditional cremation.
- Bodies are wrapped in a shroud of biodegradable material such as silk or wool before being placed in a pressurised chamber with hot water and chemicals, speeding up decomposition.
- The process involves weighing the body, then heating it to 150C (300F) in a mixture of potassium hydroxide and water for up to 90 minutes.

25. Force Majeure clause refers to:

- (a) Suspension of contractual obligations due to extraordinary events
(b) Increasing penalties for contract delay
(c) Government approval for contracts
(d) Price regulation in trade

Answer: A

Explanation

- Clause included in contracts that allows a party to suspend or terminate its obligations without penalty when an extraordinary, unforeseeable event makes fulfillment impossible.

- It essentially pauses the contract because the circumstances are beyond the control of the parties involved.

26. With reference to the Iran–Pakistan–India (IPI) Pipeline, consider the following statements:

1. It is also known as the Peace Pipeline.
2. It was aimed at linking the Persian Gulf with South Asian economies.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Explanation

The Iran-Pakistan-India (IPI) Pipeline

- This has revived discussion on past pipeline projects like the Iran–Pakistan–India (IPI) and Turkmenistan–Afghanistan–Pakistan–India (TAPI)
- A proposed 2,775 km natural gas pipeline designed to transport gas from Iran's South Pars field to Pakistan and India.
- Often referred to as the Peace Pipeline, this project was intended to link the energy-rich Persian Gulf with the energy-starved South Asian economies.

27. In 1966, the United Kingdom leased Diego Garcia to which country?

- (a) France (b) United States
(c) Australia (d) Canada

Answer: B

Explanation

- Iran recently fired two ballistic missiles toward the joint U.S.-U.K. military base at Diego Garcia in the Indian Ocean.
- Location: It is a coral atoll located in the central Indian Ocean.
- In 1966, the UK leased Diego Garcia to the US to create an air and naval base. For constructing the defence installation, the inhabitants of the island were forcibly removed.

28. The Caspian Sea is located between:

- (a) Asia and Europe
(b) Europe and Africa
(c) Asia and Africa
(d) Asia and Australia

Answer: A

Explanation

- Recently, the Israeli military confirmed that its fighter jets carried out strikes on several Iranian naval vessels in the Caspian Sea.

- It is the world's largest water body that is enclosed or bordered by land on all sides.
- It is located between Asia and Europe.
- It is an endorheic basin (drainage basin without an outflow).

29. What is the Liberties Clause (Deviation Clause)?

- (a) A provision allowing change in cargo ownership
- (b) A clause permitting alteration of voyage under specific circumstances
- (c) A rule fixing shipping tariffs
- (d) A clause regulating insurance claims

Answer: B

Explanation

- The Liberties Clause or Deviation Clause
- The Liberties Clause (often referred to as the deviation clause) is a standard provision in a Bill of Lading—the legal contract between a shipper and a carrier—that grants the shipmaster the authority to alter a planned voyage under specific circumstances.

30. Proálcool Programme promotes which alternative fuel?

- (a) Hydrogen
- (b) Ethanol
- (c) Methanol
- (d) CNG

Answer: B

Explanation

- Brazil's Proálcool Programme
- A national biofuel programme launched by Brazil in 1975 to promote ethanol as an alternative to petrol, especially after global oil shocks.
- To reduce dependence on imported crude oil and enhance energy security through large-scale adoption of ethanol-based fuels.
- Mandatory Ethanol Blending: Petrol (Gasoline C) mandated to contain ethanol (initially ~11%, later increased to ~30%), ensuring steady demand for biofuels.

31. With reference to the Panama Canal, consider the following statements:

1. It is a natural waterway formed due to tectonic activity.
2. It connects the Atlantic and Pacific Oceans across the Isthmus of Panama.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

Explanation

- The Panama Canal
- It is a manmade waterway that connects the Atlantic and Pacific oceans across the Isthmus of Panama.
- It is one of the strategic artificial waterways in the world.
- It was built by the United States and completed in August 1914.

32. What recent change has been proposed regarding U.S. paper currency?

- (a) Inclusion of Supreme Court judges' signatures
- (b) Replacement of dollar with digital currency
- (c) Proposal to include the sitting President's signature by removing the Treasurer's signature
- (d) Introduction of state-wise currencies

Answer: C

Explanation

- US paper currency will soon bear Donald Trump's signature, the Treasury Department announced in a move that would be a first for a sitting American president and coincide with the country's 250th anniversary
- Historically, the signatures on dollar bills belong to those of the Treasurer of the United States and the secretary of the Treasury.

33. The Great Salt Lake is located in:

- (a) United States
- (b) Canada
- (c) Mexico
- (d) Brazil

Answer: A

Explanation

Great Salt Lake

- Researchers at the University of Utah have found that freshwater saturates the rock and sediment beneath the Great Salt Lake to depths of up to 13,000 feet.
- Location: It is a saline lake located in northern Utah, United States.
- It is the largest inland body of salt water in the Western Hemisphere and one of the most saline inland bodies of water in the world.

34. With reference to the World Trade Organization (WTO) e-commerce moratorium, consider the following statements:

1. It prohibits the imposition of customs duties on electronic transmissions.
2. It applies only to physical goods traded through e-commerce platforms.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) and 2 only (b) 2 only
(c) 1 only (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Explanation

- The e-commerce moratorium is a global agreement among World Trade Organization members which bans customs duties being

applied to electronic transmissions such as digital downloads and streaming.

- The policy was first adopted in 1998 at the WTO's Second Ministerial Conference in Geneva as part of a declaration to encourage early digital trade growth.
- It covers cross-border transmissions such as software downloads, e-books, music and movie streaming and video games.

Sports

Khelo India Games

1. Consider the following statements regarding the Khelo India Tribal Games 2026:

1. The official mascot of the Games is named "Morveer."
2. Mallakhamb and Kabaddi are included as demonstration sports.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Explanation

- Union Minister for Youth Affairs and Sports announced that the first- ever Khelo India Tribal Games (KITG) will be held in Chhattisgarh from 25 March to 6 April 2026.
 - The official mascot Morveer symbolizes courage, pride and identity of tribal communities.
 - Medal Sports (7): Athletics, Football, Hockey, Weightlifting, Archery, Swimming, and Wrestling
 - Demonstration Sports (2): Mallakhamb and Kabaddi
2. The Indian Army won the 6th edition of the Khelo India Winter Games 2026. Which of the following correctly represents its medal tally?
- (a) 8 Gold, 7 Silver, 8 Bronze
(b) 9 Gold, 6 Silver, 8 Bronze
(c) 10 Gold, 5 Silver, 8 Bronze
(d) 9 Gold, 7 Silver, 7 Bronze

Answer: B

Explanation

- Indian Army won the 6th edition of Khelo India Winter Games 2026 team championship title with a total of 23 medals - nine gold, six silver and eight bronze.
- The Indian Army had also won the team championships in 2024 and 2025.

National / International Championship

3. Which stadium will host the National Para

Athletics Championship (2026)?

- (a) Kalinga Stadium
(b) Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium
(c) DY Patil Stadium
(d) Indira Gandhi Stadium

Answer: A

Explanation

- Kalinga Stadium in Bhubaneswar is set to host the National Para Athletics Championship from 19 to 21 March 2026
 - The event, organised by the Paralympic Committee of India (PCI) in collaboration with the Odisha government,
4. The ASMITA Women's Sports League was launched in which year?
- (a) 2019 (b) 2020
(c) 2021 (d) 2022

Answer: C

Explanation

- Minister of State for Youth Affairs and Sports Raksha Nikhil Khadse has announced a special edition of the Achieving Sports Milestone by Inspiring Women Through Action (ASMITA) League in New Delhi.
 - ASMITA is part of Khelo India's gender-neutral mission to promote sports among women through leagues and competitions.
 - Started in 2021
5. Which state emerged as the overall champion in the 24th National Para-Athletics Championships 2026?
- (a) Tamil Nadu (b) Gujarat
(c) Odisha (d) Haryana

Answer: D

Explanation

- The 24th National Para- Athletics Championships 2026 concluded at the iconic Kalinga Stadium in Bhubaneswar.
- Haryana emerged as the overall champion, dominating the medal tally with 95 medals,

including 39 gold.

6. India secured which of the following medal tallies at the Asia Cup World Ranking Archery Tournament Stage 1 (2026) held in Bangkok?

- (a) 3 Gold, 3 Silver, 4 Bronze
- (b) 1 Gold, 4 Silver, 5 Bronze
- (c) 2 Gold, 5 Silver, 3 Bronze
- (d) 2 Gold, 4 Silver, 4 Bronze

Answer: D

Explanation

- In archery, India won 10 medals as compound archers dominated with a mixed team gold and a clean sweep of the men's individual podium at the Asia Cup World Ranking Tournament Stage 1 in Bangkok.
- The Asia Cup 2026 Bangkok archery tournament conclude on March 27.
- India finished with two gold, four silver and four bronze medals, bettering their overall tally.

Cricket

7. Consider the following statements regarding the Ranji Trophy:

1. Vidarbha won the Ranji Trophy 2026 title.
2. The Ranji Trophy series was announced in 1934.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

Explanation

- Jammu and Kashmir created history by clinching their first- ever Ranji Trophy crown with a commanding triumph over Karnataka in Hubballi.
 - The series was announced in 1934, and the initial fixtures took place in 1934-35. Maharaja Bhupinder Singh of Patiala donated the trophy.
- 8. The Indian women's cricket team has been nominated for the _____ Award 2026.**
- (a) Arjuna Award
 - (b) Laureus World Team of the Year
 - (c) ICC Spirit of Cricket Award
 - (d) Khel Ratna

Answer: B

Explanation

- The Indian women's cricket squad has been nominated for the prestigious 2026 Laureus

World Team of the Year Award following their maiden World Cup title triumph.

- They are the first women's cricket team to receive this nomination, a recognition for their exceptional performance in the ICC Women's World Cup 2025, including the highest successful run chase in women's ODI history in a semi-final win against Australia.

9. Who won the Player of the Tournament award in the ICC Men's T20 World Cup 2026?

- (a) Jasprit Bumrah
- (b) Sanju Samson
- (c) Devon Conway
- (d) Kane Williamson

Answer: B

Explanation

- India defeated New Zealand by 96 runs in the ICC Men's T20 World Cup 2026 final at the Narendra Modi Stadium in Ahmedabad on 8th March, thus becoming the first team to successfully defend their World T20 crown.
- India also became the first team in history to win a T20 World Cup at home.
- Jasprit Bumrah became the Player of the Match
- Sanju Samson won the Player of the tournament.

10. Which Indian sportsperson recently became the first woman cricketer to be honoured with a Barbie doll of her own?

- (a) Smriti Mandhana
- (b) Mithali Raj
- (c) Harmanpreet Kaur
- (d) Jhulan Goswami

Answer: A

Explanation

- Indian sportsperson Smriti Mandhana has been honoured with a Barbie doll of her own, making history as the first woman cricketer to receive this tribute.

11. ICC Player of the Month (Men) for February 2026 is:

- (a) Rohit Sharma
- (b) Sahibzada Farhan
- (c) Joe Root
- (d) Shubman Gill

Answer: B

Explanation

- Pakistan opener Sahibzada Farhan has been named the ICC Player of the Month for February 2026
- Indian cricket team pacer Arundhati Reddy was named the women's ICC Player of the Month for February 2026

12. Which player became the first batter in IPL history to cross 4000 runs in run chases?

- (a) Rohit Sharma
- (b) David Warner
- (c) KL Rahul
- (d) Virat Kohli

Answer: D**Explanation**

- Indian stalwart Virat Kohli etched his name into the record books by becoming the first batter in the history of the Indian Premier League to cross 4000 runs in run chases.
- Kohli also surpassed former Pakistan batter Shoaib Malik to become the sixth-highest run-getter in T20 cricket.

Football**13. Sabrina Wittmann, who made history as the first woman to manage a professional men's football team, is associated with which country?**

- (a) France
- (b) Germany
- (c) Spain
- (d) Italy

Answer: B**Explanation**

- Sabrina Wittmann has made history in German football as the first woman to manage a professional men's football team in the country.
- Initially appointed as an interim coach in 2024

14. The Football for Schools (F4S) programme is run by FIFA in collaboration with:

- (a) UNICEF
- (b) IOC
- (c) UNDP
- (d) UNESCO

Answer: D**Explanation**

- Union Minister of State for Education & Development of North Eastern Region distributed football at PM SHRI Kendriya Vidyalaya, Dakshin Dinajpur, West Bengal, as part of the Football for Schools (F4S) initiative.
- It is run by Fédération Internationale de Football Association (FIFA) in collaboration with UNESCO.
- Aim: It aims to contribute to the education, development and empowerment of around 700 million children.

15. _____ became the second men's football player to score 900 career goals.

- (a) Neymar
- (b) Lionel Messi
- (c) Kylian Mbappé
- (d) Luka Modrić

Answer: B**Explanation**

- Argentina's Lionel Messi became the second men's football player in history to score 900 career goals in official matches, joining Cristiano Ronaldo in elite company.

Tennis**16. Who won the women's singles title at the 2026 Indian Wells Open?**

- (a) Iga Świątek
- (b) Aryna Sabalenka
- (c) Elena Rybakina
- (d) Coco Gauff

Answer: B**Explanation**

- Jannik Sinner claimed his first Indian Wells Open title in the men's singles final
- Aryna Sabalenka won the 2026 Indian Wells women's singles title by defeating Elena Rybakina

17. Who won the women's singles title at the 2026 Miami Open?

- (a) Aryna Sabalenka
- (b) Coco Gauff
- (c) Iga Świątek
- (d) Elena Rybakina

Answer: A**Explanation**

- Aryna Sabalenka successfully defended her women's singles title at the 2026 Miami Open, dispatching U.S. tennis star Coco Gauff.
- She became only the fifth woman to achieve the Sunshine Double.

Chess**18. _____ became India's 94th Chess Grandmaster and the first to hail from the _____ region of India.**

- (a) Nihal Sarin – Southern
- (b) Mayank Chakraborty – North East
- (c) Arjun Erigaisi – Western
- (d) R Praggnanandhaa – Eastern

Answer: B**Explanation**

- Mayank Chakraborty became India's 94th chess Grandmaster and the first ever to hail from the country's North East region.
- In 2023, he became just the second person from the North East to become an International Master.

Badminton**19. The 49th Yonex Sunrise Junior National Badminton Championship (U-19) 2026 will be hosted by which state?**

- (a) Arunachal Pradesh

- (b) Sikkim
- (c) Assam
- (d) Meghalaya

Answer: B

Explanation

- Sikkim has been selected as the host venue for the 49th Yonex Sunrise Junior National Badminton Championship (Individual & Team – U-19) 2026.
- The tournament is scheduled to be held from 14th to 21st November.

Basketball

20. LeBron James recently broke the NBA record for _____, surpassing Robert Parish:

- (a) Most points scored in a season
- (b) Most regular-season games played
- (c) Most championships won
- (d) Most assists in a career

Answer: B

Explanation

- LeBron James has played more games than any player in National Basketball Association history.
- He played his 1,612th game, which broke the old record.
- The previous record (1,611 games) was held by Robert Parish since 1997.

Table tennis

21. _____ clinched the men's singles title at the 87th Senior National Table Tennis Championship.

- (a) Manav Thakkar
- (b) Sharath Kamal
- (c) G Sathiyan
- (d) Harmeet Desai

Answer: A

Explanation

- Manav Thakkar and Yashaswini Ghorpade, both representing the Petroleum Sports Promotion Board (PSPB), clinched their maiden men's and women's singles titles At the 87th Senior National Table Tennis Championship.

Squash

22. Who clinched the Men's Singles title at the Indian Open Squash 2026?

- (a) Saurav Ghosal
- (b) Abhay Singh
- (c) Ramit Tandon
- (d) Velavan Senthilkumar

Answer: B

Explanation

- In Squash, top seed and defending champion Anahat Singh won the Women's Singles title, While Abhay Singh clinched the Men's Singles at the Indian Open 2026 in Mumbai

Grand Prix

23. Who won the 2026 Chinese Grand Prix?

- (a) Max Verstappen
- (b) Lewis Hamilton
- (c) Kimi Antonelli
- (d) Charles Leclerc

Answer: C

Explanation

- Kimi Antonelli (Mercedes) won the 2026 Chinese Grand Prix

24. Who won the 2026 Australian Grand Prix ?

- (a) Max Verstappen
- (b) Lewis Hamilton
- (c) George Russell
- (d) Charles Leclerc

Answer: C

Explanation

- George Russell wins Australian Grand Prix 2026

25. Who won the Japanese Grand Prix ?

- (a) Max Verstappen
- (b) Lewis Hamilton
- (c) Kimi Antonelli
- (d) Charles Leclerc

Answer: C

Explanation

- Kimi Antonelli of Mercedes won the Japanese Grand Prix

Athletics

26. Which city will host the second leg of the Asia Cup in 2027, marking India's return to hosting the Asian Archery Championships after 22 years?

- (a) New Delhi
- (b) Ahmedabad
- (c) Mumbai
- (d) Hyderabad

Answer: A

Explanation

- India is set to host a Asian Archery Championships for the first time in 22 years with Delhi being awarded the second leg of the Asia Cup in 2027,

- First Leg: Bangkok, Thailand

27. India's medal tally at the World Para Athletics Grand Prix 2026 – New Delhi leg included:

- (a) 60 Gold, 70 Silver, 78 Bronze
- (b) 75 Gold, 69 Silver, 64 Bronze

(c) 80 Gold, 65 Silver, 63 Bronze

(d) 72 Gold, 68 Silver, 70 Bronze

Answer: B

Explanation

- India finished on top of the medal standings at the World Para Athletics Grand Prix 2026 New Delhi leg, securing 208 medals as the three-day competition concluded at the Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium
- The host nation (India) won 75 gold, 69 silver and 64 bronze medals.
- Russia finished second with 35 medals, while Bosnia and Herzegovina placed third with three.

28. What was India's overall medal tally at the World Boxing Futures Cup 2026?

(a) 1 Gold, 2 Silver, 2 Bronze

(b) 1 Gold, 3 Silver, 1 Bronze

Gold, 2 Silver, 1 Bronze

(d) 1 Gold, 1 Silver, 3 Bronze

Answer: B

Explanation

- Indian boxers concluded their World Boxing Futures Cup 2026 campaign in Bangkok, Thailand, with five medals - one gold, three silver and one bronze.
- Held in Bangkok from March 8 to 15

Miscellaneous

29. Which Indian roller skater recently set a Guinness World Record for the fastest time to skate under descending poles over a distance of 50 metres?

(a) Shrishti Dharmendra Sharma

(b) Anup Kumar Yama

(c) Siddhartha Bhanushali

(d) Sagar Kale

Answer: A

Explanation

- Indian roller skater Shrishti Dharmendra Sharma has created history by setting a new Guinness World Record in limbo skating.
- She achieved the fastest time to skate under descending poles over a distance of 50 metres in just 7.46 seconds.

30. Who recently became the second Indian woman to summit the world's highest volcanic peak, Nevado Ojos del Salado?

(a) Premlata Agarwal

(b) Santosh Yadav

(c) Arpita Patra

(d) Arunima Sinha

Answer: C

Explanation

- Arpita Patra, professor at the Indian Institute of Science (IISc) has summited the Nevado Ojos del Salado, which is the highest volcanic peak in the world and the highest mountain in Chile.
- By sumitting the Nevado Ojos del Salado, which is 6,893 meters,
- Became the second Indian woman to achieve this feat.

31. Athlete Anant Rana was recently in the news for which of the following achievements?

(a) Winning a gold medal at the Asian Games

(b) Climbing Mount Everest without oxygen

(c) Setting a national record in marathon running

(d) Completing the Full Ironman New Zealand triathlon

Answer: D

Explanation

- Athlete Anant Rana created history by completing the 'Full Ironman New Zealand' triathlon held in Taupo, New Zealand in 11 hours and 50 minutes, finishing swimming, cycling and the marathon run.

32. What is the new men's 50-meter freestyle world record time set by Cameron McEvoy?

(a) 20.91 seconds

(b) 20.88 seconds

(c) 21.00 seconds

(d) 20.85 seconds

Answer: B

Explanation

- Olympic and world champion swimmer Cameron McEvoy has broken the men's 50-meter freestyle world record which had stood for 17 years, posted a time of 20.88 seconds at the China Open in Shenzhen, taking 0.03 second off Brazilian César Cielo's previous mark.

33. The 2028 World Indoor Athletics Championships will be held in which state?

(a) Andhra Pradesh (b) Odisha

(c) West Bengal (d) Telangana

Answer: B

Explanation

- India will be hosting the 2028 World Indoor Athletics Championships in Bhubaneswar, Odisha at the Kalinga Indoor Athletics Stadium, Athletics Federation of India confirmed

34. Consider the following statements regarding the SRY gene:

1. It triggers the development of testes.

2. It is present on the Y chromosome.

3. It regulates insulin production.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only

(b) 2 and 3 only

(c) 1 only

(d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A

Explanation

- SRY stands for 'Sex-determining Region Y'. It is a specific segment of DNA usually found on the Y chromosome.
- This gene acts as a biological master switch that triggers the development of testes and the production of male levels of testosterone, leading to male physical development.
- Developed By: The SRY gene was first discovered in 1990 by Professor Andrew Sinclair.
- The primary objective is to protect the female category in elite sports.

Banking

1. Consider the following statements about the Sixteenth Finance Commission (16th FC):

1. It is chaired by Dr. Arvind Panagariya.

2. It submitted its report for the award period 2026–31.

3. The vertical devolution to states was retained at 41%. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only

(b) 2 and 3 only

(c) 1 and 3 only

(d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation.

- The Sixteenth Finance Commission (16th FC), chaired by Dr. Arvind Panagariya, submitted its final report for the period 2026–31.
 - The Finance Commission is a constitutional body established under Article 280 to define the financial relations between the Union and the States.
 - The 16th FC's mandate was to recommend the vertical share of taxes for states and the horizontal formula to distribute those funds among them for the five-year award period starting April 1, 2026.
 - Vertical Devolution (41%): The Commission recommended retaining the states' share in the divisible pool of central taxes at 41%, maintaining the status quo from the 15th FC.
 - Horizontal Devolution Formula: A new formula was introduced with a 10% weightage for Contribution to GDP (measured by the square root of GSDP), replacing the previous Tax Effort criterion.
2. The concept of "Tax Year" introduced in the new Income-tax Act refers to:
- (a) Calendar year (January–December)

(b) Financial year (April 1 to March 31)

(c) Assessment year only

(d) Any 12-month period chosen by taxpayer

Answer: B

Explanation

Introduction of "Tax Year"

- A new concept of "tax year", defined as April 1 to March 31, has been introduced.

The law has been significantly streamlined:

- Sections reduced from 819 (1961 Act) to 536.
 - Chapters reduced from 47 to 23.
 - Word count halved from 5.12 lakh to 2.6 lakh.
 - Tables and formulae increased to provide clarity (57 tables, 46 formulae)
3. Gruh Sugam portal, recently seen in news, is an initiative of which of the following institutions?
- (a) Reserve Bank of India (RBI)
- (b) National Housing Bank (NHB)
- (c) Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI)
- (d) National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (NABARD)

Answer: B

Explanation

- The National Housing Bank (NHB) has launched the Gruh Sugam portal, a specialized digital lending platform designed for Defense, Paramilitary, and Government personnel.
- It is a dedicated digital bridge between government employees and lending institutions.
- The portal functions as an aggregator where employees can register their home loan requirements, receive multiple competitive offers from banks, and complete the application process digitally through their respective administrative units.

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